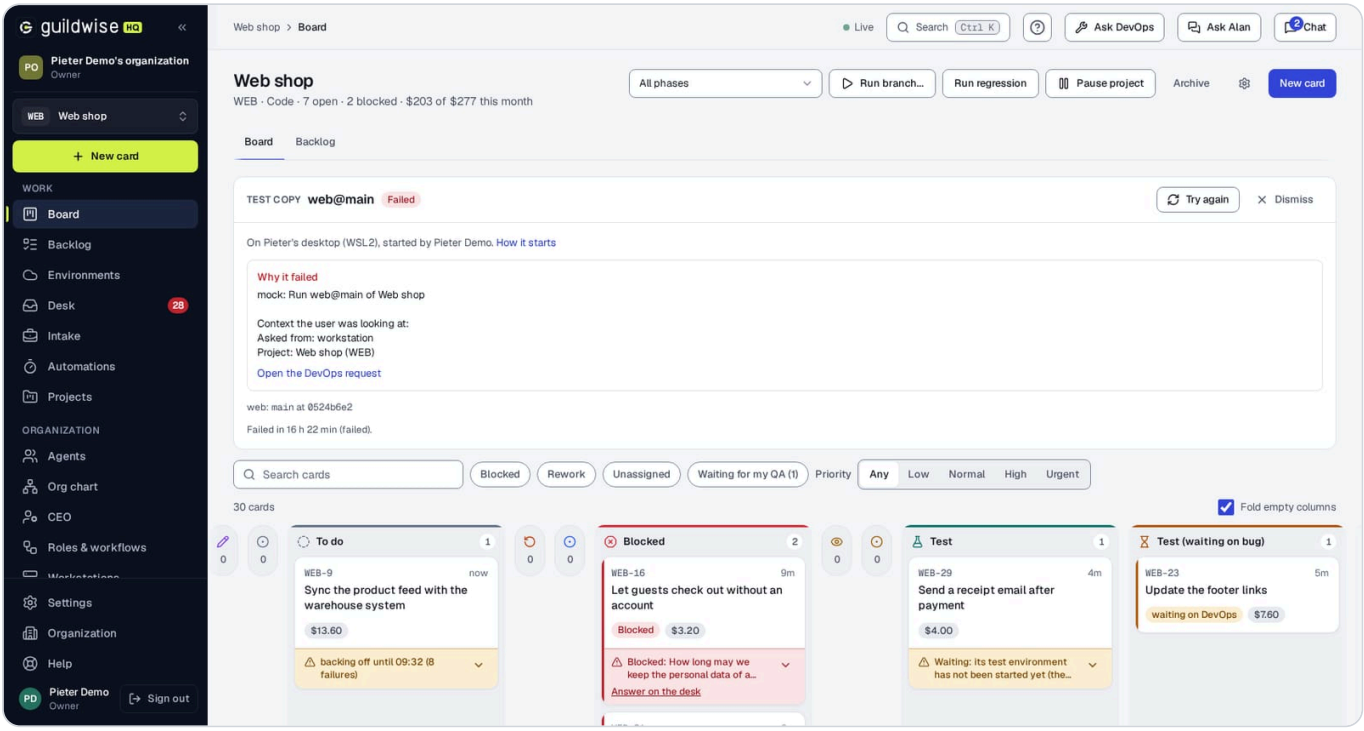
guildwise HQ

User Guide

Many hands. One master.

How to run a team of AI agents from one board: for owners, admins, members, guests and the platform administrator.



Date	**7 October 2026**
Edition	Guide 2.0, written for the complete Guildwise HQ: organizations and roles, budgets, schedules, interests, phases, the BA reporter and the installer
Data shown	Only fake demo data (`@demo.local`, `example.com`). No real Claude sessions or external posts appear.
More	In the app: **Help** in the sidebar. In the repository: `docs/USER-GUIDE.md` is the same text.

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> **About the screenshots**
> Every picture is a real screenshot of Guildwise HQ running locally with a fake demo organization (`@demo.local`, `example.com`). The agents in the demo run on a scripted stand-in for Claude, so their messages and logs read "[mock] ..." and nothing real (no Claude session, GitHub or Jira) was used. Real agents write real work.

Guildwise HQ is a place where you run a team of AI agents the way you would run a small company. You write down what you want. The agents do the work. They stop and ask you whenever a decision is really yours to make.

This guide is for people who have never worked with AI agents before. You do not need to be a programmer to read it. Where a technical word is unavoidable, it is explained the first time it appears and again in the glossary in chapter 2.

How to use this guide

- New here? Read chapters 1 to 3. They take about half an hour, and chapter 3 gets you from an invitation to your first working card in about 15 minutes.
- Then read the chapter for your role: chapter 4 for Owners and Admins, chapter 5 for Members, chapter 6 for Guests, chapter 7 for the platform administrator (the person who runs the Guildwise HQ service itself).
- Chapter 8 shows four everyday workflows from start to finish. Chapter 9 helps when something goes wrong. Chapters 10 and 11 cover Contact us and frequently asked questions.
- Inside the app, the **Help** page has short articles on every topic. This guide points to them like this: *In the app: Help, "Budgets and costs"*. The same articles open from the small **?** hints next to many headings.

1. What Guildwise HQ is

1.1 The idea in one minute

Imagine you hire a small team: someone who builds, someone who checks the work, someone who tests it, and an assistant who keeps notes and reports to you. Each of them can work on several things, but they cannot read your mind. When they are unsure, they ask. When something is risky, they wait for your go-ahead.

Guildwise HQ is that team, made of AI agents. It gives you:

- a **board** that shows every piece of work and where it stands, from left to right;
- a **desk**, which is your inbox of decisions: questions, approvals and go-aheads that only you can give;
- **agents** with names, faces and roles, who do the actual work on one of your own computers;
- a **memory** (the ledger) that remembers every decision, so nobody asks you the same thing twice;
- **reports and limits**: a daily report from your CEO, monthly spending budgets, and loop protection, so the team cannot run away with your money or your patience.

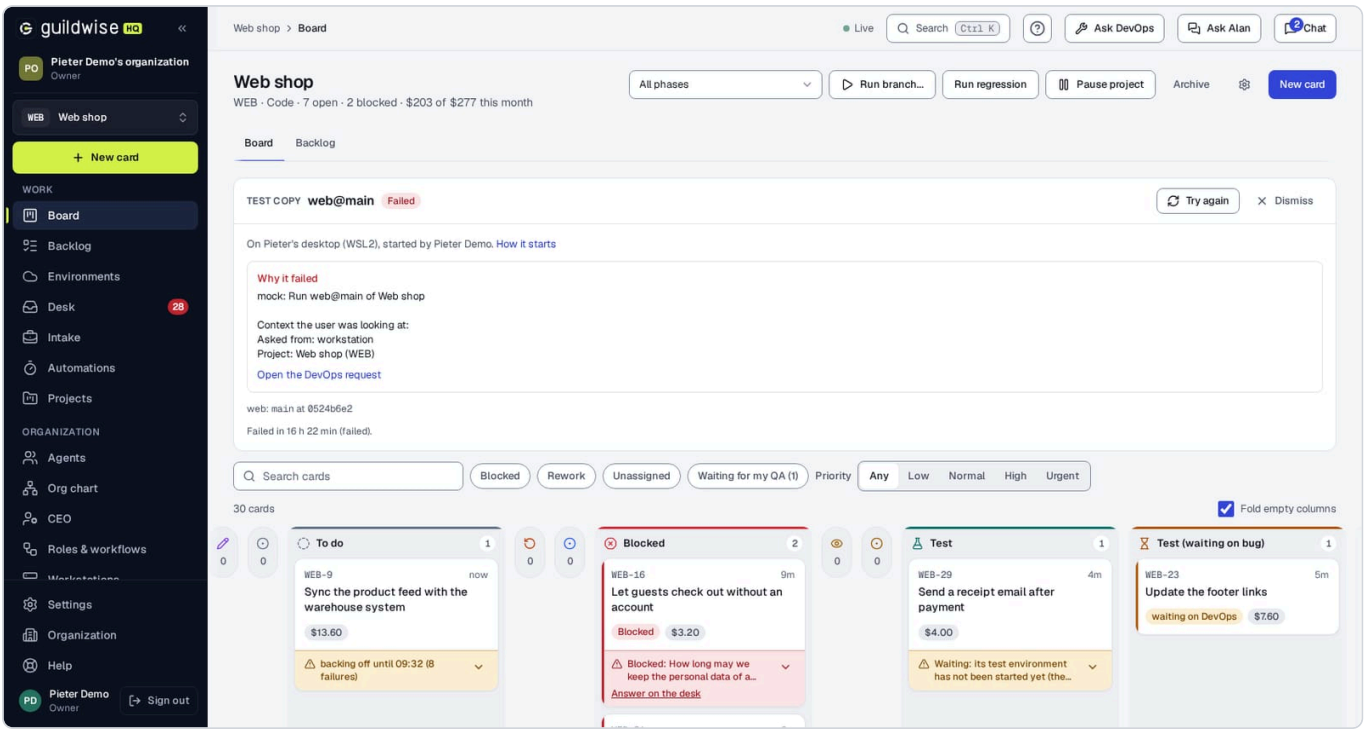


Figure 1 — The board of a project, with cards moving from left to right

1.2 What you do and what the agents do

You	The agents
Say what you want, in plain words, as a card	Turn it into a proper specification, build it, review it, test it
Answer questions on the desk	Ask when they cannot decide, and carry on once you answer
Approve risky steps (merging big changes, posting to a ticket, spending beyond a budget)	Wait for your approval and never go around it
Choose the team, the budgets and the rules	Follow them, and report if something does not fit

1.3 Where the agents run

Guildwise HQ itself is a website you sign up for. The agents do their work on a machine you choose, called a **workstation**: your own PC, a Mac or a Linux machine, a server you rent (a VPS), or a GitHub Codespace (4.19). Your code, your passwords and your files stay on that machine and in your own repositories. The Guildwise HQ website only holds the board, the desk and the records. A small helper program called the **runner** (installed in the next chapters with a guided installer) connects the workstation to the website.

> **Good to know**
> The AI itself is Claude. You sign in to Claude once on your workstation, either with your own Claude subscription or with an API key. The agents' work is billed by Claude to you (a subscription uses your plan, an API key is pay-as-you-go). Guildwise HQ estimates and limits that spend for you (see chapter 4.6).

2. Key ideas

Read this chapter once. Everything else builds on these words.

2.1 The words you will meet

Word	What it means
Organization	Your company's space in Guildwise HQ. It holds the people, projects, agents, workstations and records. You can belong to more than one.
Owner, Admin, Member, Guest	The four roles a person can have. The Owner runs the organization, Admins help manage it, Members work in the projects they are added to, Guests are visitors from another organization who can work in one shared project.
Project	A body of work with its own board, for example "Web shop". A *code* project builds software. A *research* project looks things up and writes notes.
Card	One piece of work with its requirements and acceptance criteria ("what done looks like"). A card moves across the board until it is done.
Board	The columns of a project. Each column is a stage of the work.
Agent	One AI team member: a **role** (such as builder or reviewer), a **seniority** (junior or senior), a face, a name and a track record.
Allow-list	The projects an agent may work on. An agent only ever gets cards from projects on its list.
Workstation	A computer of yours where agents run.
Runner	The small program on a workstation that does the agents' work and talks to the website.
Shift	One stretch of work by one agent on one card. You will see the word in logs and reports.
Desk	Your inbox of decisions.
Ledger	The shared memory: decisions, standing orders and requirements, searchable.
Standing order	A rule every agent reads at the start of every shift, such as "write a unit test for every change".
BA	The business analyst agent, a spec writer. It drafts and specifies cards from your requests and tickets, answers what it can from the ledger and finishes finished work. It does not report to you: your CEO does.
CEO	The agent you talk to first. Every organization has exactly one, built in. It watches the floor, handles routine items before they reach your desk and writes you a daily report (4.22).
Architect	An optional senior agent that investigates and designs a card before the builder starts, or answers a question in a written report. Off until a project turns the design step on (4.20).
DevOps engineer	A free agent that looks after one workstation: installs tools, keeps your repositories tidy, starts and stops things.
Vault	A folder of notes (a git repository) that is synced to your workstations: your organization's knowledge base, or one project's own notes.
Priority order	The order of your projects on the Projects page, most important first. Agents serve the project higher up first.
Automation	A trigger plus one action, for example "every Monday at 07:00, create a card" or "when a card reaches Review, create a follow-up". Called a schedule before October 2026.
Interest	A topic you follow, such as "AI news". Agents look for new items on a schedule and deliver them to your desk.
Phase	A named slice of a project ("Phase 2: autosave") that you ship and check together, followed by steps such as deploy and regression run.
Budget	A monthly spending limit on a project (or an interest).

The in-app glossary is at **Help, Glossary**.

2.2 How a card travels

A card in a code project goes through the same stages every time. You do not have to push it along. The agents do.

1. **Spec**: the card is written down: context, requirements, acceptance criteria. You (or the BA) write it. Until it is specified it is a draft.
2. **Design (optional)**: when the project (or the card) asks for it, an architect investigates the code and writes a design first (4.20). Off by default.
3. **To do and Build**: a builder takes the card and works on a branch of your repository.
4. **Review**: a reviewer reads the change and either approves or sends it back (rework). The reviewer also tries to break the change (an *adversarial* review: callers, edge cases, old data and clients, security, performance) and writes a short **risk analysis** with an overall risk of **low, medium or high**: what else could break, concrete failure scenarios, what was and was not verified, and what to do about it. The risk badge and the analysis are on the card page (**Reviewer risk analysis**). A **medium** or **high** risk passes the reviewer's "what to test by hand" on to the tester and to the manual QA steps. A **high** risk also makes the merge wait for your approval on the desk, even if the project lets large merges through without it. A review can be sent back as a likely **regression** (it would break something outside the card). Reviewers run at high effort on purpose, and the automatic suggestions (HR and the CEO) never lower a reviewer's effort or model; only you can.
5. **Test**: a tester runs the tests in the test plan. A failure creates a bug card, and the original waits for the fix.
6. **Finalize**: the BA completes the card the way the project says: committed and pushed to the working branch with no pull request, or as a pull request for you to approve (4.4, *How finished work lands*).
7. **QA (optional, on by default)**: the person who started the card tests it, with test steps an agent wrote (4.12, *Manual QA*).
8. **Done**.

If anyone gets stuck or needs a decision, the card turns to **Blocked** and a question appears on your desk.

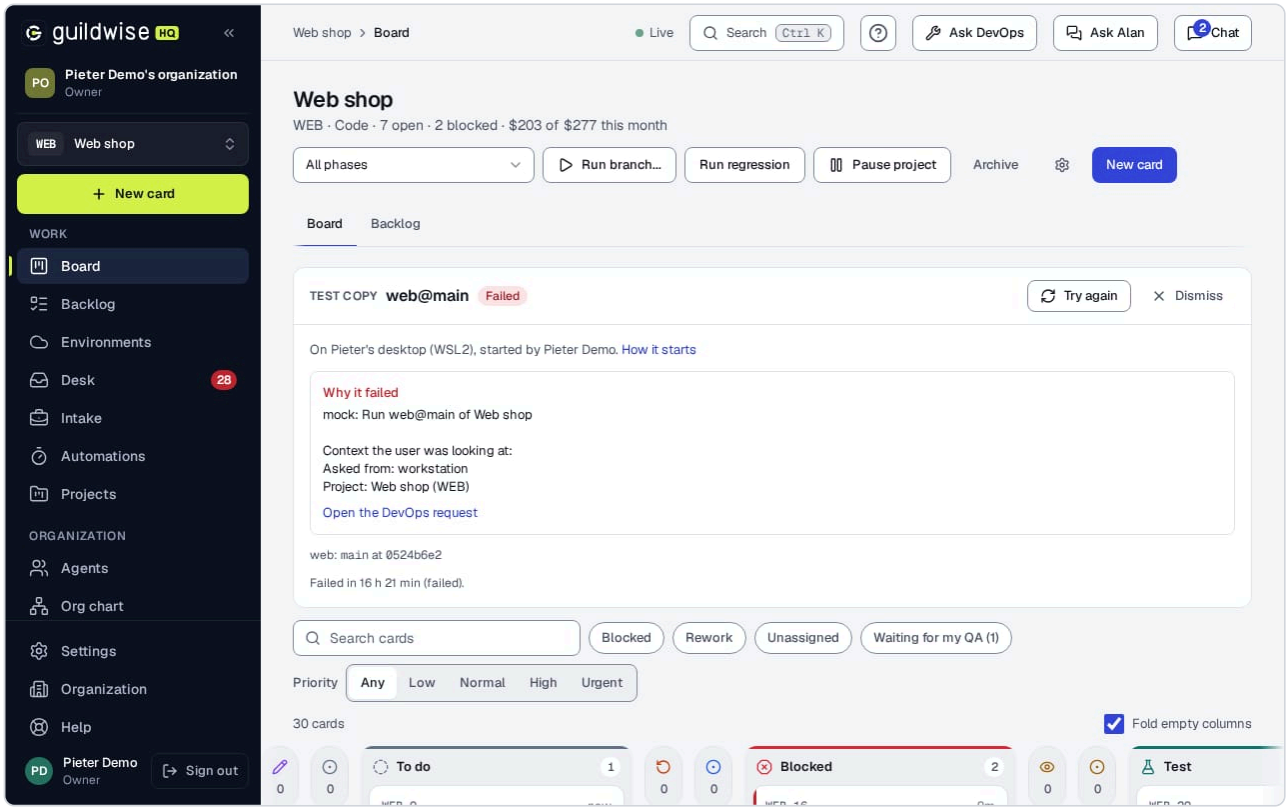


Figure 2 — The same card in different columns, from To do to Done

Around the board. The project's page has two tabs, **Board** and **Backlog** (4.3b). The header shows the project's cost this month against its budget, **New card**, and for Owners and Admins **Pause project** (4.6). Filter chips narrow the board, for example **Blocked**, **Rework**, **Waiting for my QA (n)** and **Waiting for my approval (n)**. On a phone the same controls sit behind **Filters** and **Project actions**, and the columns are an accordion.

> **In the app**
> Help, "Board and cards" (`/help/board-and-cards`) and "Testing and finalization" (`/help/testing-and-finalization`).

2.3 Who is allowed to do what

In short: **Owners and Admins manage**, **Members work** in the projects they were added to, **Guests work** in the one project that was shared with them, and the **platform administrator** only runs the service and never sees your work. Chapter 4 to 7 have the details for each role.

> **In the app**
> Help, "Organizations and roles" (`/help/organizations-and-roles`).

3. Getting started in 15 minutes

By the end of this chapter you have: a working login with two-factor protection, a workstation connected, a small team hired, a project and your first card moving across the board.

> **Before you start**
> You need an invitation email or your own sign-up (below), a computer to use as a workstation (it can be the one you are on now; a VPS or a GitHub Codespace works too), and a Claude account. A Claude subscription (Pro, Max, Team or Enterprise) is the easiest. An API key works too.

3.1 Accept the invitation and sign in (2 minutes)

1. Open the invitation email. It comes from either the **platform administrator** ("start your organization": you become its Owner) or from the **Owner or an Admin** of an existing organization ("join Acme": you become a Member or Admin). Invitations work for 7 days.
2. Click the link. Type your name and choose a password of at least 12 characters, then confirm it.
3. You land inside the app. If you already had an account, sign in instead and confirm.

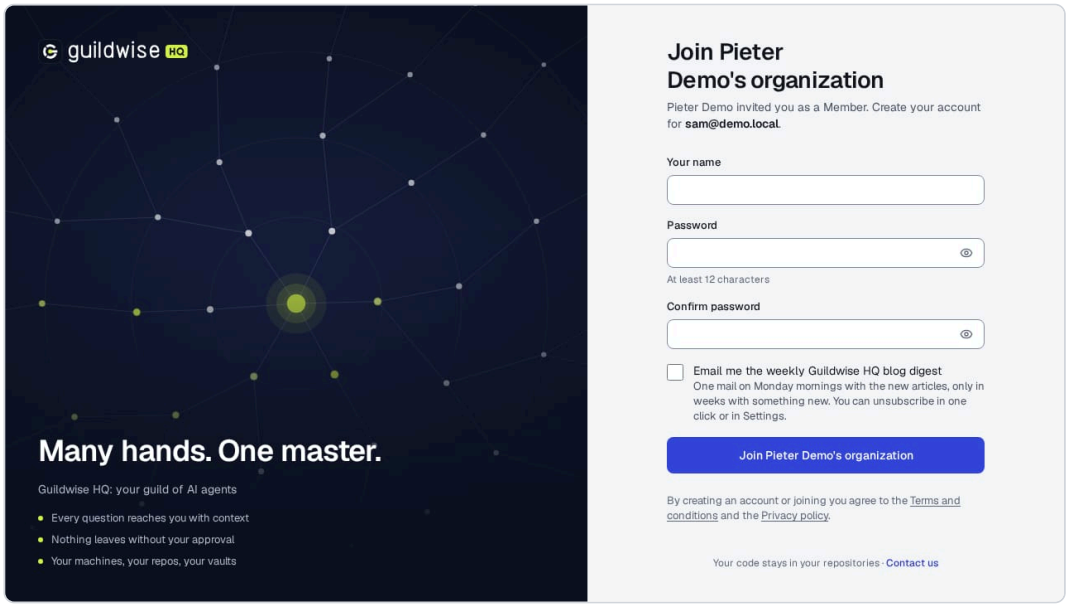


Figure 3 — Accepting an invitation

If the link says the invitation is no longer valid, it has expired, was used already, or was withdrawn. Ask the person who invited you to send a new one.

No invitation? Sign up yourself. On the website click **Start free trial** (or a plan's button under **Pricing**), choose a plan and enter your organization name, your name, email and a password. Open the link in the confirmation email: you are signed in and see one page, **Start your 7-day free trial**, with your plan, its price (US dollars, VAT included, and the rand amount at today's rate) and the trial's start and end dates. Add a card there: your **7-day free trial** starts and the app opens, with the tour and the Get started checklist; nothing is charged until the trial ends (4.17). Until the card is saved nothing else in the app opens, and coming back later shows the same page. A sign-up that never adds a card is removed after 14 days. You are the Owner of the new organization.

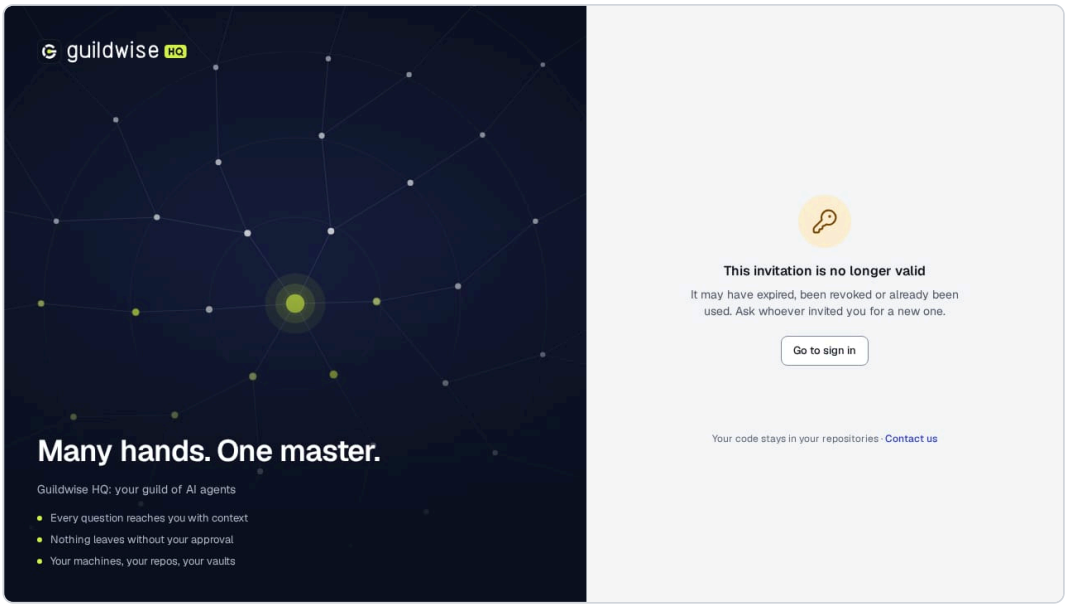


Figure 4 — An invitation link that no longer works

Forgot your password? On the sign-in page click **Forgot your password?**, type your email and we send a link (it works once and expires after an hour). We answer the same way whether or not the email has an account, so nobody can find out who is registered. Choose a new password (at least 12 characters); every other place you were signed in is signed out. Then sign in as usual: if you use two-factor login you still enter your code. A platform administrator can also send you this link (7.4). Platform administrators may use it too (their two-factor code is still asked at the next sign-in). If the email never reaches you, your organization's Owner or an Admin can give you a temporary password instead (4.15).

Visitors who are not signed in see the landing page, with **Log in** and **Start free trial** buttons, the plans and prices, a link to the blog, and a small **Ask Guildwise** chat that answers questions about the product.

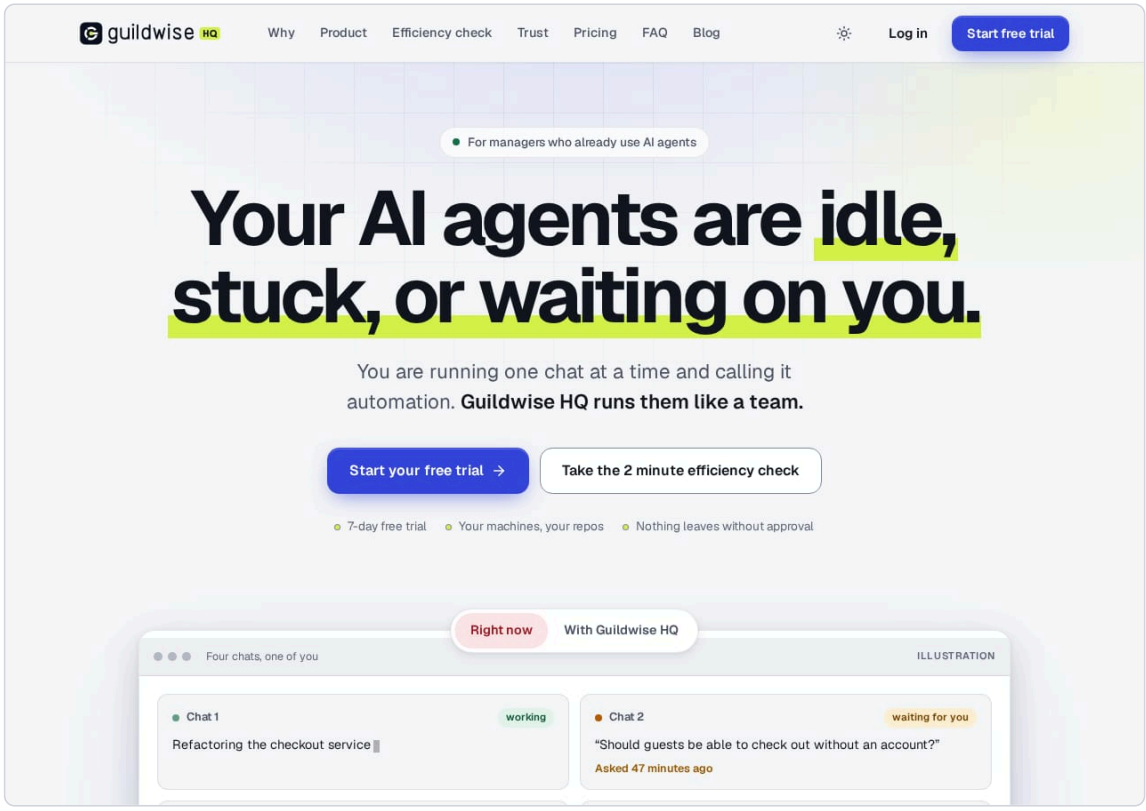


Figure 5 — The landing page

The footer links the **Privacy policy** and the **Terms and conditions**. The sign-in and invitation pages remind you that signing in or creating an account means you accept them.

To sign in later, go to the sign-in page, type your email and password, and press **Sign in**.

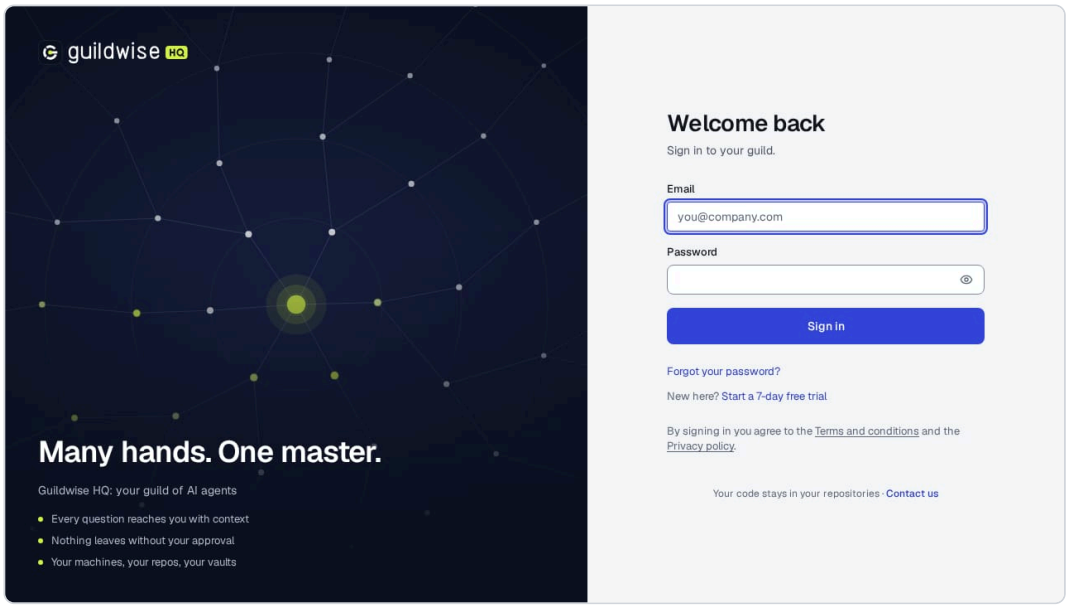


Figure 6 — The sign-in page

A wrong email or password always gives the same message, so nobody can use the page to find out who has an account.

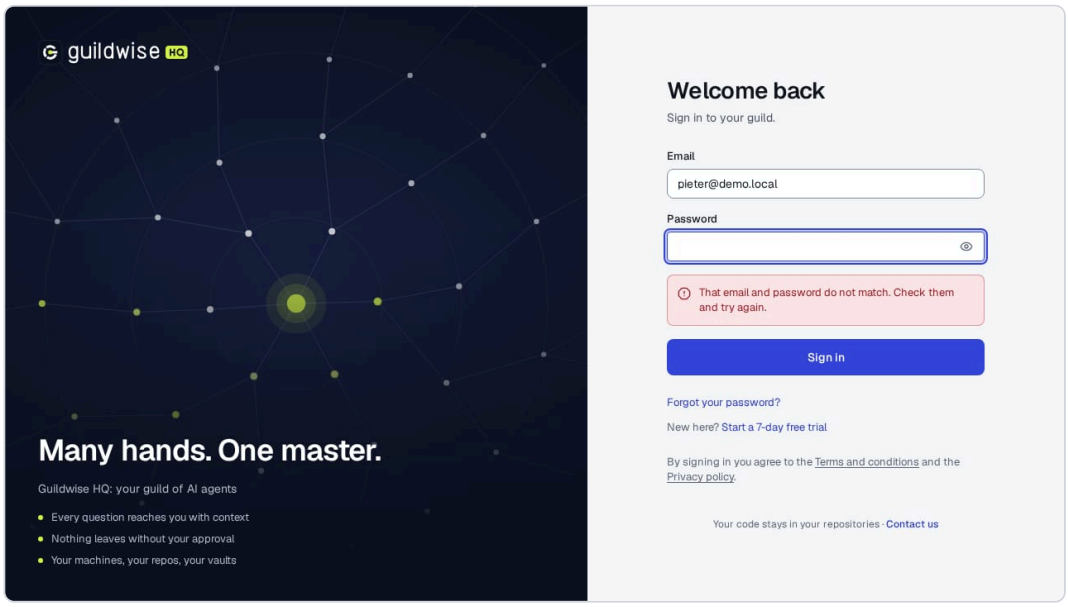


Figure 7 — A wrong password

3.2 Turn on two-factor login (3 minutes)

Two-factor login means that after your password you also type a six-digit code from an app on your phone. Even if somebody learns your password, they cannot get in. It is strongly recommended for everybody, and your Owner may require it.

1. Open your avatar menu at the bottom of the sidebar and choose **Your settings**.
2. On that page, in the **Two-factor login** panel, press **Set up**. Type your password, scan the QR code with an authenticator app (any one will do, for example Google Authenticator, Microsoft Authenticator or 1Password), type the first six-digit code and press **Turn on two-factor login**.

3. You are shown **ten recovery codes, once**. Save them in a password manager or print them. Each code works one time, if you lose your phone.

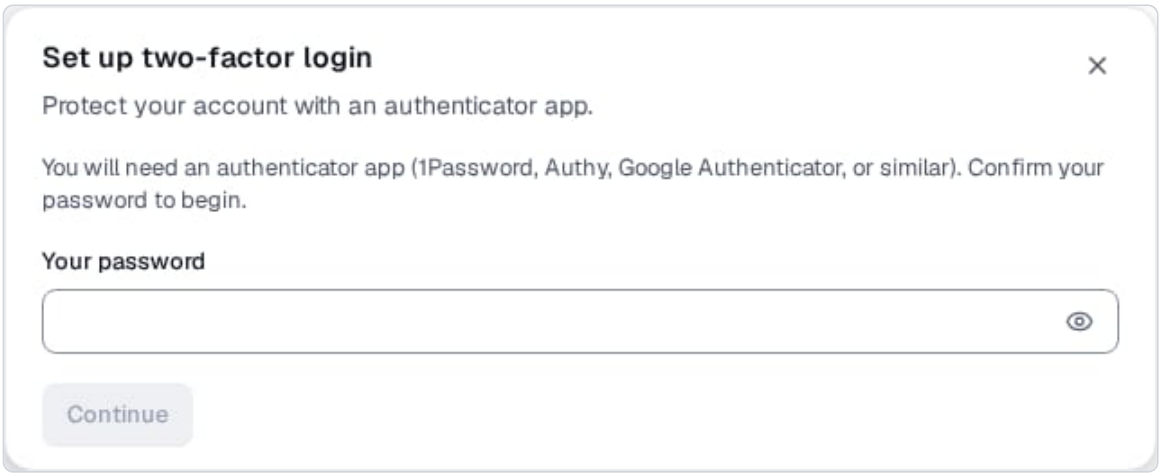


Figure 8 — Setting up two-factor login

> **Watch out**
> The recovery codes are the only way back in if you lose your phone, apart from asking your Owner to reset your two-factor login. Save them now.

> **In the app**
> Help, "Two-factor login" (`/help/two-factor`).

3.3 Take the tour (1 minute)

The first time you sign in, a short guided tour highlights the main areas and tells you what each is for. The tour is different for each role. You can skip it and replay it any time from **Help**; a tour you closed half way does not come back by itself, but **Help** offers to resume it.

The tour walks down the sidebar in order, one step for every entry you have (Board, Backlog, Environments, Research, Desk, Intake, Automations, Projects, Agents, Org chart, CEO, Roles & workflows, Workstations, Releases, Integrations, Metrics, Costs, Interests, Ledger, Vaults, Settings and Organization), then shows the search, the page help, **Ask DevOps** and Help. It takes about three minutes. Appendix A lists the tour step of every section.

The tour starts with the training video: its first step is **Watch the 3-minute getting-started video**, with the player (captions and chapter buttons) in the tour card; press **Next: take the tour** to carry on (the video pauses). The same video is on the **Help** page as **Getting started in five steps**, a spoken tutorial of about three minutes: create a project, hire your agents, create cards, talk to the business analyst, and test the result. If the video file is missing, the first step shows a short text instead.

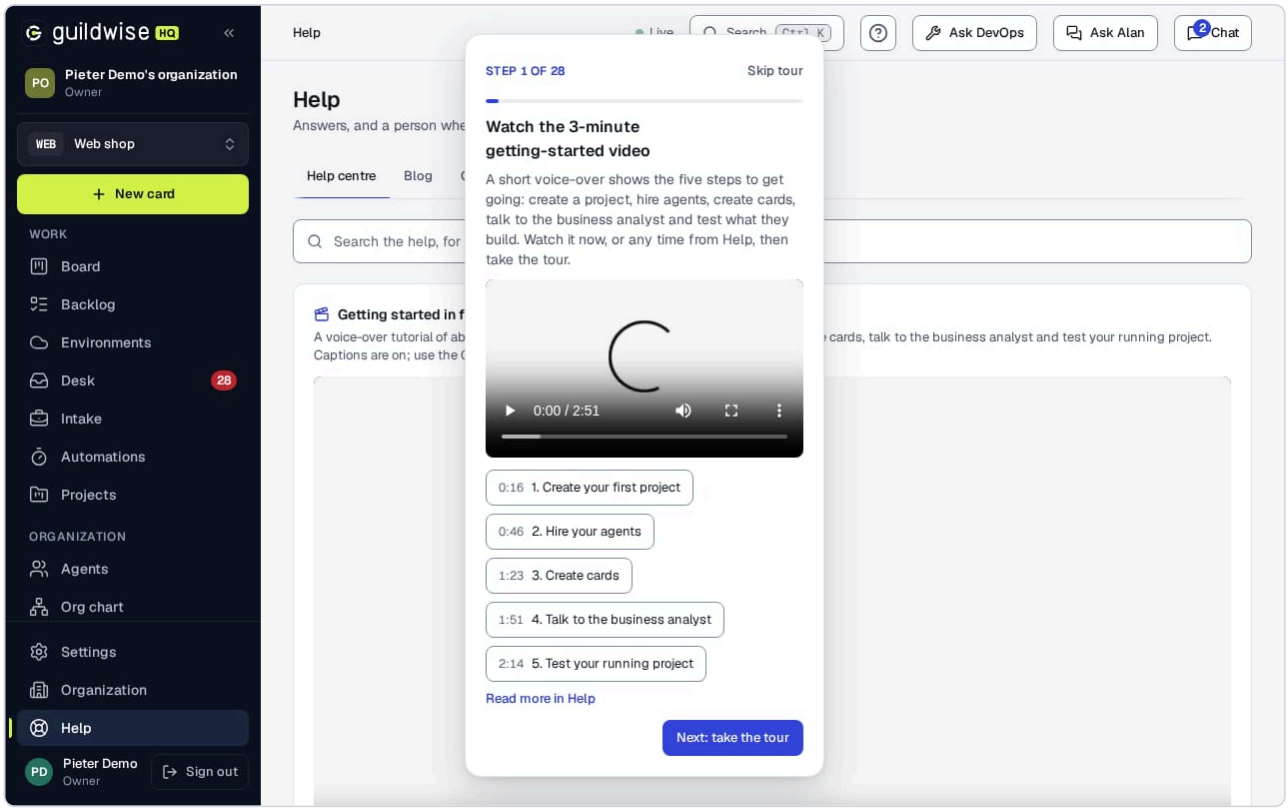


Figure 9 — The first step of the tour

After an update, a window called **What's new in Guildwise HQ** opens the next time you sign in and lists the changes meant for your role, newest first. Click **Got it** to close it; it is remembered for your account, so it does not come back on another device. It never opens on top of the tour, and a brand-new account does not see changes from before it existed. To read the list again, open **Help** and choose **See what's new**.

Three things worth knowing from the start:

- **Search and jump anywhere:** press **Ctrl+K** (on a Mac **Cmd+K**) to open the command palette. Type a project, card, page or action ("contact", "new card") and press Enter.
- **The ? hints:** small question-mark buttons next to headings open the matching help article in a side panel, without leaving your page.
- **On a phone:** the whole app works on a phone. Open the menu with the button at the top left.



Figure 10 — The command palette

> **Your checklist.** The **Get started** button at the bottom of the sidebar lists the five things this chapter walks through (project, repository, workstation, team, talking to the business analyst) and ticks each one by itself as it becomes true. Each step opens the right page. Hide it with **Hide this checklist**; bring it back from **Help**.

3.4 Add a workstation (5 minutes)

A workstation is the computer where your agents will work. The guided installer sets everything up for you.

1. Open **Workstations** in the sidebar and click **Add a workstation**.
2. **Choose where your agents run**: **My computer** (the rest of this section), **A VPS (SSH)** or **GitHub Codespaces** (section 4.19). For your own computer, **pick the system**. The page guesses from your browser (Windows, Linux or macOS). Change it if the machine that will run the agents is a different one. Windows runs the agents inside WSL2, Microsoft's built-in Linux, and the installer turns it on for you. You may also type a name for it ("Office PC").
3. **Copy the command** with the copy button, or choose **Download the script** if you would like to read it first. The command contains a link that is valid for 30 minutes and a one-time pairing code. It never contains a password.
4. **Run it on that computer.** Open a terminal (on Windows, PowerShell), paste the command and press Enter. Say yes when it asks for permission. Windows may ask to restart once. The installer carries on by itself when you sign in again.
5. **Watch the page.** It shows "Waiting for you to run the command", then the installer starting, the computer pairing, and then health checks one by one (Node, git, Claude, the sandbox, Docker, yt-dlp, your repositories, the server), ending with **Ready**.

Pair with a code. If you would rather not paste the long command, use **Pair workstation** at the top of the Workstations page (or **Pair with a code** on an empty page, or **Pair it with a code instead** at the bottom of the wizard). Press **Generate pairing code**, then run the command it shows on the machine that will host your agents; the page updates when the runner connects.

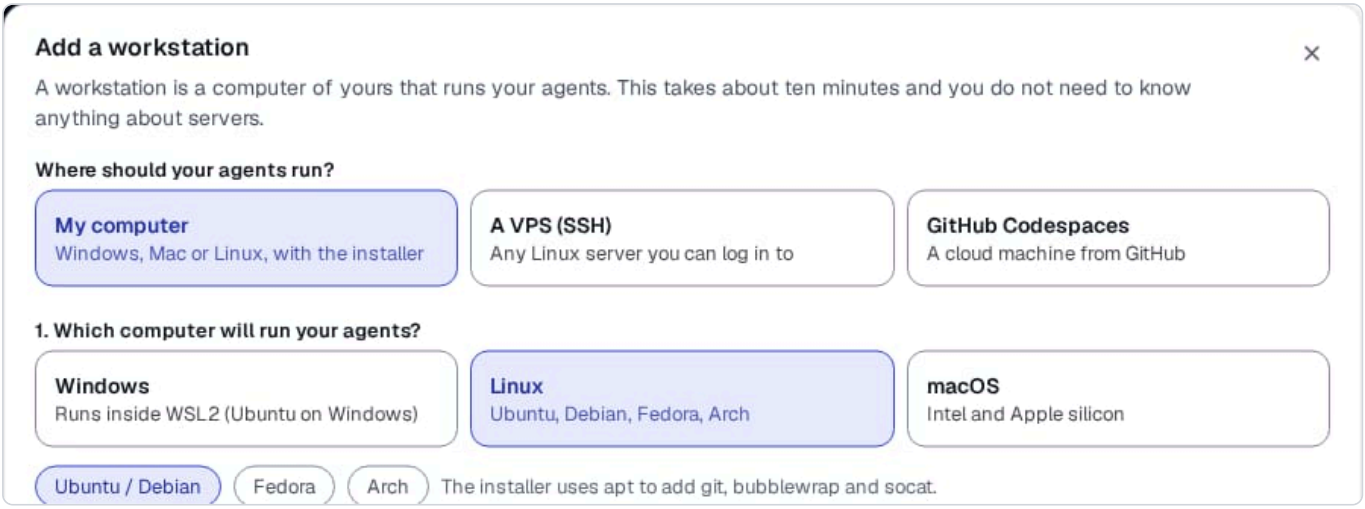


Figure 11 — The installer wizard, step 1: choose the computer

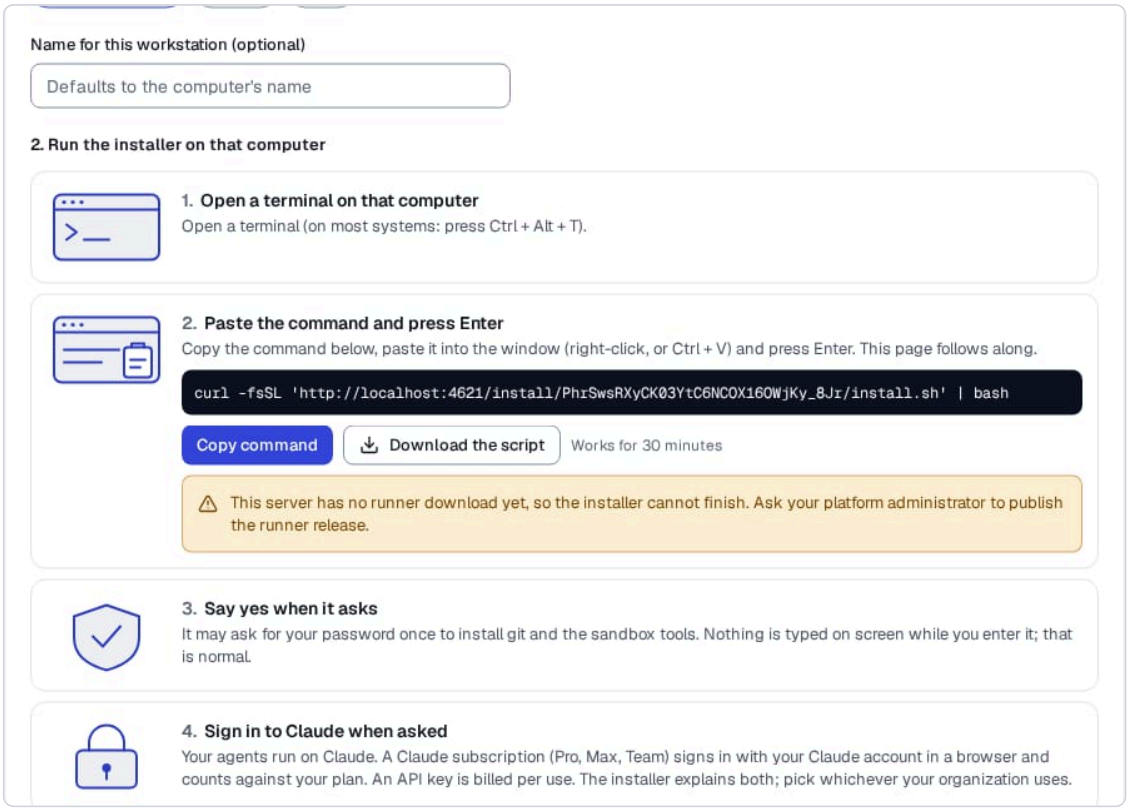


Figure 12 — The installer wizard, step 3: the command to run

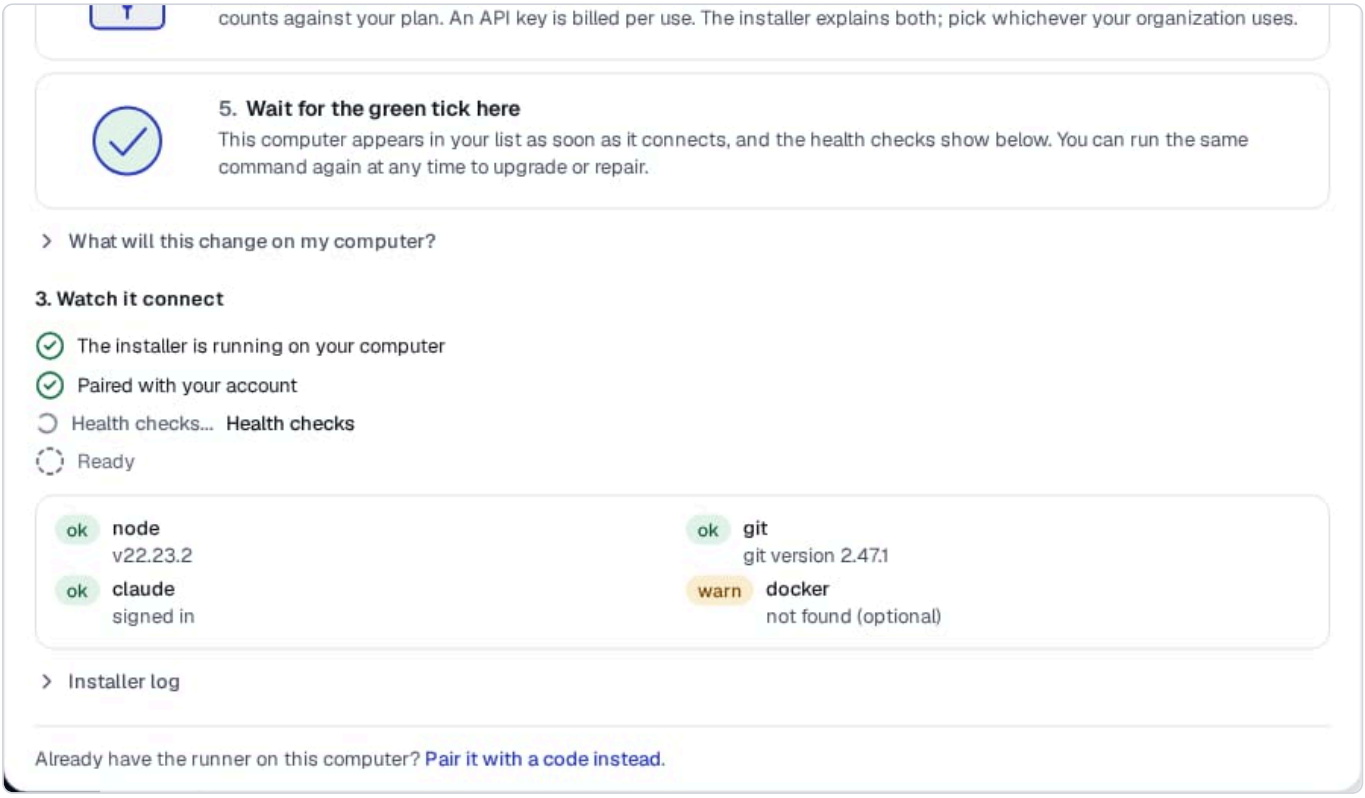


Figure 13 — The installer wizard while it works: pairing and health checks

The installer asks only what it must: your password once to install system tools, whether you want the optional extras (yt-dlp for transcripts of videos and podcasts; Docker only if your tests run containers), and how Claude should sign in. Your code lives in `~/src`; the installer asks about the folder only in expert mode (Settings) or with `--choose-folders`. It explains the two ways in plain words. Choose **Claude subscription** if you have one: you sign in with your Claude account in a browser. Choose **API key** if you would rather pay for exactly what the agents use.

> **Good to know**
> You can run the same command again at any time. It upgrades the runner, repairs a broken installation and keeps your existing pairing.

The runner updates itself. Once installed, the runner checks once a day (and a few minutes after it starts) whether the server offers a newer version. It downloads and checks it, then waits until no agent is working on that workstation before restarting into it, so a running job is never cut short (after about six hours of being busy it updates anyway). The Workstations page shows the runner version and, when there is something to know, a label: *Update pending*, *Updating*, *Update failed*, *Update rolled back* (the new version did not connect within a few minutes, so the runner went back to the previous one by itself), *Updates paused* (a platform administrator paused automatic updates) or *Updates by hand* (this runner was not started by the installer's service). Platform administrators pause and resume automatic updates under **Runners** in the platform area. To not wait for the daily check, press **Check for updates** next to the runner version: the runner looks right away and the page tells you the result (*Up to date*, *Update found: installs when idle*, *Updates are paused* …). It still waits until no agent is working before it restarts. The button needs runner 0.1.34 or newer and a connected workstation; an older runner checks by itself once a day. You can still run the install command again at any time, and set `AOM_RUNNER_AUTO_UPDATE=0` for the runner to switch updating off on one computer.

If something goes wrong, the installer says what happened and links to the install help and to **Contact us**. Chapter 9.1 covers the usual problems.

> **In the app**
> Help, "Workstations and the installer" (`/help/workstations-and-installer`) and "Installing a workstation: if something goes wrong" (`/help/install-troubleshooting`).

3.4a Connect your integrations

Once the workstation is paired, open **Integrations** in the sidebar (or the **Integrations** button on the workstation's card). With several workstations you choose one first. Each tile is one connection with its status: *Connected*, *Not connected*, *Refused*, *Expired*, *Needs sign-in*, *Unreachable*, *Tool missing* or *Not needed*; it also shows who it is signed in as, the scopes (missing ones in amber), when it expires and when it was last checked. **Connect**, **Replace**, **Test** and **Remove** are on the tile; "How to set it up" lists the steps with links to where the token is made, and "From a terminal" gives the command for a machine without a browser.

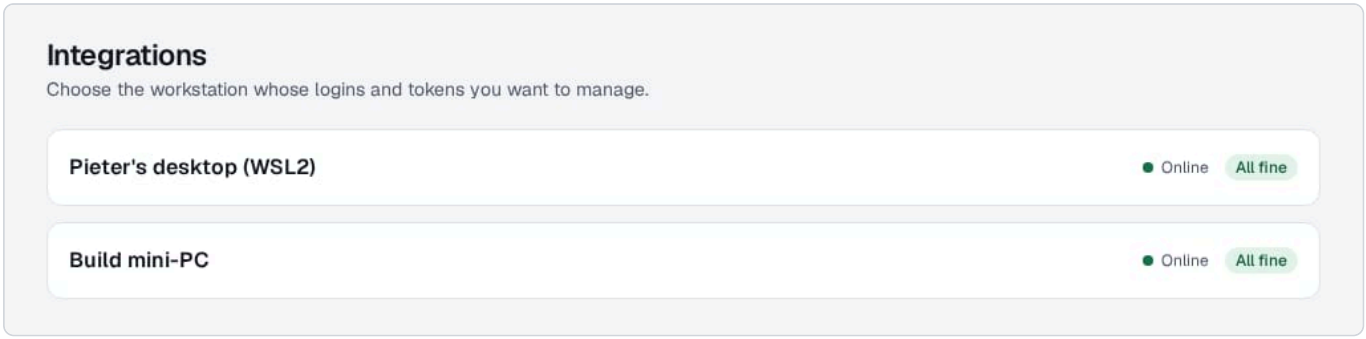


Figure 14 — The Integrations page: pick a workstation

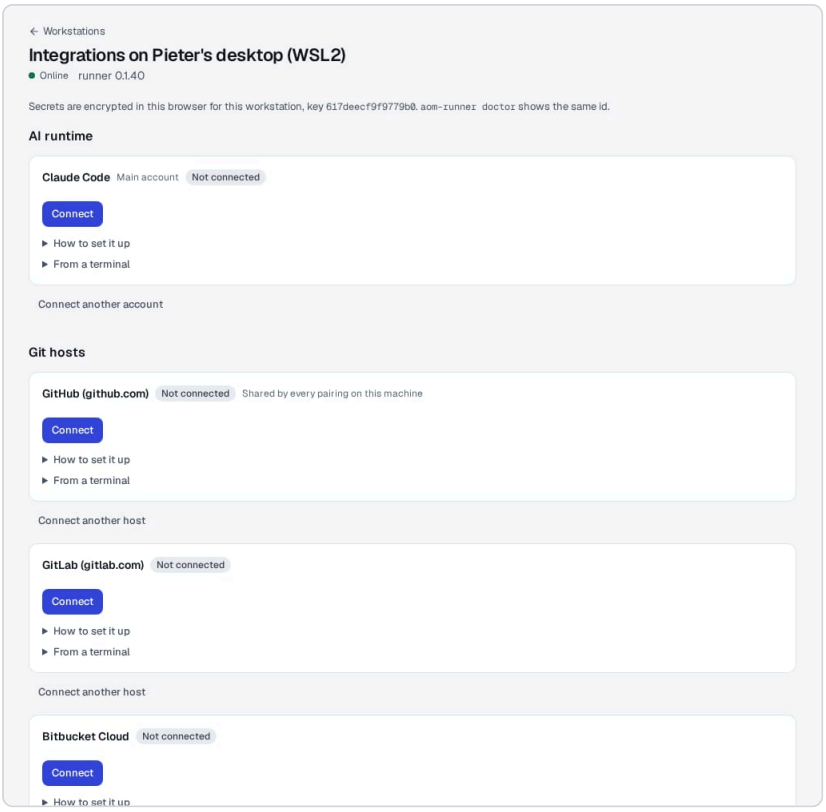


Figure 15 — The Integrations of one workstation: each connection is a tile with its status

What you type is **sealed in your browser** with a key that belongs to that workstation (the page shows the key id; `aom-runner doctor` shows the same id) and only the workstation can open it. Guildwise relays it and cannot read it; it is checked with the provider on the workstation and saved there only when the provider accepts it. If you would rather never send a credential from the browser, run `aom-runner integrations allow-web off` on the workstation: the page then says it is turned off there and you use the terminal commands.

- **Claude Code.** *Sign in with your Claude subscription*: **Connect**, open the link, sign in at claude.ai, copy the code the page shows and paste it back. The workstation keeps a year-long token and switches to it by itself; agents wait no longer for a login that expired. Or paste an **Anthropic API key** (best for a cloud workstation), or a token made elsewhere with `claude setup-token`. A subscription is for your own use. There is one Claude tile for each account of the workstation: the main account and one for every project account (4.24a). Add another with **Connect another account**.
- **GitHub.** *Sign in with a code*: the page shows a code and a link; enter the code at GitHub and approve. Or paste a classic personal access token (`repo`, `read:org`, `gist`).
- **GitLab, Azure DevOps.** Paste a personal access token (GitLab: `api` and `write_repository`; Azure DevOps: an organization-scoped token with Code read and write and Project and Team read). GitLab shows the expiry.
- **Bitbucket Cloud.** Your Atlassian e-mail and an API token with the five Bitbucket scopes the tile lists. A refusal names the missing scope.
- **Jira.** The base URL, your Atlassian e-mail and a classic API token ("Create API token", not "with scopes"). Leave the e-mail empty for a Data Center personal access token.
- **MCP servers** (from Claude Code plugins). Each server has a tile with **Sign in** (**Sign in again** once signed in) and **Sign out**. **Sign in** opens the provider's link. When you have signed in, the provider sends you to an address that starts with `http://localhost`. If your browser is not on the workstation that page does not load: that is expected. Copy the whole address from the address bar and paste it into the field. (If the browser is on the workstation itself, it finishes by itself.)
- **SSH keys** show the status and the public key to add; create and choose keys in **Workstations**, Git hosts.

Some logins belong to the whole computer (the `gh` login, `~/.claude`, MCP sign-ins) and are shared by every pairing on it; the tile says so, and from the web they can be changed only through the computer's primary pairing. The same

page is where the notices *Claude login expired* and *needs sign-in* on your desk lead to: **Sign in from the web**.

> **In the app**
> Help, "Integrations" (`/help/integrations`).

3.5 Hire your first agents (2 minutes)

You need at least a builder, a reviewer and a tester to get a card from idea to done. The BA is also strongly recommended. New projects use the lean team workflow (4.26), which also uses a planner, an architect and a pre-reviewer: hire those too for the intended cost, until then the architect plans and the reviewer does the pre-review.

1. Open **Agents** and click **Hire agent**.
2. Choose a **Role**: *Builder* writes the change, *Reviewer* checks it, *Tester* runs the tests, *BA* writes cards (your CEO writes the reports), *Writer* documents, *Planner* does a short code-research pass before design, *Pre-reviewer* checks the basics before the review. A senior *Architect* designs every card on the lean team workflow (4.20, 4.26). Choose **Seniority**: seniors take larger and riskier work and may review large changes. Pick the **Workstation** where the agent runs.
3. Choose where the agent may work: **Any project**, or **Selected projects** (the allow-list). For now keep the project you will create next, or any project.
4. Choose the **Runtime** (the AI engine the agent uses), the **Model** and the **Effort** (how hard it thinks) : a bigger model or a higher effort is smarter and costs more; a smaller one is fast and cheap. A good start is a stronger model for builders and BAs and a lighter one for reviewers and testers. Give the agent a **Name**. The name generator suggests unused names; pick a theme or type your own.
5. Click **Hire**. Repeat for each role.

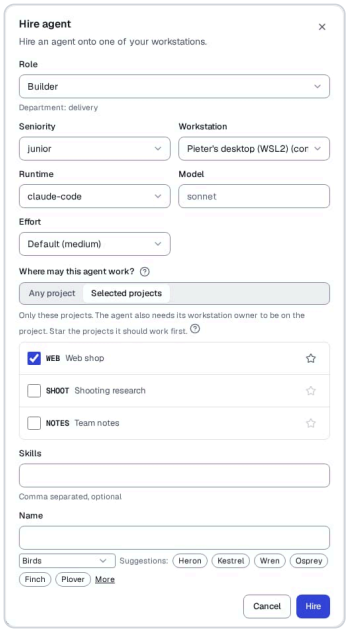


Figure 16 — Hiring an agent

> **Tip**
> Two builders and one each of reviewer, tester and BA is a comfortable first team. Large changes need two different senior reviewers, so hire a second senior reviewer when you get to bigger work. Review and Finalize need seniors.

Each workstation also gets a free **DevOps engineer** automatically. You never hire or fire it.

> **In the app**
> Help, "Agents" (`/help/agents`).

3.6 Create your first project (1 minute)

1. Open **Projects** and click **New project** (Owners and Admins only).
2. Give it a **Name** and a short **Key** (for example `WEB`; card references look like `WEB-1`). Choose the **Workflow**: **Code** for software, **Research** for investigations, or a custom workflow your organization designed. Click **Create project**.
3. For a code project, open the project's **Settings** (the gear on the Projects page) and, under **Repositories**, add your repository: a name and the address of your code (or create a new one). The git host (GitHub, GitLab, Bitbucket, Azure DevOps or a plain git server) is detected from the address, and you can pick another one. If the app lives in a folder of the repository (a monorepo, `src/app`), fill in **Project path**; leave it empty when the app is at the top. Each repository has a **Main branch** (where pull requests go) and a **Working branch** (where finished work is combined), both the repository's default branch unless you change them; finished work is committed and pushed to the working branch automatically after review and test, and you can change **How finished work lands** in the same settings (see 4.4). A research project needs no repository.

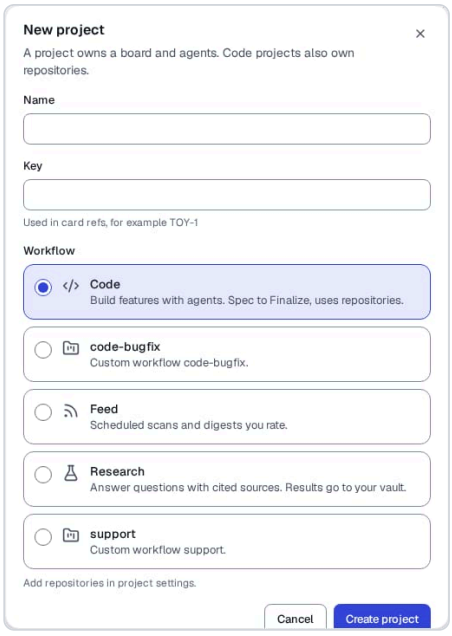


Figure 17 — The new project dialog

> **In the app**
> Help, "Projects" (`/help/projects`).

3.7 Create your first card (2 minutes)

1. Open the project's board and click **New card**.
2. Fill in the form. Be concrete, as if you were briefing a new colleague:
   - **Title:** what it is ("Show the last login time on the profile page").
   - **Context:** why it matters.
   - **Requirements:** what must be done.
   - **Acceptance criteria:** how you will know it is done, one line each.
   - **Affected areas, Constraints, Test plan:** what to touch and not to touch, and how to check it.
   - **How it lands:** you do not need to choose. Finished work goes where the project's **How finished work lands** setting says (committed and pushed to the working branch, or as a pull request you approve). With expert mode on (see 4.4) the form also offers a per-card **Completion action**.
3. Click **Specify**. The card moves to **To do** and the agents pick it up. If a required field is missing, the form tells you which. Use **Save draft** if you want to finish later. Through the API, a card created with `specify: true` that lacks

required fields is still saved as a draft, and the answer says so: `specified: false`, a `message` and the `missing` fields.

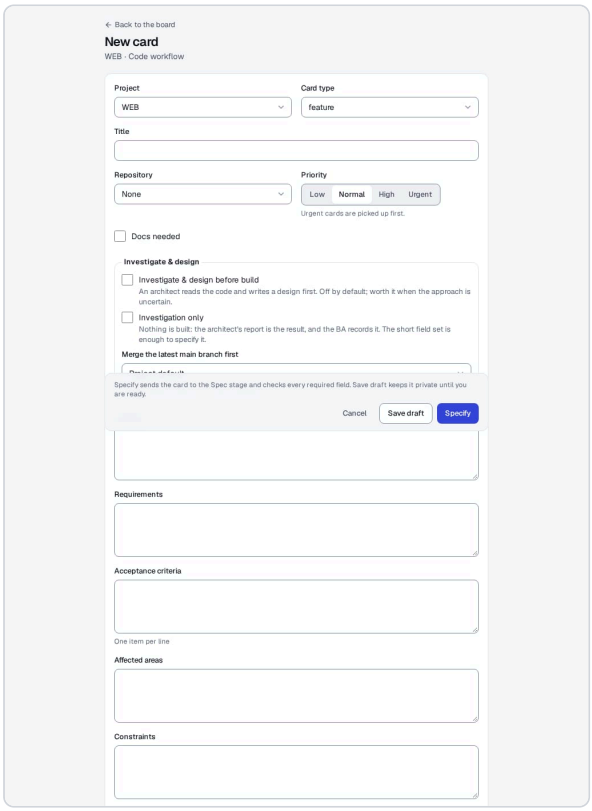


Figure 18 — The New card form

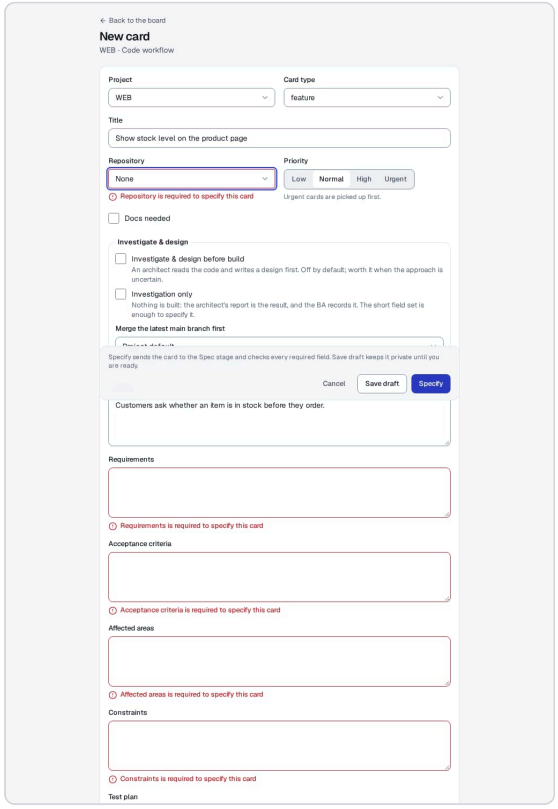


Figure 19 — The form tells you which fields are still missing

> **Tip**
> You do not have to write it all yourself. Open a chat with the BA ("Chat" button on the desk), say what you want in your own words, and the BA drafts and specifies the cards for you.

Attachments. A card can carry files: screenshots, a design (SVG, PDF), a spec, a log. On the New card form use **Attachments, Add files**; on an open card use the **Attachments** section (drag files in or choose **Add files**; images show as previews; **Download** and **Remove** are on each file). The card owner and the project owner can add and remove files; every member of the project can look and download. Limits: 20 MB per file, 100 MB and 50 files per card; images, SVG, PDF, zip, Office files and text are accepted, programs and scripts are refused. Builders, reviewers and testers get the files as read-only copies next to their shift and can look at them (an agent can view an image), so say in the card what each file shows. The BA attaches the files of a Jira ticket to the cards it drafts and says which went where.

3.8 Watch it happen

Within a minute the card moves to **Build**. A builder works on it, then a reviewer, then a tester. Open the card to follow along: the **Live shift** panel shows what the agent is doing right now, **Handoffs** shows the notes agents leave for each other, and **Timeline** records every step.

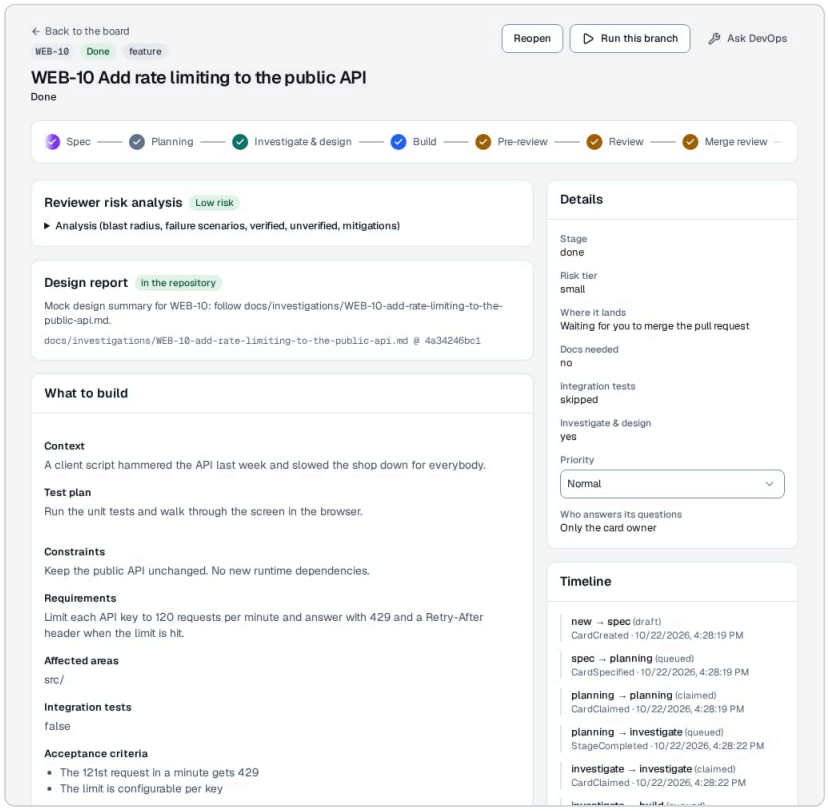


Figure 20 — A card in the middle of a shift

When an agent needs a decision, the card turns **Blocked** and the question appears on your **Desk**. Answer it and work continues. When the card is done, the card says where the change went: *"Your change is live on main"*, or *"Waiting for you to merge the pull request"* if the project works with pull requests.

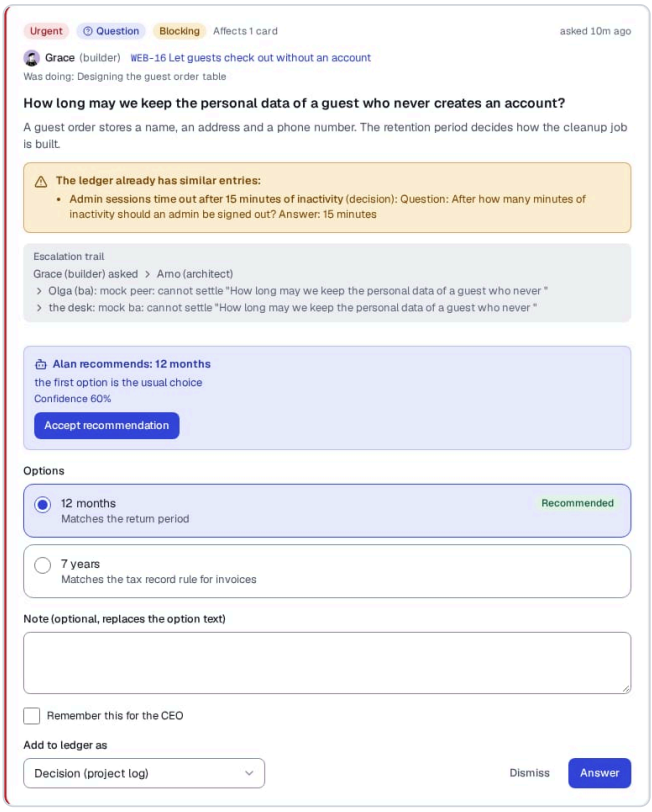


Figure 21 — A question waiting on the desk

You now have a working team. The rest of this guide is for when you want more: more control, more automation, or more safety.

4. For Owners and Admins

The **Owner** runs the organization: there is exactly one, and the Owner can hand the role to someone else. **Admins** are appointed by the Owner and help manage. This chapter covers everything the two roles do. Where something is only for the Owner, it says so.

	Owner	Admin
Create projects, add people to projects, change project settings	yes	yes
See every project of the organization	yes	yes
Invite Members	yes	yes
Invite, promote or demote Admins; change roles	yes	no
Remove Members	yes	yes
Remove Admins	yes	no
Hire, change and fire any agent, widen an agent's permissions	yes	yes
Set budgets, see Costs	yes	yes
Design roles, workflows and departments	yes	yes
Org-wide automations, interests quiet cap	yes	yes
Talk to and configure the CEO	yes	read its page and activity log, pause it
See plan and limits	yes	yes
Require two-factor login for everybody	yes	no
Hand over ownership	yes	no

4.1 Your organization

Open **Organization** at the bottom of the sidebar. The tabs are **General**, **Members**, **Invitations**, **Guests**, **E-mail inbox**, **Project links**, **Plan & limits** and (Owner only) **Billing**. The **General** tab shows the organization's name (rename it here), who the Owner is and **Your role**, the security switch for two-factor login (4.15), **Transfer ownership** (Owner, asks for your password) and **Leave organization**. Where the platform offers it, a **Share diagnostic data** switch lets the CEO send general research topics to Guildwise (4.22); it is not yet available to customer organizations.

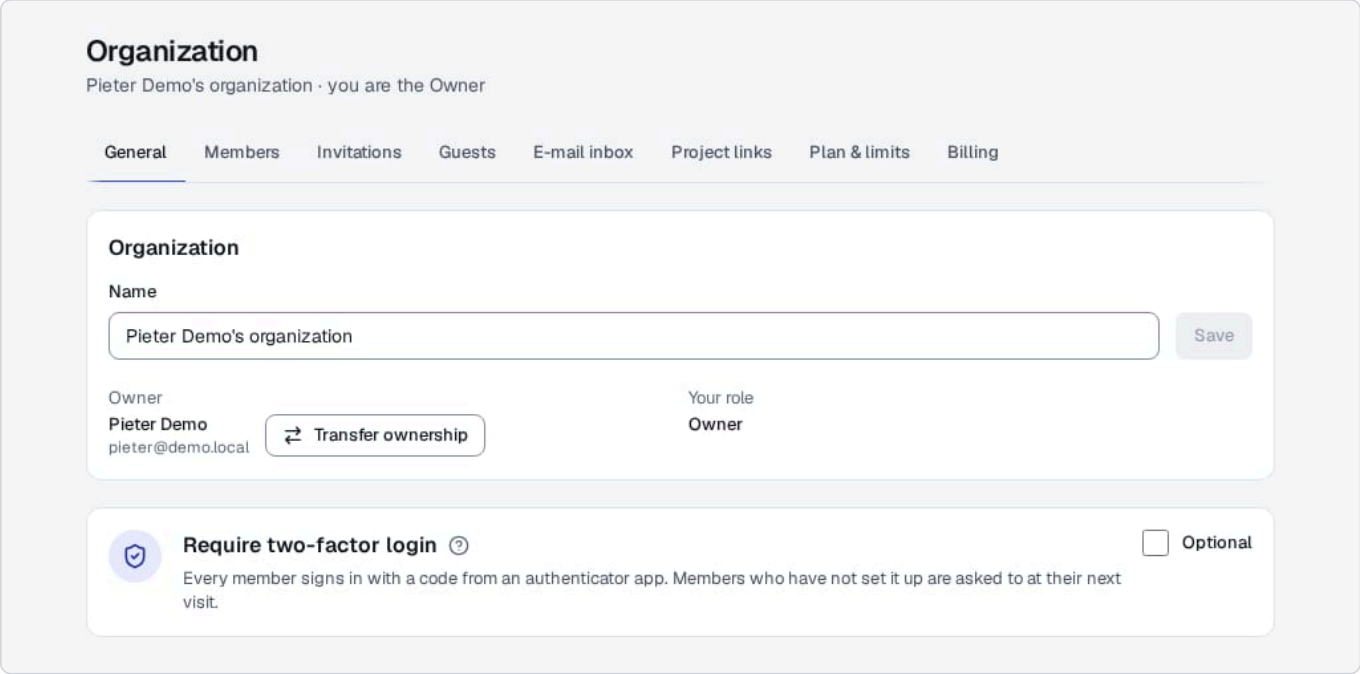


Figure 22 — Organization settings: General

Project links. Owners and Admins find the **Project links** tab on the same page (Organization, then **Project links**). Here you tell Guildwise how your projects belong together: add a link between two projects, or between a project and something outside Guildwise (type its name). A link says that one **depends on**, **uses** or **is related to** the other, with an optional note. **Remove** takes a link away. The CEO reads these links, with the project names, to decide which project a request is for. The tab lists only the links you add. What the code suggests stays on your workstation: the CEO can show those suggestions in chat, and they count only after you add the link here.

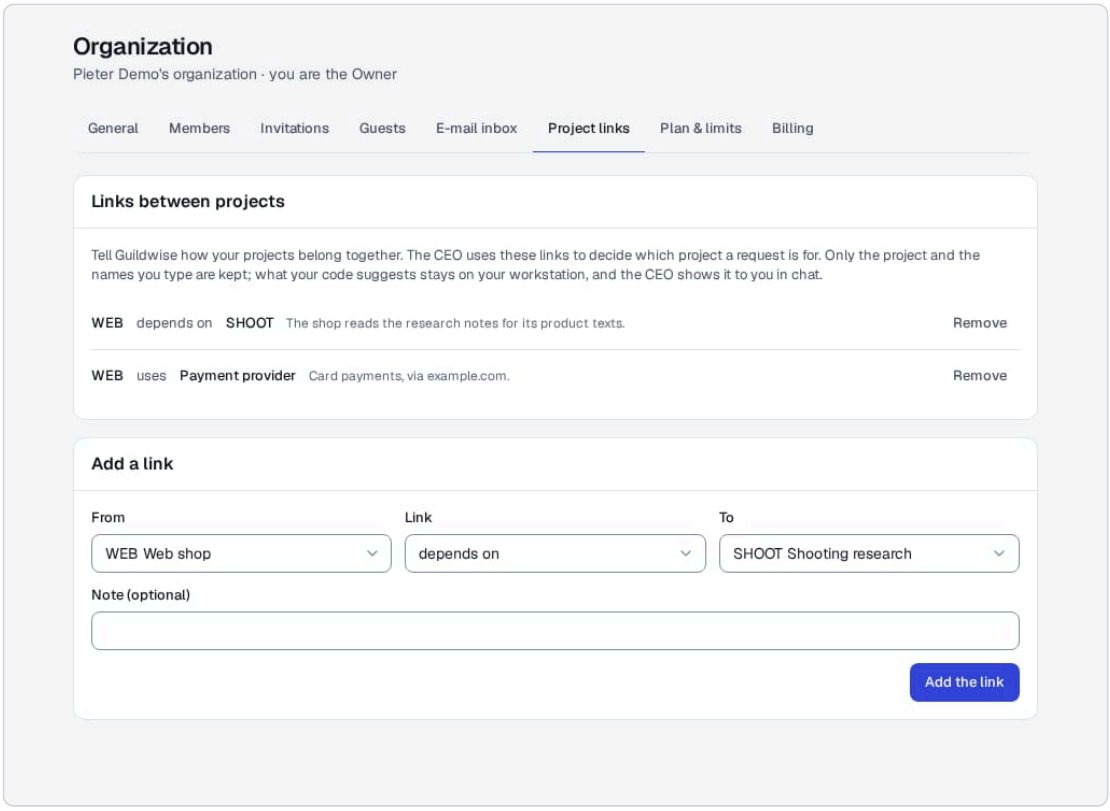


Figure 23 — The Project links tab of the organization

If you belong to several organizations, the **organization switcher** at the top of the sidebar shows which one this browser tab works in. A different tab can work in a different organization. Projects of an organization where you are

only a guest carry a "Guest" label.

4.2 Members, invitations and guests

On **Organization, Members** you see everybody with their role.

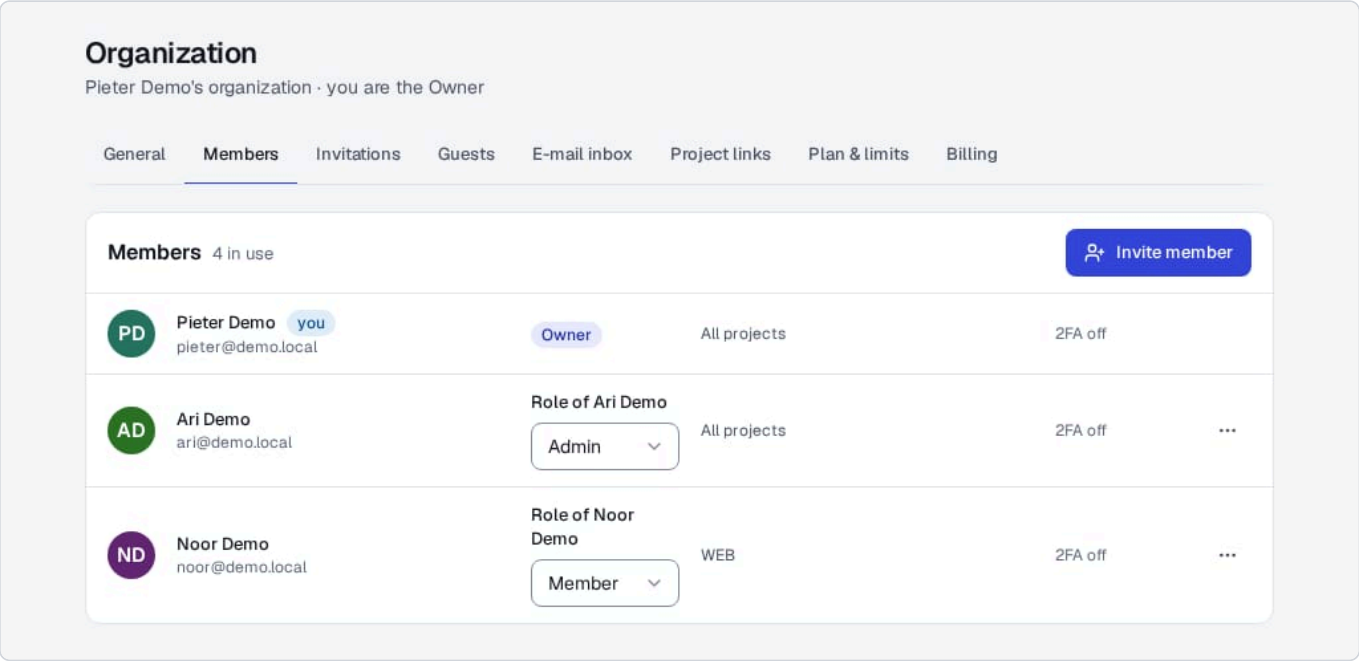


Figure 24 — The Members tab

To invite someone: click **Invite member**, type their email, choose the role (**Member**, or **Admin** if you are the Owner) and, if you like, the projects they should start on, then **Send invitation**. They receive an email with a link that works for 7 days. On the **Invitations** tab you can see pending and past invitations, resend one or revoke one.

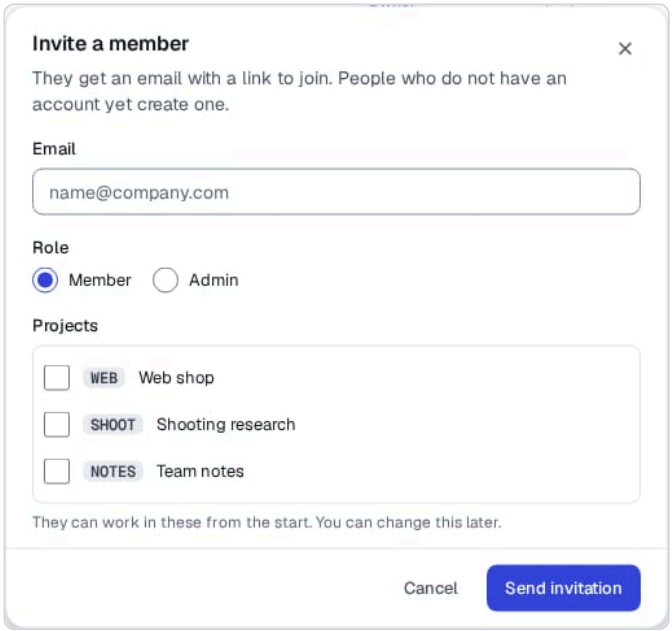


Figure 25 — Inviting a member

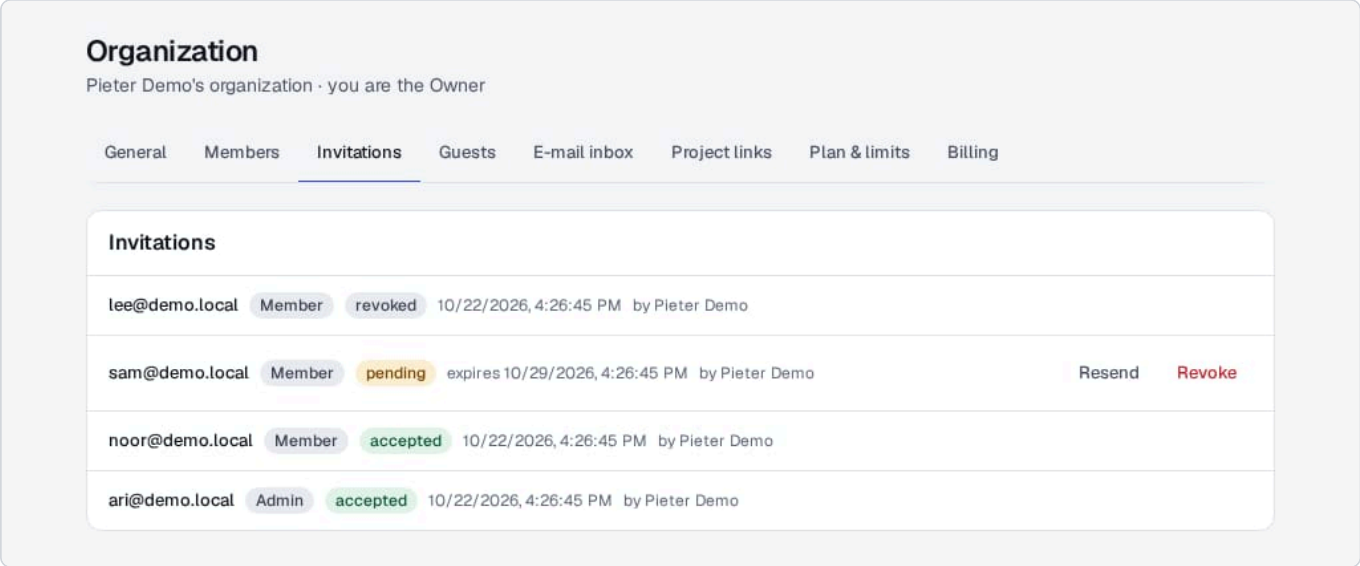


Figure 26 — The Invitations tab

To change a role or remove a person: use the role selector and the remove button in the Members list. When somebody is removed, their agents are handed to you and any cards those agents held go back into the queue. Anyone except the Owner can leave an organization. The Owner must hand over ownership first (**General, Transfer ownership**, which asks for your password).

Guests are people from other organizations who work in a project you shared. The **Guests** tab lists them and the projects they can reach (see 4.3, sharing a project).

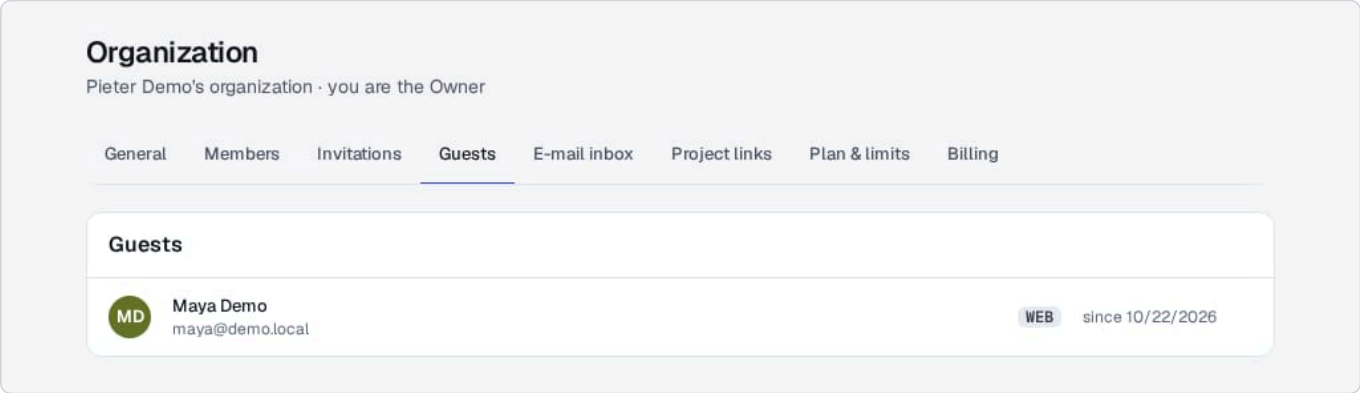


Figure 27 — The Guests tab

> **In the app**
> Help, "Organizations and roles" (`/help/organizations-and-roles`).

4.3 Projects

Create a project as in chapter 3.6. A new project goes to the bottom of your priority order (see below). Everything about a project lives in its **Settings** (the gear on the Projects page).

Put your projects in order. The **Projects** page lists your organization's projects, most important first. When an agent looks for its next card, it takes work in this order: scheduled work first (schedules, interest scans and an on-demand **Research this**), then cards that came back to it for rework, then the **project order** (the card of the project higher up first), and then the card's own priority, how long it has waited and its dependencies. An agent's **focus** projects (4.4) are a gentle preference ahead of the order. A shift that has started is never interrupted: a more important card waits for it to end.

Owners and Admins change the order by **dragging** a project by its grip (the dotted handle on the left), or with the **Move up** and **Move down** buttons on each row. With the grip selected, the up and down arrow keys move it as well, and Home and End send it to the top or the bottom. The order saves by itself. Members and Guests see the order but cannot change it. Archived projects are not ranked, and the hidden projects behind interests never appear: interests run on their own schedule and are not ranked.

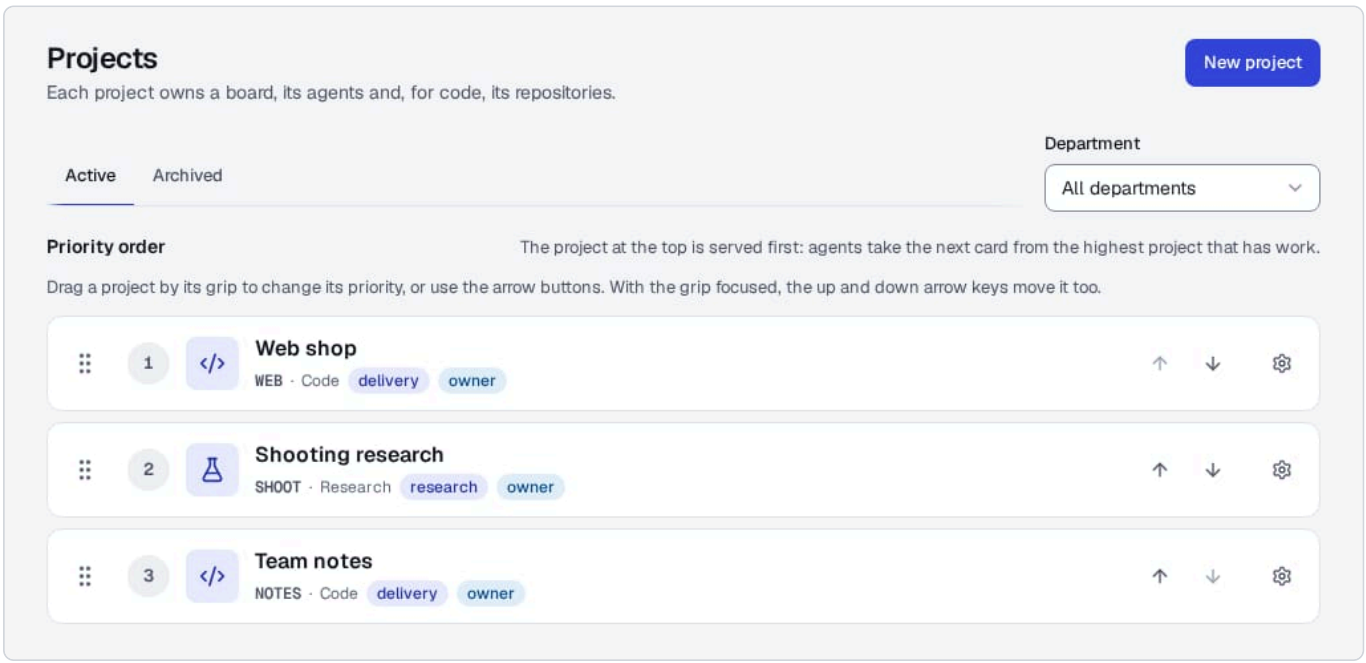


Figure 28 — The Projects page in priority order

Good to know

There is no work/personal split any more. "Personal" simply means your own organization: keep personal projects in it, or in an organization of your own that you switch to. If your organization had a personal vault and personal projects from before, they were merged for you: the projects sit below your work projects in the order they had, and the personal vault's files are under `personal/` in the organization vault. The desk note you received says what happened.

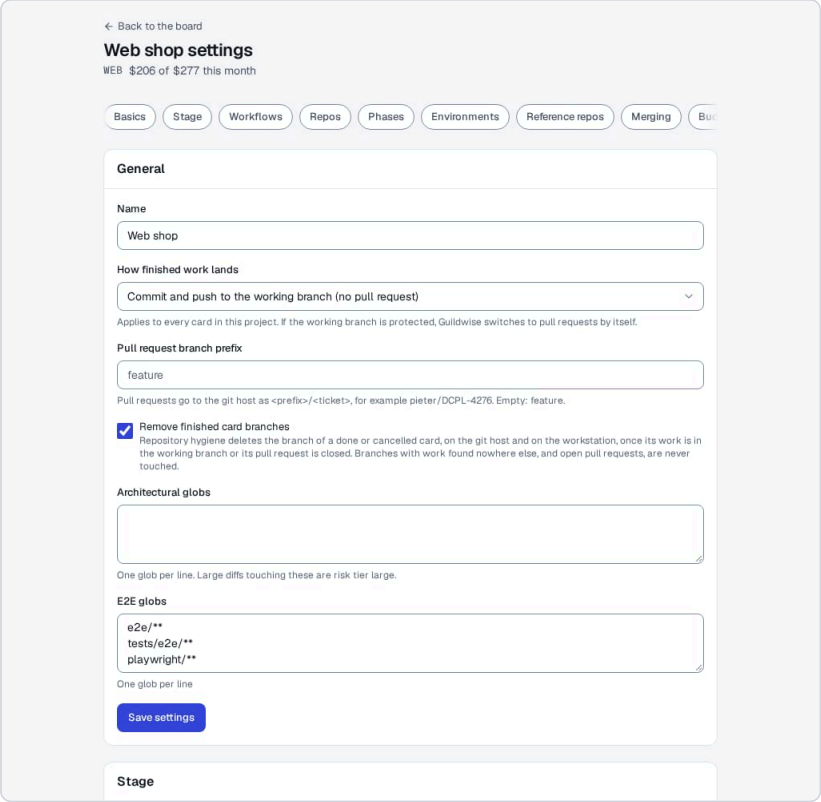


Figure 29 — Project settings

What you will find there:

- **Repos:** the code the agents work on, with its git host, its **Main branch** and **Working branch** (4.4) and its **Project path**: the folder of the repository the app lives in (empty: the repository root). The owner can change the path with **Change**, and how the repository is reached (**Access**: the workstation default, an API token / CLI login, or an SSH key); the development environment check, the package installs and the agents' build and test commands then run from that folder. After changing it, click **Check again** under the development environment. Research projects need none.
- **Reference repositories:** other repositories your agents may **read**, in card work and in chats, so they can compare code or look up how something is done elsewhere. The owner picks them under **Add a reference repository**: the repositories of the organization's other projects (organization Owners and Admins see every project's repositories, everyone else the projects they belong to, listed under **Projects**), or **any repository cloned on one of your workstations**, even one that is not in a project (listed under **On <workstation name>**; a clone without a remote shows as "no remote"). **Remove** takes one away. Nothing is added on its own: only what you pick is opened. The agents get them read-only on every workstation that has them cloned: they cannot change them, and secret files inside (`.env` files, keys, certificates) stay blocked. Every repository you do not pick stays blocked, and so does everything else on the workstation, including this platform's own code.
- **MCP servers:** external tools such as Jira or Confluence for your agents, taken from the **Claude Code plugins** installed and enabled on your workstation (the runner reports them; nothing secret is sent). Only the **organization Owner** can grant a server to a project, under **Grant an MCP server**; **Remove** takes it away; everyone on the project can read the list. Two things are needed before an agent can use a server: the grant here **and** the server in the agent's tool permissions, either through a custom role (Organization, Roles, "What it may do", "External tools") or, for any hired agent including the built-in roles, the **External tools (MCP)** switches on its card on the Agents page (see "External tools (MCP)" under the Agents page; only the Owner can switch them on). Agents then work with the access your signed-in plugin has, so a server whose tools can write, send or delete lets an agent change data in that service as you. Each server carries a warning (judged from its tool names when they are known, otherwise a general one): prefer read-only use and grant such servers only to roles you trust with it. The tools an

agent called are listed on the card under **External tools used**. The DevOps engineer is not affected. Claude.ai connectors and servers you added by hand are not offered yet.

- **Code map for agents:** the status of the project's code map, and **Index again** (4.3a).
- **Architect:** whether new cards are investigated and designed before they are built (off by default), whether the latest main branch is merged first (on by default) and where the architect's reports go (4.20).
- **Commit as:** the name and e-mail every commit of the project carries, so the work reads as yours. Read-only work (planning, reviews) never needs one. Leave it empty to use the repository's own git setting, then your workstation's global one. The page shows which one each workstation uses; with none set, nothing is committed and the desk says so. Agents never commit under their own names.

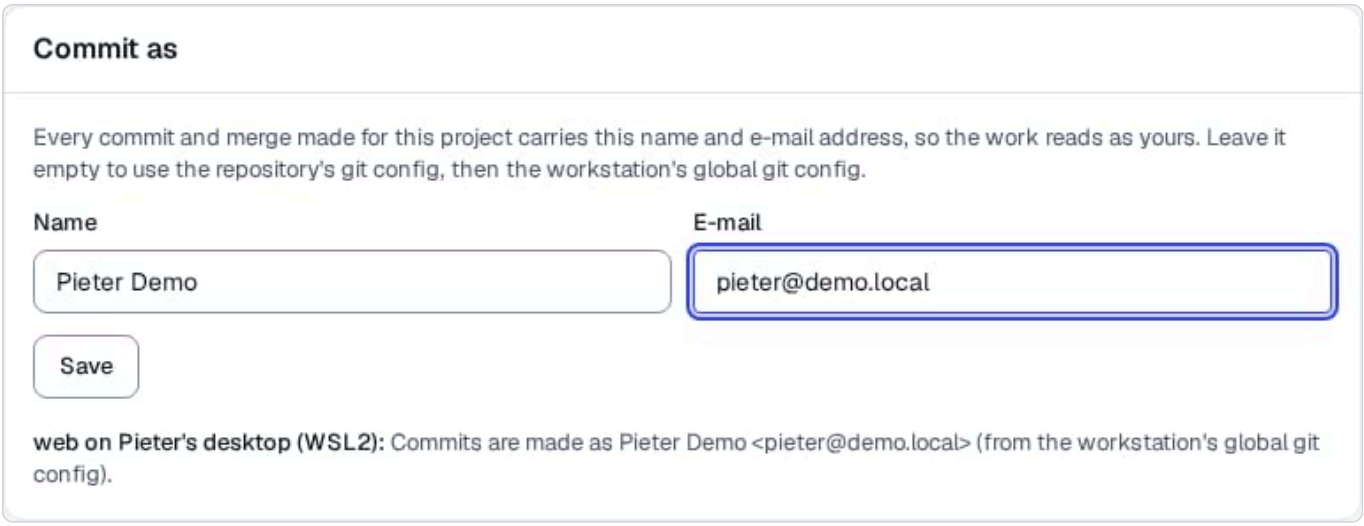


Figure 30 — The Commit as panel in the project settings

- **How finished work lands: Commit and push to the working branch** (the default; no pull request) or **Pull request I approve** (4.4).
- **Team:** who works in the project (see below).
- **Merging:** the setting **Merge large changes without my approval** (off by default). Read chapter 4.12 before turning it on.
- **Simultaneous shifts:** an optional cap on how many shifts may run at once in this project.
- **Workflows:** which workflows the project runs and your own steps in them (4.7).
- **Claude account:** a second Claude subscription for the project (4.24a).
- **Owner approval after the review:** *large and high-risk cards* (the default) or *every card* (4.26).
- **Manual QA before done:** whether a finalized card waits for a person's test (4.12).
- **Testing and decisions:** testing without an environment (4.5), keeping the project's decisions at project level, and **Full test run after each card** (4.26).
- **Pull request branch prefix** and **Remove finished card branches:** how a pull request branch is named and whether finished branches are tidied up (4.4).
- **Budget** (4.6), **Phases** (4.10), **Environments** (4.27), **Stage** (4.13) and **Archive** (4.14). The page has jump chips at the top for Basics, Stage, Workflows, Repos, Phases, Environments, Reference repos, Merging, Budget, Team and Archive.

Who answers a card's questions. By default only the card's creator answers them. On the card page you can let any project member answer (**Who answers its questions**).

Project types. A **code** project follows Spec, Build, Review, Test and Finalize. A **research** project follows Question, Research, Fact check and Publish and writes its results as notes into the project's vault folder. Your organization can also design its own workflows (4.7).

Adding people to a project. Only Owners and Admins add people. Add an organization member under **Team** in the project settings. They get access at once. To share with somebody from another organization (a guest), type the email of an existing account in **Invite by email** and click **Send invitation**. They accept in the **Project invitations** inbox on their Projects page, and they only ever see this project. There are no guests without an organization. Someone with no account must be invited as a Member of your organization instead.

> **Watch out**
> Removing a person from their last project hands their agents back to you (they need a new home on one of your workstations). Cards those agents held go back into the queue.

Vaults. A vault is a folder of notes. Most are git repositories that sync to your workstations; a project's vault can also be a local folder (see "Project vaults and the code map" below). Agents read it (never write it directly) in card work, chats, questions and the BA's tasks. There are two kinds: the **organization vault** (your organization's knowledge, including your interests under `interests/`, shared among Owners and Admins) and a **project vault** (shared with the project's members). Agents read a project's git vault first, then the organization vault, then the project's local folder. Register git vaults under **Vaults** in the sidebar. The address must not contain a password or token. Use an SSH key or a credential helper on the workstation instead.

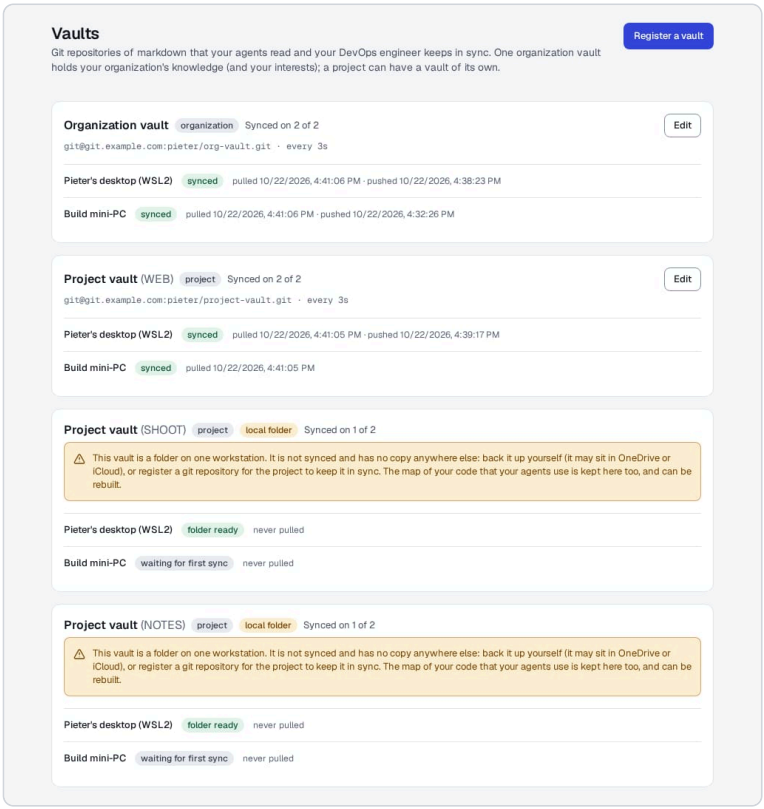


Figure 31 — Vaults

> **In the app**
> Help, "Projects" (`/help/projects`) and "Ledger and vaults" (`/help/ledger-and-vaults`).

4.3a Project vaults and the code map

Every project has a vault. It is created with the project. A vault is one of two kinds of storage:

- **Git (recommended).** A git repository. The vault sync commits and pushes it, so a copy lives on your git host.
- **Local folder.** A folder on the Owner's primary workstation (the first one you paired). Nothing syncs it and it has no other copy. The Vaults page says so. Back it up yourself: copy it to a second disk or a private repository on a schedule. A folder inside OneDrive, iCloud, Dropbox or Google Drive is only as safe as that sync tool.

To move a local vault to git, register a git repository for the project. The folder is kept (renamed, not deleted) and the repository is cloned in its place. If the Owner has no workstation yet, the vault is created when the first one connects.

> **Good to know**
> Guildwise uses the git vault for knowledge first, then the organization vault, then the local folder.

The code map. Each project can have a map of its code and docs (a project graph). A workstation that holds the repository builds it, and it is kept in the project vault under `graph/`. Agents use it to find where a thing is and what touches it, so they read fewer files. A card's brief gets a short "Graph context" section when the map knows the card's areas, and agents can ask the map with `aom graph` (where is it, what calls it, what does a change reach).

The map is built when a workstation that holds the repository connects and the project has no map yet, after each merge, and when you press **Index again** in project settings (under **Code map for agents**). The panel shows, per repository, one of: *not indexed yet*, *indexing*, *indexed* (with the number of nodes and links, the modules, the commit and the time) or *could not index*. A failure names its cause: no workstation holds a clone, the vault is not reachable from the workstation, the working branch has no commit yet, the model usage limit was reached (it is tried again), or the indexer stopped (see the workstation's log). Building the map uses no model, so it costs no tokens.

> **Trust:** Your code and its code map stay on your workstation and in your project vault. They never go to Guildwise HQ. The server keeps only the status shown in the panel (counts, the commit, the time) and the work it already tracks (cards, decisions, merges). Nothing derived from your code, not even a module name, is sent.

To measure whether the map saves tokens, one card in five runs without it for four weeks after a project's first index. See "Code map: what it saved" under 4.6.

4.3b The project backlog

Every project has a **Backlog** tab next to its **Board**. It is your list of wanted work that is **not in development yet**: nothing on the backlog is worked on by an agent, becomes a card, appears on the board or creates a desk item until you send it to the BA.

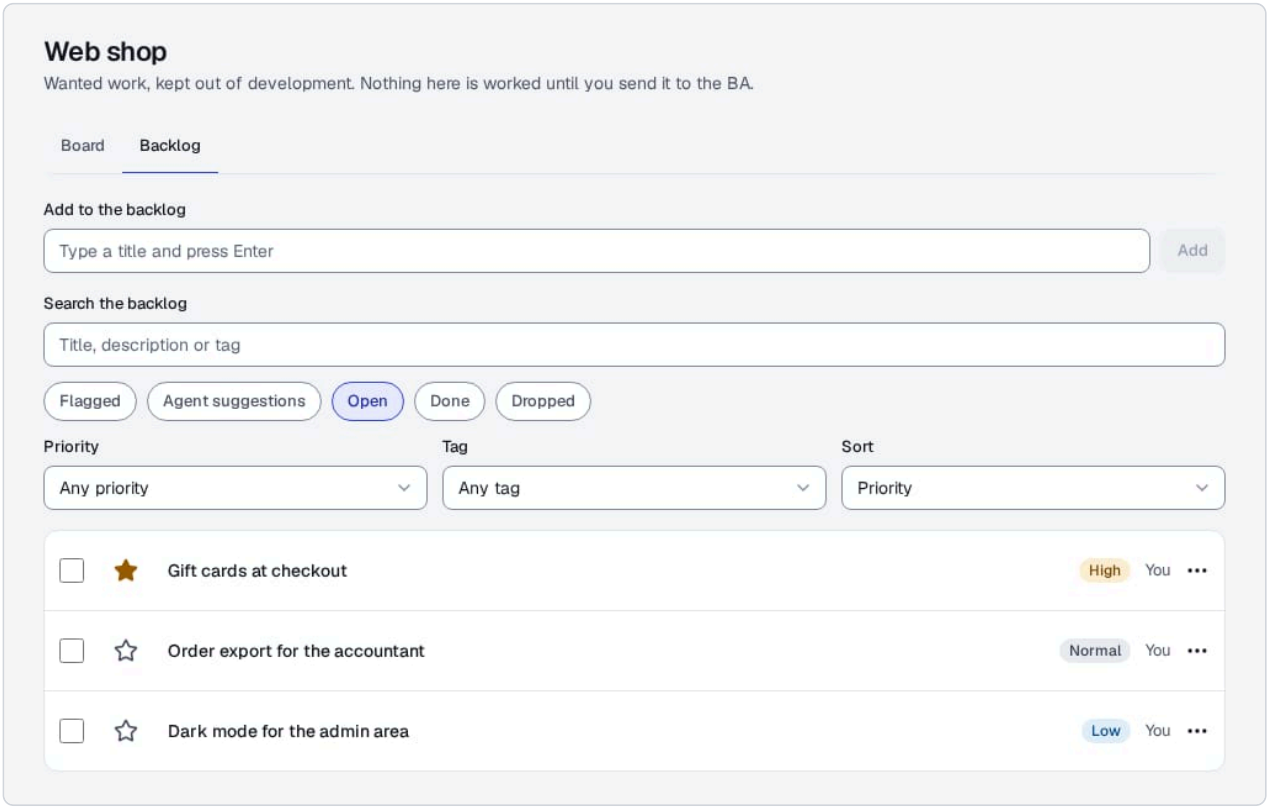


Figure 32 — The backlog of a project

Add and edit. Type a title in the quick-add field and press **Enter** (or **Add**, which is there for touch screens). The item is **Open**, priority **Normal**, with no tags, not starred, and its source is you. **Edit** opens the title, description (what you want), priority (Critical, High, Normal, Low) and tags. The **star** marks an item to look at soon. **Drop** sets the item to **Dropped**. Done is set only by sending; reopening a dropped item is not possible. Only **Owners and Admins** of the organization manage the backlog (add, edit, star, drop, send); every member of the project, guests included, can read it.

Find things. Search looks in the title, description and tags. Filter by tag, priority, flagged, source (you or an agent) and status; the filters combine. The list shows **Open** items only until the status filter includes Done or Dropped. Sort by priority (Critical first, newest first within a priority) or by **Newest** (newest first). Items an agent suggested show the agent's name and the card it was working on.

Send to BA. Send to BA on an Open item starts a normal BA intake for the project from its title and description, exactly as if you had started it yourself. The priority maps to the card's priority (Critical 1, High 3, Normal 5, Low 8), and the priority and the tags are written at the end of the card's context. The new card goes on the board. When it exists, the item becomes **Done**, links to the card (find it with the **Done** status filter) and leaves the default list. If the intake cannot be created (for example no BA is hired, or the project is archived) the item stays Open and you see the error. Select several items and use **Send {n} to the BA** (for example "Send 3 to the BA") to send them in one go: each becomes its own card; the ones that fail stay Open and are named.

Suggestions from agents. An agent that finds a follow-up outside its card can add it to the backlog (`aom backlog suggest`) instead of putting it on the board. The agent and its card are recorded by the server. An agent can only add (at most 5 per shift); it cannot edit, star, drop or send. Suggestions create no desk item; the CEO's **daily report** lists the new ones since the previous report under **New backlog suggestions from agents** (project, title, priority, agent, card) and leaves the section out when there are none.

Through the CEO. In the CEO chat you can say "add X to the backlog of project P" or "send the flagged ui items to the BA". The CEO uses `aom ceo backlog add | list | update | send`: `add` needs a project and a title (optional description, priority, tags, flag); `list` filters by project, tag, priority, flagged and status (default Open) with an optional text search; `update` changes the title, description, priority, tags or flag of one item by id, or drops it; `send` sends one item by id or all Open items that match the filters (at least one filter is required, at most 25 at once) and prints the card or the reason for each item. The web page and the CEO work on the same data and follow the same rules.

> **In the app**
> Help, "Board and cards" (`/help/board-and-cards`), section "The project backlog".

4.4 Agents, hiring and allow-lists

Agents belong to the organization, not to a single project. For each agent you decide where it may work: its **allow-list**. The agent is only offered cards from those projects.

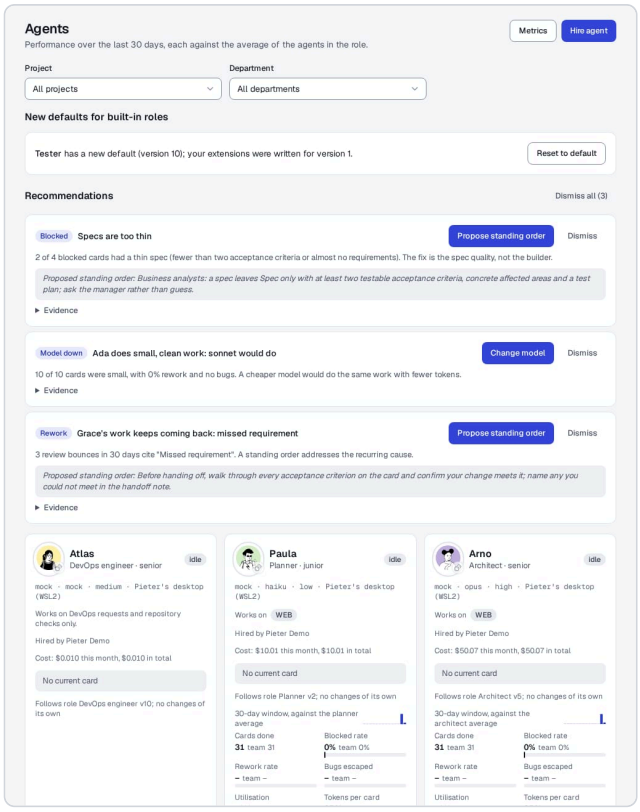


Figure 33 — The Agents page

Hiring works as described in 3.5. Hiring has a few more options:

- **Where may this agent work? Any project** (Owners and Admins only) or **Selected projects**, ticked one by one. Hiring needs at least one project (or **Any project**): an empty list is refused. Later, when you remove the last project of an agent in its **Projects** dialog, the agent is **benched**: it takes no work until you give it projects again. A star next to a project means *preferred*: when two cards are waiting, the agent takes the starred project's card first.
- **Seniority** decides who may review large changes and who handles harder work.
- **Effort and Model:** how hard the agent thinks. Higher costs more.
- **Skills:** extra know-how, such as "Playwright" or "database migrations".

Changing an agent. On the agent's card use **Projects** (the allow-list), **Change model**, **Change role**, **Pause** (and **Resume**) and **Fire**. A paused agent takes no new work; the card says "Paused" or "Paused by the CEO". An agent that lost its home (for example when its owner left) shows **needs rehome**: press **Re-home** to give it to someone. A small button on the face re-rolls it. Firing releases the cards the agent holds back to the queue with the last handoff, deletes the agent's private sandbox, and retires the name. The agent's history stays in the records. A fired name is never reused.

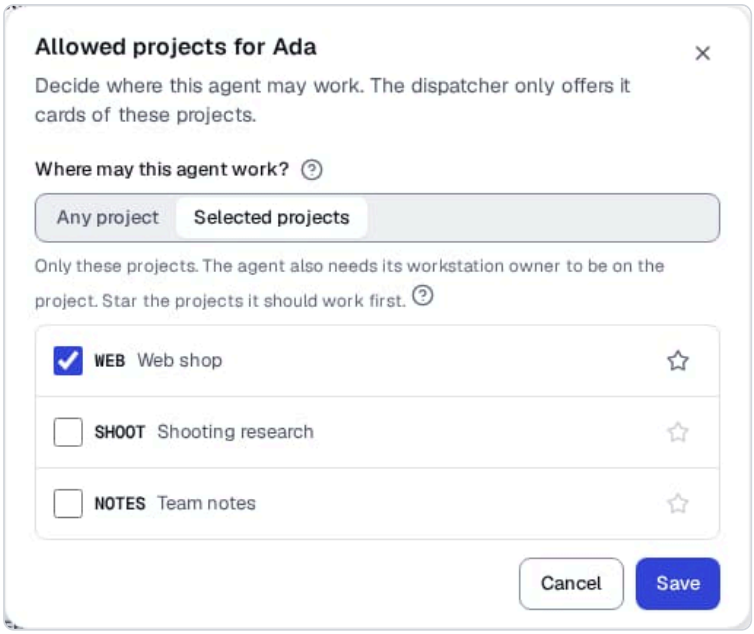


Figure 34 — Changing an agent's allowed projects

Agents follow their role. An agent always works with the current version of its role: when a role gets a new version (a built-in update, or a custom role you approve), the agents in that role pick up its new permissions and instructions. What you changed on one agent yourself (extra blocked commands, narrowed tools, external tools) stays. The card shows "Follows role Builder v4" and lists those changes of its own.

External tools (MCP). Each agent card has an **External tools (MCP)** section: one switch per plugin MCP server your workstations report, with a plain-language note and the same warning as in the project settings (a server that can write, send or delete lets the agent change data in that service as you; prefer read-only use). This is how a built-in agent such as the business analyst, the builder or the architect gets Jira or Confluence, since built-in roles have no external tools of their own. Everyone who can see the agent reads the switches; only the **organization Owner** can change them (Administrators and the hiring manager get a clear refusal, but may still switch a server off). The server must **also** be granted to the project (project settings, MCP servers), otherwise the agent cannot use it. The DevOps engineer has no such section and cannot be given external tools.

Each agent card also shows what the agent costs this month and in total, how many cards it finished, its bounce rate (how often review sent its work back) and its current work.

Recommendations. The Agents page suggests changes based on how the team performs: a different model, hiring another reviewer, or a standing order. You can apply them in one click, or **Dismiss** one, or **Dismiss all (N)**.

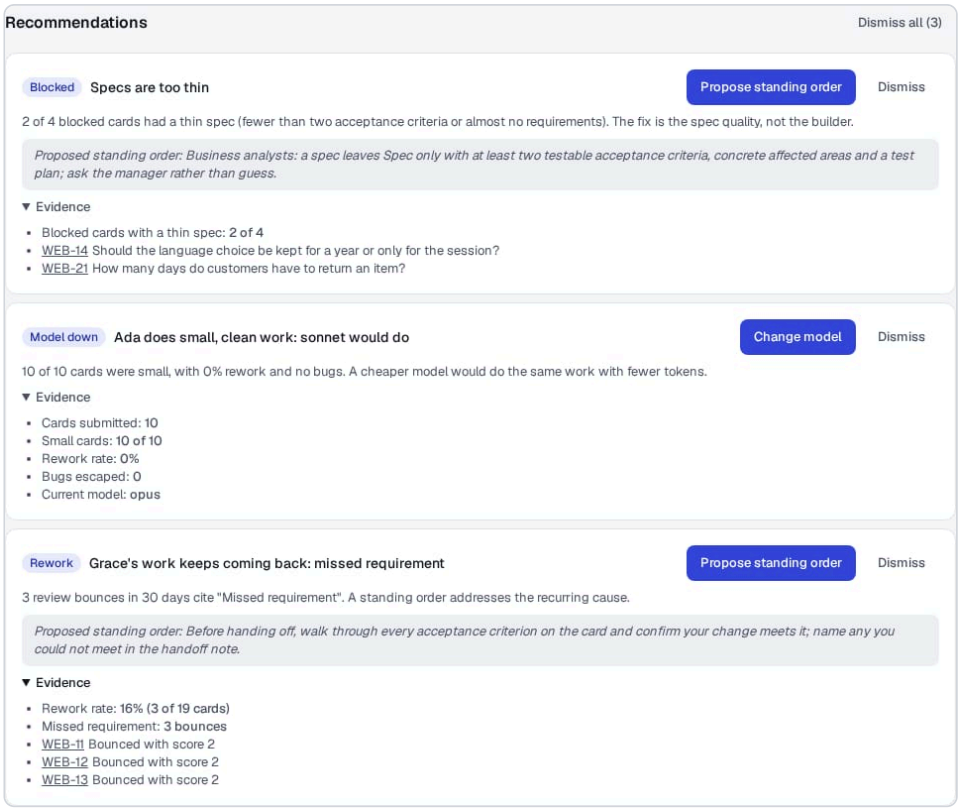


Figure 35 — Recommendations on the Agents page

Safety. Agents run inside a sandbox on the workstation, so they cannot read your whole disk. The DevOps engineer is the exception: it works as you (below). Some computers cannot offer a sandbox (for example plain Windows). The app then shows an amber warning on the workstation, on each affected agent and in the Hire form, and hiring onto that machine needs an explicit confirmation. Prefer a workstation with a sandbox (Linux, macOS, or Windows with WSL2).

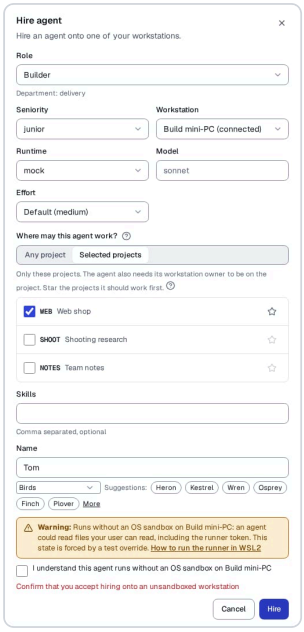


Figure 36 — The unsandboxed warning when hiring

The DevOps engineer. Each workstation has one, free of charge. It installs tools, starts containers, pulls and pushes vault changes and keeps repositories tidy (next section). You can only reset it, never fire it, and only change its model and effort.

Ask DevOps from anywhere. Click **Ask DevOps** in the top bar, choose **Ask DevOps…** in the command palette, or use the button on a card, a desk item or the workstation. The page, project, card or error you were looking at is

attached (remove what you do not want to share) and the right workstation's engineer is chosen for you when it is obvious. The dialog says "DevOps works through <CEO name> now": press **Ask <CEO name>** and your CEO chat opens with the question filled in; the CEO hands it to DevOps and tells you the result (4.22). The DevOps engineer works as you on your machine and is not sandboxed, in a chat as in a shift: a command, a Docker build or a deploy you ask for runs right away. The tick boxes on the workstation (install, Docker, sudo, paths) are instructions and limits for the automatic tool setup, not a physical barrier. On a team member's workstation an approval needs an Owner or Admin and the machine's user (one person can be both).

Questions and approvals from DevOps. The DevOps engineer asks for **approval** (`aom devops-approval`) only for something destructive or outside its granted access. A plain question (which branch, which option, what is missing) is asked with `aom devops-question` and is an ordinary question: it goes to a senior agent or the BA, then the CEO, and reaches your desk only when nobody before you can answer; the request carries on with the answer. When the card's project does not require your approval for merges ("Merge large changes without my approval" is on and the owner approval policy is not "always"), the DevOps engineer resolves merge conflicts in the card's own worktree without asking, and the server approves such a request by itself ("Auto-approved: the project does not require approval for merges"); deleting branches, force-pushing and resetting shared branches are always asked.

A request about a card. When a request is filed for a card (from the card's **Ask DevOps** button, or by the agent working on it), the DevOps engineer gets the card in its brief: title, type, fields, project, repository and the latest comments. It can read that card, comment on it and set the card's fields it needs (for example how to start the stack), and nothing else: it cannot change the title, stage or status, and it cannot read or change any other card.

> **In the app**
> Help, "Agents" (`/help/agents`).

How finished work lands (and expert mode)

Every project repository has two branches, and the settings name both under the repository:

- The **main branch** is where pull requests go. By default it is the repository's default branch (usually `main`); the owner can name another one with **Change**.
- The **working branch** is where finished card work is combined. It can be the same branch as the main branch (the default, so you can ignore the difference), or another one such as `develop`. If the working branch does not exist yet, Guildwise creates it from the main branch and pushes it when the first card starts; the repository row says when it will be created and, afterwards, when it was and from which branch. If the push is refused, the card says so and the desk asks you, naming the branch, with the reason from the git host.

Agents always work on a card branch of their own. **How finished work lands** (per project, and per card in expert mode) decides what happens to that card branch when the work is reviewed and tested:

Completion action	What happens	Pull request
Commit and push to the working branch (the default; stored as `merge`)	The card branch is merged into the working branch and the working branch is pushed.	None.
Pull request (`pr`)	The card branch is pushed and a pull request is opened into the working branch (that is the main branch when you use one branch), for you to review and merge.	Card branch to working branch.

A card follows its project: it has no completion action of its own unless a person sets one on that card (expert mode, at any time before it is finalised). Agents, the BA included, never set it. When you change the project setting, every card that has not set its own, open or not yet started, follows the change; a card with its own action keeps it. In expert mode choose **Project default** on the card to go back to following the project.

When the working branch is not the main branch, the work reaches the main branch the way you choose: in the repository row of the project settings the owner clicks **Open pull request: develop to main**, and the workstation

opens a pull request from the working branch to the main branch through the git host (or reports that there is nothing new to open). This is deliberately a project action and not part of every card, so a release is reviewed once, not per card.

If the working branch is protected on the code host (it refuses direct changes), Guildwise notices, opens a pull request for the card instead, and switches the project to pull requests with a note on the card. A large change that would be committed to the working branch waits for your approval on the desk first (see 4.12).

You see plain outcomes on cards: *"Goes into the working branch after review and test"*, *"Your change is live on the working branch"*, *"Waiting for you to merge the pull request"* (with the working branch's name when it is not main). When two changes clash, the DevOps engineer tries to fix it first and leaves a note on the card.

If you know git and want the details, turn on **Expert mode for code changes** in **Settings** (it is per person and off by default; it only changes what you see). It brings back the per-card completion action (commit and push to the working branch, or pull request), branch names and commit hashes, **Mark merged** on the phase page, and the questions about keeping or changing the working branch for a new intake or phase. The main and working branch rows in the repository settings are shown to everyone.

Repository hygiene and the working branch

Once a day per workstation the DevOps engineer tidies the project repositories on that machine: it fetches and pulls, **stores any uncommitted edits of yours in a git stash** (`git stash list` shows `saved work <date>: N file(s) not committed`; it stays on your machine, is never pushed and adds no branch; your files are left exactly as they are and nothing reaches main by surprise) and removes branches and worktrees of cards that are finished and merged. Files that look like passwords or keys (`.env*`, `*.pem`, names with *key* or *secret*) are never copied; the notice on your desk names them. Hygiene never force-pushes and never discards anything. Change the time or switch it off in the workstation's **Repository hygiene** panel on the Workstations page, or start it with **Run hygiene now**.

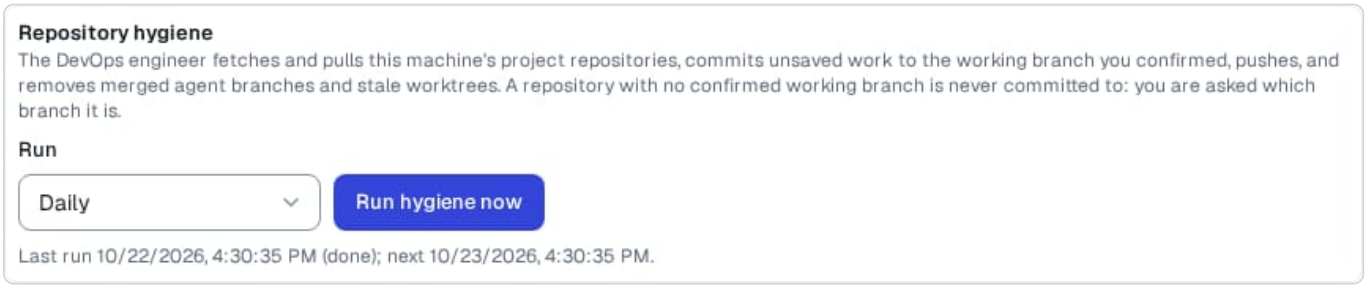


Figure 37 — Repository hygiene on the Workstations page

The working branch is the repository's default branch unless you name another, confirmed automatically the first time Guildwise sees the repository. You are asked on the desk (*Which branch is the working branch of this repository?*) only when the default cannot be told. The owner can change it in the project settings (**Change**) and you are asked again when a new intake or phase starts ("keep `main` as the working branch?").

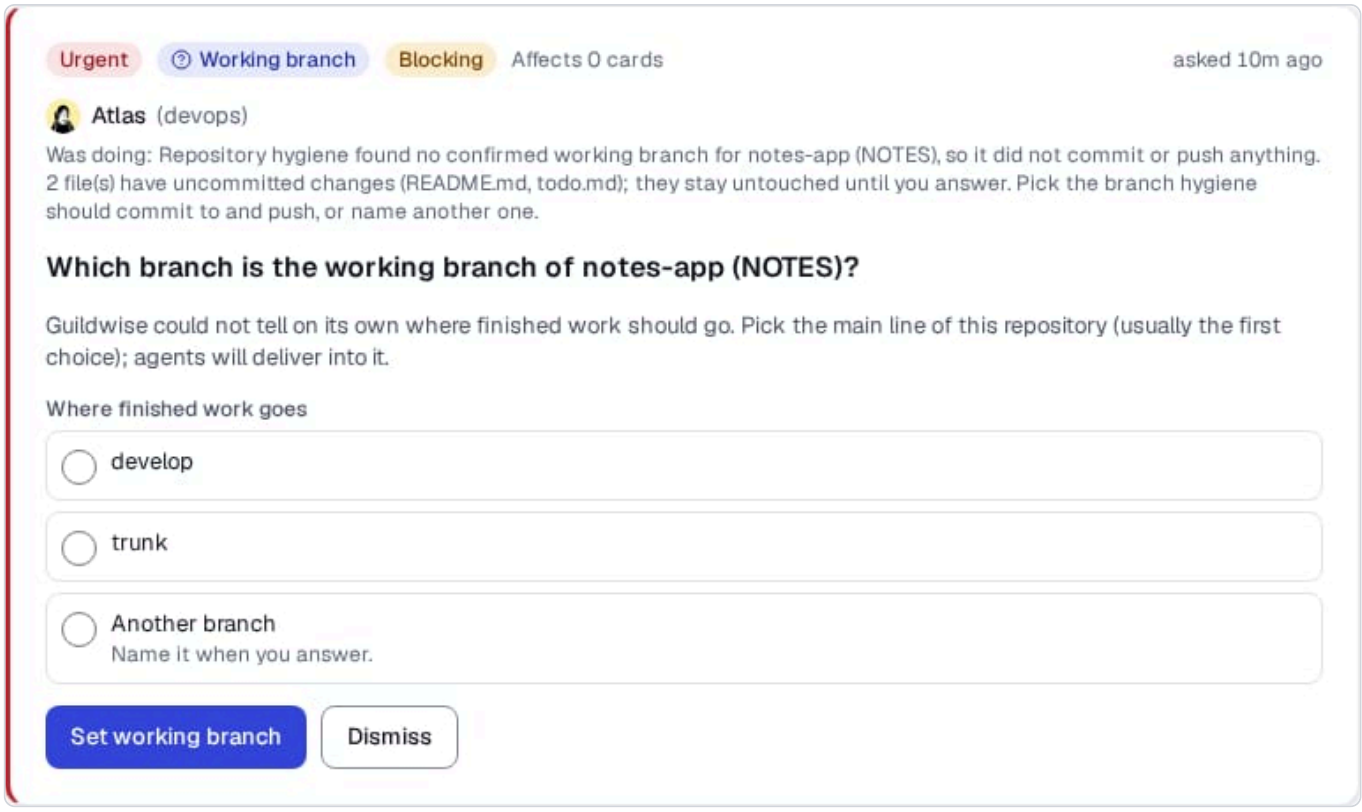


Figure 38 — The desk asks which branch is the working branch

Card branches only go to the git host when the card needs them (a pull request, or "push the branch"). A pull request goes out as `<prefix>/<ticket>`, for example `pieter/DCPL-4276`: the prefix is the project setting **Pull request branch prefix** (empty: `feature`), the ticket is the Jira key the card came from, else the card reference (`-2`, `-3` if the name is taken). Rework pushes to the same branch and pull request. Your local card branch keeps its name; with "Commit and push to the working branch" only the working branch is pushed. Hygiene also deletes the branch of a **done or cancelled** card, on the host, on the workstation and its worktree, once its work is in the working branch (merged, rebased or cherry-picked) or its pull request is merged (a declined pull request alone does not delete a branch that holds unmerged commits). Open pull requests, branches with work found nowhere else and branches of open or reopened cards are never touched. The card records each deletion and your desk gets one notice per run. Turn it off with **Remove finished card branches** in the project settings.

What hygiene cannot resolve, it does not force. For a conflict while pulling, the DevOps engineer first tries to resolve it on a temporary branch and runs the tests (you get a notice; after two attempts it goes to your desk). Changes on the wrong branch, a failed login, a missing clone, or a leftover worktree with uncommitted work are not forced either. These appear under Failures in your CEO's daily report until a later run finds the repository in order.

> **In the app**
> Help, "DevOps and repository hygiene" (`/help/devops-and-hygiene`).

4.5 The desk, the ledger and standing orders

The **Desk** is where every question and approval reaches you. Cards do not move past a question until you answer.

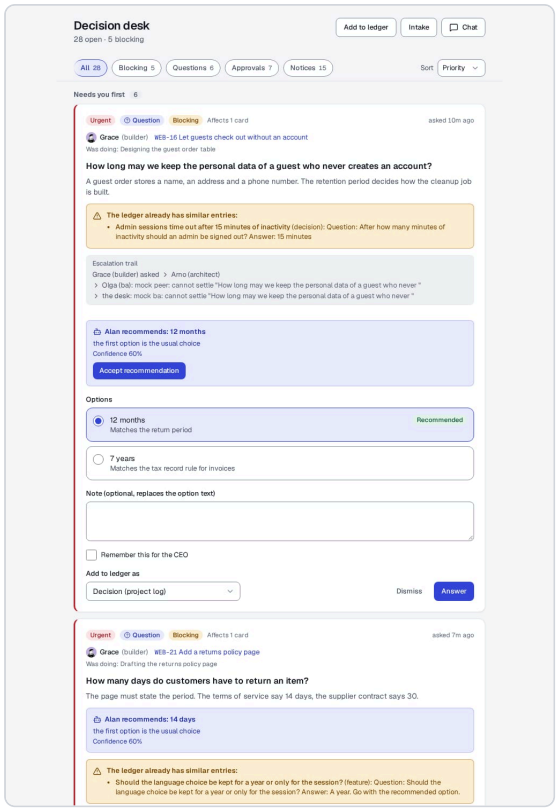


Figure 39 — The Desk

An agent can wait for an answer without losing its work, and an agent's answer can say **keep this card parked until** something happens. If the same question is asked again on a card with nothing changed, the card is parked with a back-off and you get one item about it instead of another round of questions. A card that uses up its passes, review rounds or shifts (small 2 / 2 / 10, medium 3 / 2 / 15, large 4 / 2 / 25, adjustable per project) goes to its architect first and reaches you only if the architect cannot resolve it. Cards that already existed when stop-loss was introduced are counted from that day, not from their whole history; a card the crash-loop breaker has already parked does not get a second stop-loss item, and a stop-loss question about mostly crashed shifts names the crashes and the last error.

The items are grouped (**Needs you first**, **Blocking work**, **Decisions**, **Heads-up**) and the filter chips narrow the list: **All**, **Blocking**, **Questions**, **Approvals**, **Notices**, **Handled by CEO** and **CEO decisions**. **Handled by CEO** shows the items your CEO answered or passed on.

Each desk item says **what kind it is** (Question, DevOps approval, Merge approval, Outbound update, Digest to rate, Alert, and so on; the CEO's morning report is an Alert titled "Daily report <date>", 4.11), **who asked and what they were doing**, the **question** with options and a **recommendation**, and **how many cards are waiting**. To answer, click an option or type your own answer, optionally add it to the ledger, and click **Answer**. When your CEO has a recommendation, **Accept recommendation** answers with exactly what it recommends.

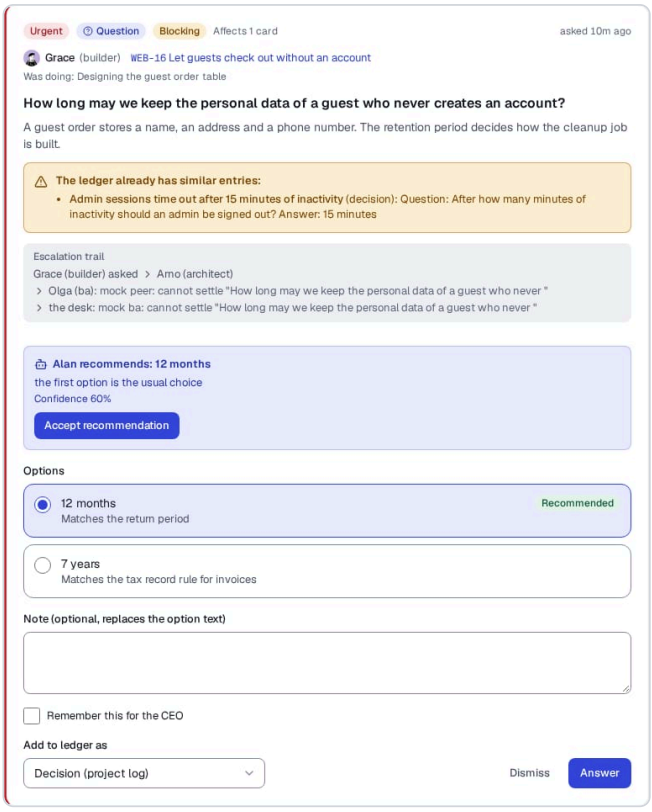


Figure 40 — A question with options and a recommendation

CEO decisions. When your CEO decides something on its own that you would otherwise have been asked (it answers a question routed to it, or decides a matter you delegated, such as which working branch a repository uses), the decision appears under **CEO decisions** at the bottom of the Desk, and under its own filter chip. It is information, not a request: it never sends a notification, is not blocking and is not counted in "open" or in the badge on the Desk tab. Each one shows what was asked, the CEO's decision and reason, the card, the time and "CEO decision · <name>". **Acknowledge** marks it read (the memories the decision relied on gain a little confidence); **Acknowledge all** marks every open CEO decision read in one go. **Correct** is for a decision that was wrong: write what the right decision is. The CEO adds it to its memory at once ("Owner corrected: … (was: …)"), the CEO and the BA then discuss it in exactly three turns. The BA analyses it (why the instinct was wrong, which signal it missed, a proposed rule) and assesses the consequences: what already happened because of the wrong decision, with the fix work proposed as concrete cards (nothing is created yet). The CEO replies in its own words: it agrees or disagrees, says what it got wrong and records the lesson (a disagreement is recorded for you, your correction always stands), and comments on the proposed cards. The BA then adjusts the proposal and creates the fix cards in the right projects (drafted by the BA, in the specify stage, linked to the decision and to the original card; on a paused project they are created but do not start). The item shows the discussion as a small timeline and the chip changes from "Under review" to "Lesson recorded · N fix cards". If the BA concludes that no fix work is needed and the CEO does not object, no cards are created. If the CEO does not reply within two hours (it is paused, offline or over budget) the lesson is recorded without it, marked "recorded without the CEO", and the BA still creates the cards it proposed. None of this sends a notification or needs anything from you. Where the decision can be undone (the Owner only), **Apply the correction now** also re-opens the question on your desk. Owners and Admins can acknowledge and correct; decisions taken before this feature existed are not listed.

When you answer you can also record it in the **ledger** as a **requirement** (a permanent rule), a **standing order** (an instruction every agent reads at the start of every shift) or a **decision** (a one-time choice kept for history). That is how the team learns: the next agent who is about to ask the same thing finds your answer first, and the desk shows "similar decision in the ledger".

The **Ledger** page lists everything and is searchable, and has a **Project** filter. Organization-wide standing orders can only come from the Owner and Admins. A project owner adds project-wide ones.

Editing a standing order. Press **Edit** on a standing order in the Ledger to change its title or text; the people who may add it may edit it (the Owner and Admins for an organization-wide one, the project's owner for a project one). The order keeps its place, shows *edited* with who and when, and **History** lists every earlier wording. Agents are briefed from the Ledger each time, so the new wording reaches their next shift or chat, and the copy in the vault's `standing-orders.md` is rewritten to match. Every agent follows the standing orders as binding rules that override its usual habits: builders, reviewers and the BA, and also the DevOps engineer (for its requests, repository hygiene, running a branch and its chats), which receives the organization's orders plus those of the projects involved. Decisions and requirements cannot be edited, only replaced.

Retiring an entry. Press **Retire** on an entry in the Ledger and give a reason when it is a one-off order, a duplicate, or a rule that a setting now replaces. A retired entry is kept for the record (switch on **Show retired** to see it greyed out, with its reason), but no agent is briefed with it and a search no longer finds it. The same people who may edit an entry may retire it, the BA can retire one (`aom ledger retire <id> --reason "..."`), and so can the CEO (as a recommendation until you let it decide).

Duplicates and contradictions. When you save a standing order the ledger compares it with the live ones. A near-duplicate is refused with a pointer to the existing order (hyphens, plurals, articles and small word endings do not make an order different: "user-facing copy" and "the user facing copies" are the same order); the form offers **Merge into the existing order instead**, which puts the new wording into that order. An order that looks like it says the opposite of another one (the same subject, one asks and the other forbids) is saved but marked **May contradict another order**, and one desk item asks you or the BA to retire or reword one of them.

Decisions stay with their project. An answer on a card is a decision of that card's project. HR and the CEO never turn it into an organization-wide order; only you can promote one (the **organization-wide** switch when you answer). For a project that must keep its decisions to itself, such as the platform project, switch on **Keep this project's decisions at project level** in its settings: the switch is then refused on its questions and HR leaves its questions out when it looks for patterns.

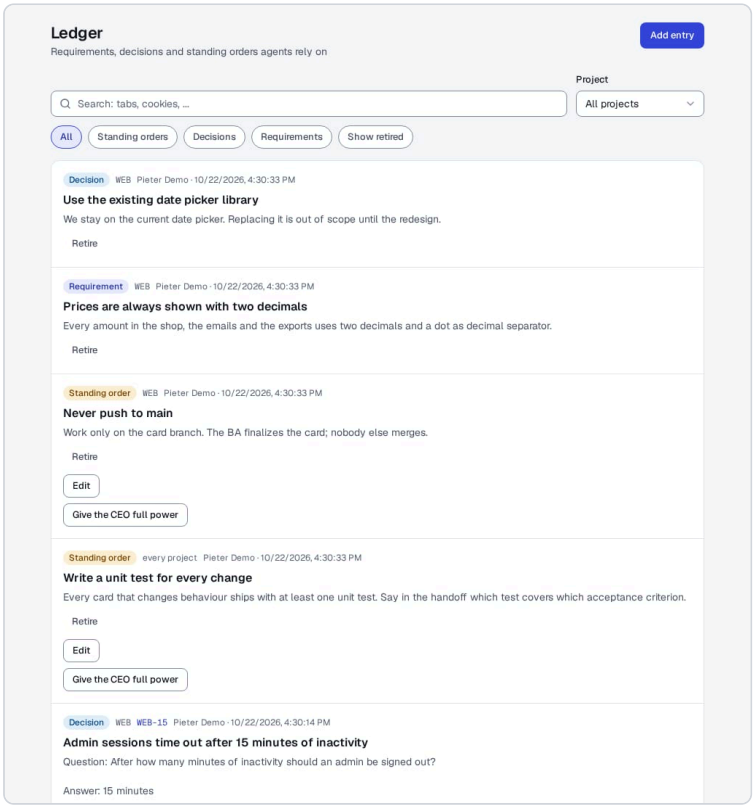


Figure 41 — The ledger

> **In the app**
> Help, "The Decision desk" (`/help/desk`) and "Ledger and vaults" (`/help/ledger-and-vaults`).

Testing without an environment

In the project settings, **Test without an environment** replaces the old "Test mode" and "Test Environment" standing orders (which contradicted each other). Off (the default): when a card needs a test environment and none is ready, it waits for DevOps to start one. On: the tester runs what it can without an environment and records in its note that none was used.

4.6 Budgets and costs

Every shift records what it used (input, output and cache tokens and the model). The server turns that into money at the **list prices** of the models, in US dollars, and shows it in your organization's currency. These are estimates of what the work costs, not an invoice. Chats count too: to the project when the chat is about a card or project, otherwise to **Org overhead**.

Where spend shows:

- the **Costs** page (Owners and Admins): spend by project, agent, model and day for any date range, with an **Export CSV** button;
- the **project settings** and the **board header** ("$9.00 of $10.00 this month");
- each **agent card**, each **card** and each **phase**;
- the **CEO's daily report** (older floor reports stay on the desk).

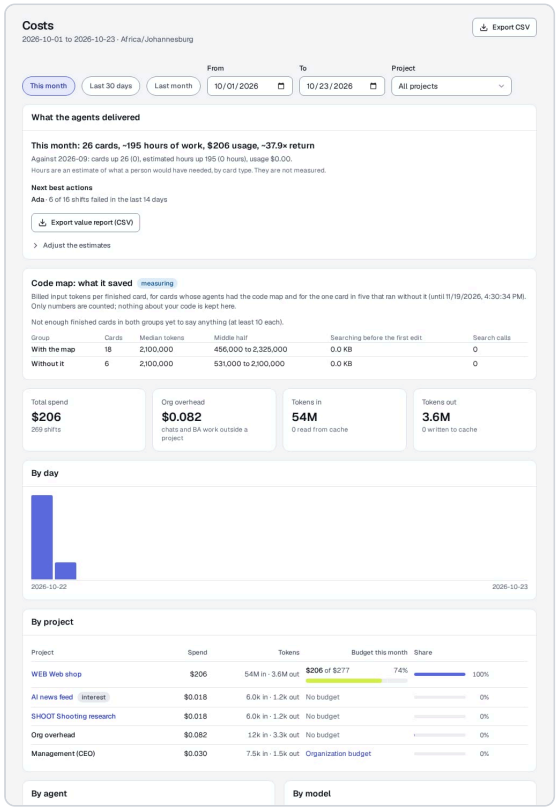


Figure 42 — The Costs page

Monthly budgets. In the project settings, **Monthly budget** sets a limit for the project. (An interest has its own budget on its Settings tab, 4.9.) The month runs from the 1st to the end of the month in your time zone.

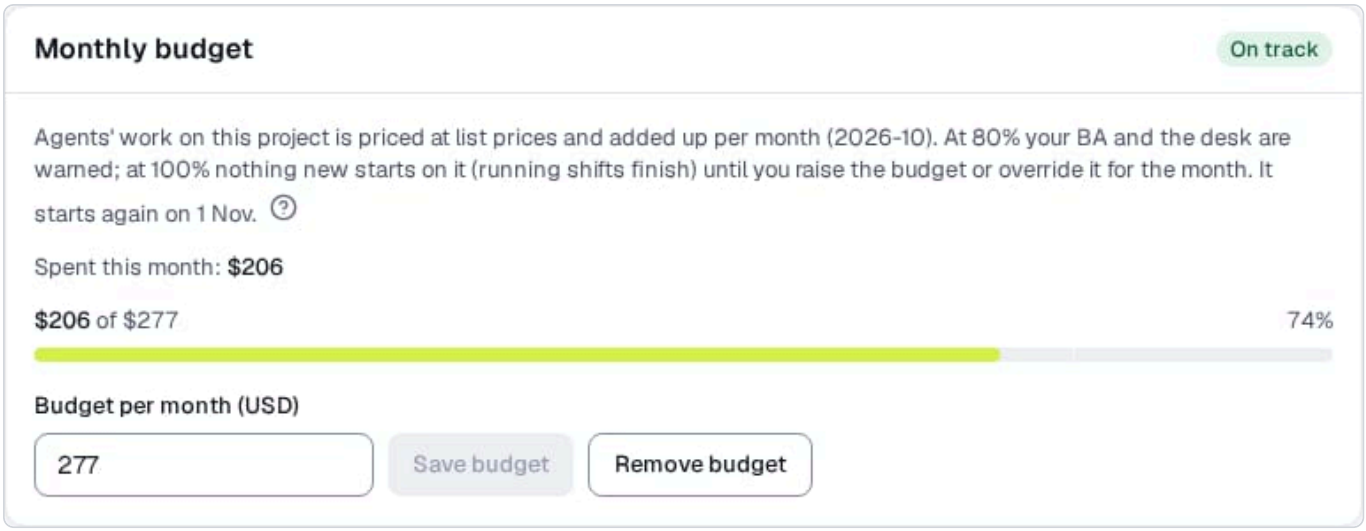


Figure 43 — The Monthly budget panel

- **At 80%** you get one notice on the desk and a line in the daily report. Work carries on.
- **At 100%** the project is **paused**. Running shifts finish, but nothing new starts. Cards wait in the queue. A banner on the board says so, and a desk item offers **Raise budget** (the pause lifts as soon as the new amount is above the spend) or **Override for this month** (work resumes until the 1st).
- **On the 1st** the month starts again from zero.

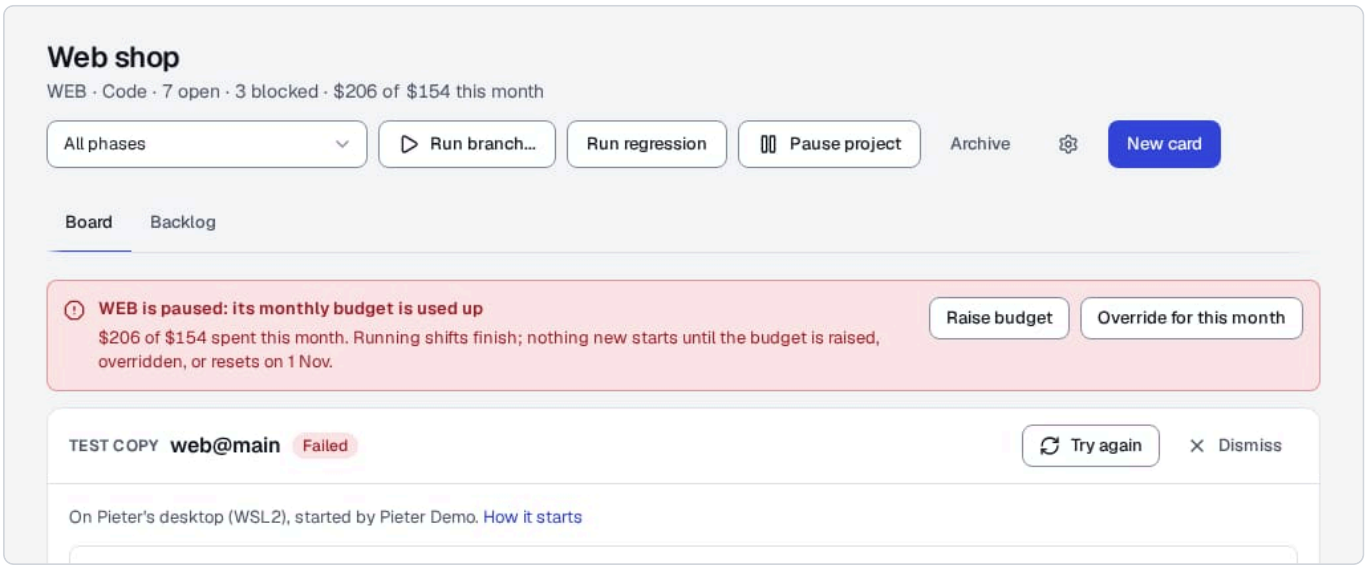


Figure 44 — The board banner when a project is over budget

Setting a budget below what was already spent pauses the project at once. Members can see the progress but not change it. Guests see only that a project is paused.

Pausing a project by hand. An organization Owner or Admin can press **Pause project** in the board header (optionally with a reason). Nothing new starts on the project until an Owner or Admin presses **Resume project** on the banner: no card is claimed at any stage, and the BA, DevOps and question shifts, scheduled runs and interest scans for it wait. Shifts already running finish, and cards keep their place in the queue. People can still view and edit cards, create new ones, answer questions and change settings; agents pick the work up at resume. Scheduled runs that fall due during the pause are skipped (they are not made up afterwards), while cards that arrive by e-mail, webhook or a trigger are created and wait in the queue. Everyone on the project sees the banner (who paused it, when, why) and a **Paused** badge in project lists; only Owners and Admins see the buttons. Agents and the CEO cannot pause or resume.

Cost by cause. Each card on the board shows what it has cost so far. Behind it, the cost of a card (and of a day) is split by what the shift was spent on: working, asking (a shift that ended with a question), answering (a colleague's question), reviewing, re-review after a conflict (a review done again because a rebase conflict reset it) and rejected (the runner turned the shift away). Prices are the list prices of October 2026 (Sonnet 5.5 $2 / $10 per million tokens, Opus 5.5 $4 / $20, cache reads at 10%, writes at 1.25x, or 2x when the runner reports a one-hour cache write). A shift that reported and was then stopped counts as reported, and a crashed shift is priced from the usage the runner reports afterwards.

What the agents delivered (the value report). The panel of this name at the top of the Costs page: "This month: 42 cards, ~168 hours of work, $84 usage, ~80x return", the change against last month, and **Next best actions** (cards that have not moved for days, agents that fail often, projects with no work). The hours are an estimate of what a person would have needed, by card type; Owners and Admins can change them under **Adjust the estimates**. **Export value report (CSV)** downloads it.

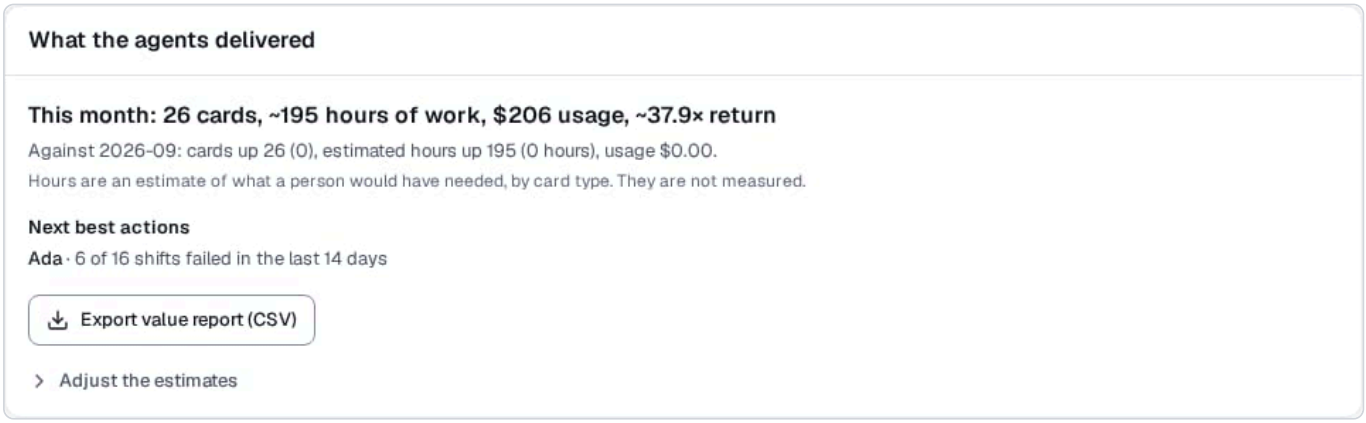


Figure 45 — The value report at the top of the Costs page

Code map: what it saved. The Costs page has a panel with this name. It compares finished cards that ran with the code map against the one card in five that ran without it (the holdout, chosen by a hash of the card's id, for four weeks after a project's first index). For each group it shows the cards, the median billed input tokens with the middle half, and the median searching before the first edit and the median number of search calls. Only numbers are kept.

The panel states a saving (for example "used 25% fewer billed input tokens", with the likely range) only when all of these hold:

- at least 10 finished cards in each group;
- the likely range of the difference lies entirely below zero, so chance does not explain it;
- no quality measure is worse with the map: rework rounds, changes requested, tester failures, days to done, or cost per card.

Otherwise the panel says why no saving is claimed (for example "not enough finished cards yet", or "the cards with the map did worse on a quality measure"). Until then it shows the numbers only.

Monday briefing. Every Monday at 08:00 (organization time) you get an e-mail with what was finished, what waits on you, what is blocked and the health of your agents and workstations; Owners and Admins also get spend against budget and the value report. Switch it off under **Settings, Monday briefing**.

Currency. On the Costs page, in the **Currency and prices** panel, type a three-letter currency code and how many units make one US dollar (for example `EUR` and `0.92`). Changing the rate changes how history is shown, not what was recorded.

> **In the app**
> Help, "Budgets and costs" (`/help/budgets-and-costs`).

4.7 The org chart, roles and workflows

Org chart (sidebar, Organization) shows who works for you and who answers whom, as a tree: you at the top, then your CEO (always there), then the BAs, then each department with its seniors above its juniors. The lines are the **escalation path**: a question goes to the colleague its topic names (the card's architect for design questions, the BA for requirements, the builder for code, the DevOps engineer for environment problems), else to a senior of the same role, then to the BA, then to your CEO, then to your desk. Each tile shows the agent's face, name, role, what it is doing and its workstation. Click an agent for its card. **List** shows the same as grouped lists (the default on a phone). The **Allowed on project** filter shows only the agents that may work on one project. The **Workstations and DevOps** panel lists the machines and their DevOps engineers, and **Hire a BA** appears on the chart when you have none.

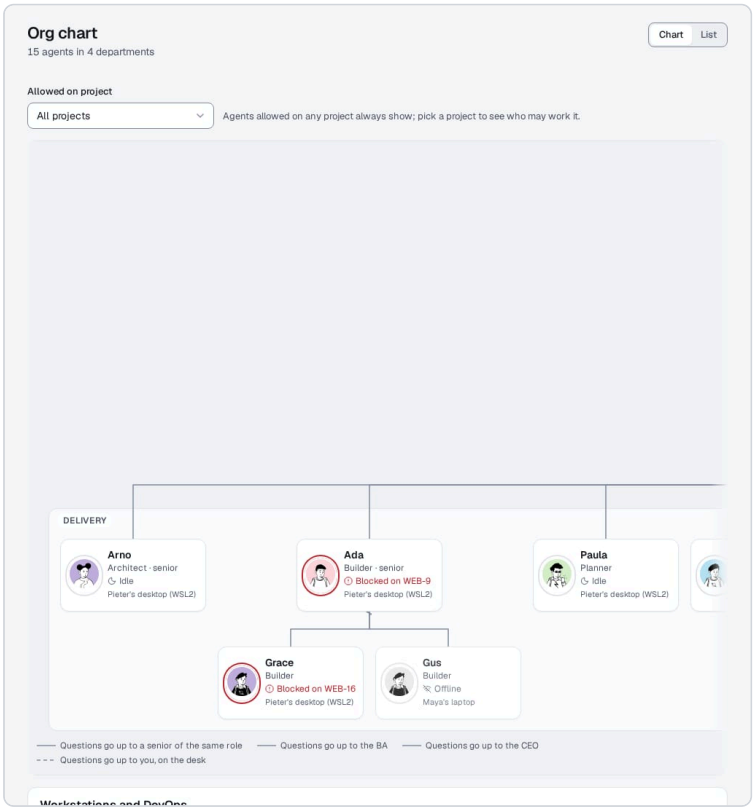


Figure 46 — The org chart

Roles & workflows (sidebar, Organization) lets you extend the team beyond the built-in roles. The page itself is titled **Organization** and has the tabs Roles, Workflows, Departments and **Design with the BA**.

- **Roles.** Built-in roles (builder, reviewer, tester, writer, architect and others) cannot be removed, but you can extend them with extra instructions, skills and standing orders (**Extend**). You can also design **custom roles** with a guided form in sections: name and purpose, instructions and rules, **what it may do** (plain-language switches such as change files, run commands, search the web or commit, each with a risk note; reading all organization repositories is for the Owner only), the model and effort, seniority and skills, and a checklist of the **steps of your custom workflows** it can take. Problems are explained in plain words beside each section, and **Preview what the agent is told** shows the instructions an agent with the role would get, from a sample card, without running anything. The BA can still draft a role for you to check in the form.
- **Workflows.** A workflow is a list of steps with a role for each, and a route for success and for sending work back. Design your own, for example a support-triage flow, in the **workflow builder** (below). The BA checks that every step can be reached and every failure ends somewhere.
- **Departments** group roles by function so you can filter the board and the Agents page.
- **Design with the BA.** On that tab click **Start a design chat** and the BA interviews you and drafts the role or workflow. It needs a BA that is allowed on any project, and Owners and Admins can use it.

Everything you design is **submitted to the desk for your approval** before it can be used.

The workflow builder. New custom workflow (Workflows tab) opens a template gallery: Blank, Simple review, Request, do, check, Content (draft, edit, publish), Support reply, or a **copy of a built-in** workflow (Code or Research; the copy does not keep the built-in's special behaviour, such as tests opening bug cards, and the builder lists what it left out). Then you work on the page:

- **Steps** (left): for each step a name, what to do and what "done" looks like, **who does it** (a role), the information it needs first, **When finished, go to**, **If it is not good enough, send back to**, and **Only when** a yes-or-no answer applies. Add, move up or down, and remove steps with buttons (no dragging). **Information the card carries** defines the fields of the card.
- **Diagram and Try a card** (right): the diagram redraws as you edit, and **Try a card** walks a card through the steps with the answers you tick and marks the path on the diagram. It also warns when no agent with a step's role is hired.
- **Things to fix**: every problem in plain words, pinned to its step; problems block **Save and send for approval**, tips do not. A role must list a step among the steps it may take before it can work it.
- **Ask the BA**: a chat beside the builder that gets an outline of your current draft.
- **Versions**: each save is a draft of the next version; **Compare with previous** shows what changed step by step. After a version is approved its steps keep their internal names for good, so renaming a step never breaks roles or running cards; **Edit as new version** starts the next one.
- **Advanced: table editor** keeps the original table with ids and events.

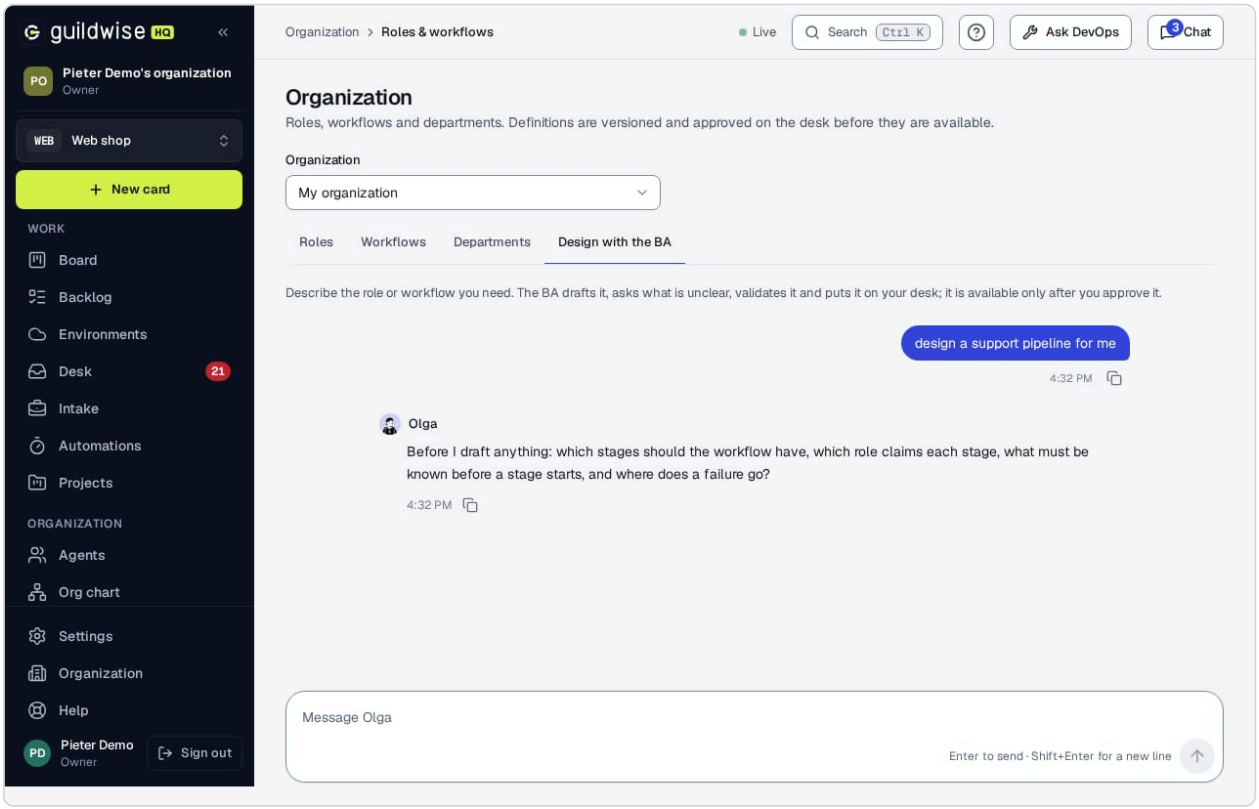


Figure 47 — The design chat: the BA asks what it needs to know

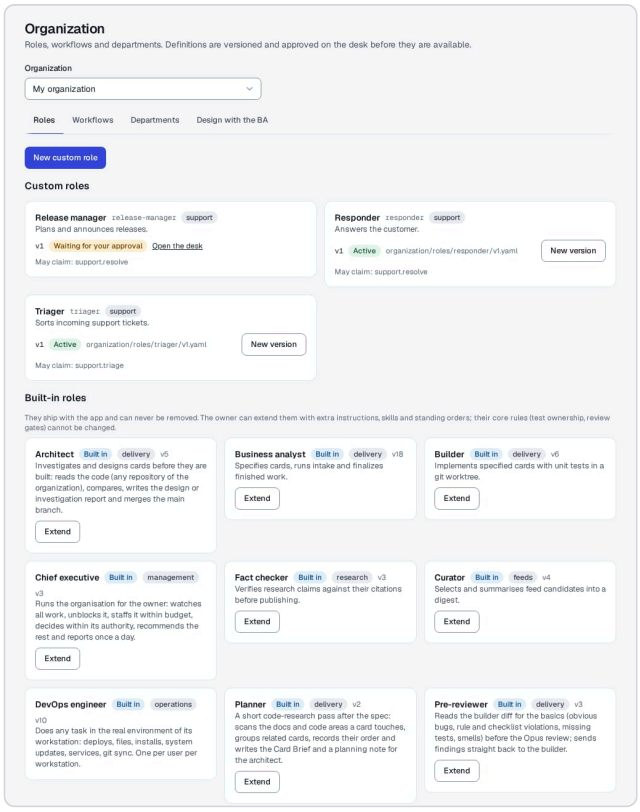


Figure 48 — Roles in the organization designer

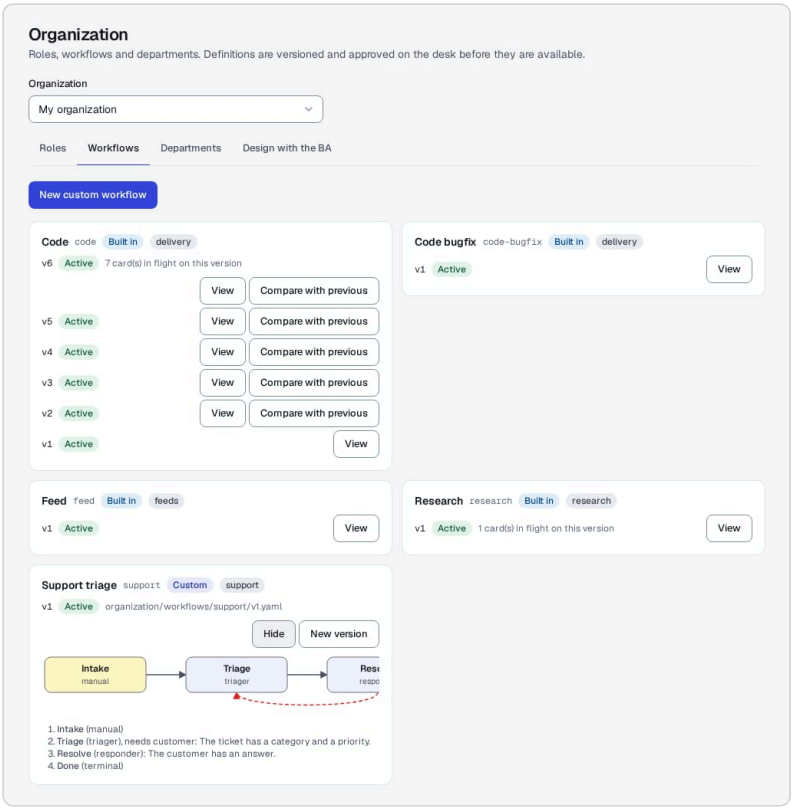


Figure 49 — Designing a workflow

More than one workflow per project, and your own steps in a built-in workflow. A project runs on one workflow by default (its type). In the project's settings, **Workflows** (organization Owners and Admins) you can:

- **Enable more workflows** next to the project's own, for example a support workflow in a code project. Tick **Default for** a card type to make that workflow the one new cards of that type use. When a card type has two choices, the

New card form shows a **Workflow** list so you can pick; cards that are already running always finish on the version they started on. Disabling a workflow does not touch its open cards.

- **Customise a workflow for this project.** Click **Customise** on Code (or on an approved custom workflow). This opens the workflow builder in project scope: the steps of the base workflow are listed locked and cannot be changed; use **Insert step after …** to add your own, for example a custom security check after Build, or the **Investigate and design** template (done by the architect) after Test. A custom step has a name, the role that works it and what done means. You can rename, move up or down and remove the steps you added. The builder checks the steps as you work and lists every problem in plain words at the top and on the step it is about; the diagram shows the flow, **Try a card** walks a sample card through the steps, and **Compare with previous** lists what your draft changes against the approved version (or the base workflow for a first draft). **Save draft** keeps your work; **Send for approval** puts the new version on your desk; **nothing changes for any card until the owner approves it**. A new version affects new cards only. When the base workflow gets a newer version, the project shows "code v2 available" and **Rebase** (in the list and in the builder) re-applies your steps on it as a new draft.
- Ask the **BA in a design chat** to do the same: it drafts a project variant with `aom org workflow variant`, you approve it on the desk, then enable it in the project's settings.

Steps for a person (approval and QA). In the workflow builder choose **A person approves it on the desk** as the kind of step, say who approves (the Owner, the project owner, the person who started the card or a named member) and which earlier step a send back returns to. The card waits in the step's column and shows on that person's desk; **Approve** moves it on, **Send back** needs a comment, which the earlier step reads as a review comment, and the card comes back to the approval after the rework. The Owner and Admins can always decide. **A person tests it** is the same for manual QA (pass, skip or send back). A project's customised workflow can insert an approval step after any step too.

A step that starts another workflow (sub-workflows). A step of a custom workflow can start a card in another workflow instead of being worked by an agent. In the workflow builder choose **Start another workflow** as the kind of step (or ask the BA in a design chat to draft it). The step names the workflow, the project (the same one, or another project of your organization where that workflow is enabled and where the card's owner is a member), which fields to pass on (from a field of the card, a fixed value or a text with placeholders) and, while waiting, which to bring back, whether the new card starts queued or as a draft, whether the step **waits** or **carries on**, and what happens when the new card is cancelled. A waiting card sits in the step's column with a line such as "Waiting for SUP-12 (Translate) in project Web, now in Review"; when the new card finishes, the card takes the step's **done** route and the chosen fields are copied back, and when the new card is cancelled it takes the **failed** route. A card that carries on moves at once. The new card says "Started by" its parent, and the card page has a **Sub-workflows** panel. Cancelling a waiting card cancels only that card unless you tick **Also cancel the card it is waiting for** in the cancel window (shown only when you may cancel that card). A manager who moves a card back into a step whose earlier new card still runs makes the card wait for that card again; no second card is started. Nesting is limited to three levels, a workflow cannot start itself (directly or through others), and both are checked when the workflow is saved. When a step cannot start its card (too deep, workflow not enabled in that project, not a member of it, a field that no longer exists) the card is **Blocked** and a notice lands on your desk; fix the cause, acknowledge the notice and the step is tried again.

A role that works an inserted step must be allowed to claim it: the roles that already work a base step (the builder on Build, and so on) keep working it, while a step you add needs a role that claims it (a custom role naming the step, or the architect for steps named `investigate...`).

> **In the app**
> Help, "Organization chart and design" (`/help/org-chart-and-design`) and "Projects" (`/help/projects#workflows`).

4.8 Automations and integrations

An **automation** (called a schedule before October 2026) is *a trigger and one action*. Open **Automations** in the sidebar and click **New automation**. A three-step wizard asks **When**, **What** and **Details**. The old address `/schedules` still opens the page.

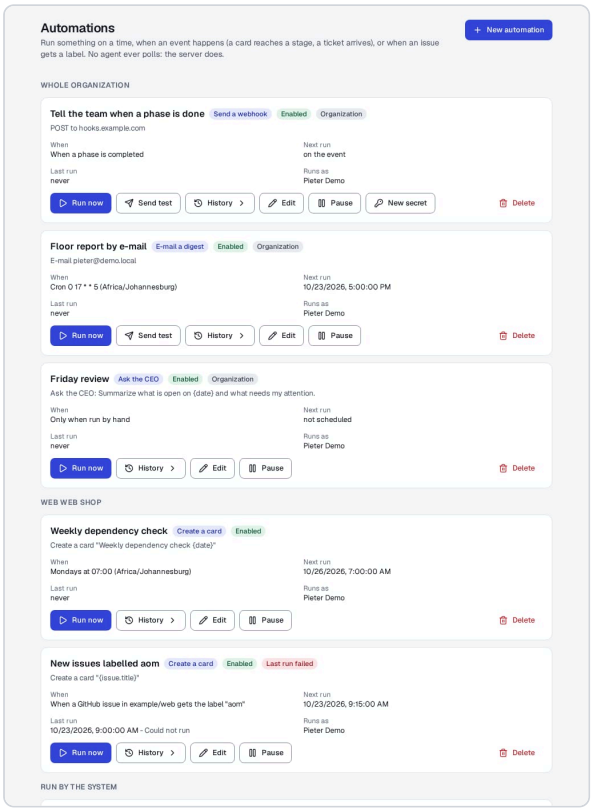


Figure 50 — The automations page

When (the trigger):

Trigger	What it does
On a schedule	A time such as "Weekdays at 07:00" or your own cron expression, in a time zone you choose. If the server was down, a missed run happens once, not many times.
When something happens	A phase is completed, a card is finalized, an interest run is done, a project is converted, a card **reaches a stage** of a workflow, a card of a workflow is **done**, or an **investigation is reported**. For the card events you can narrow it to a workflow, a stage, a card type or a field value. Each event runs an automation once.
When an intake ticket arrives	The BA took a request into intake, from an issue poll or the intake chat. You can limit it to one source.
When an e-mail arrives	Someone writes (or forwards) to one of your Guildwise inbox addresses. You can limit it to some senders or to a word in the subject. See "E-mail inbox" below.
When a web address is called	Another system (monitoring, a form, n8n, Zapier) calls a private address. Saving makes the address and its secret; you see it **once**. Fields of what it sends fill the card through tokens such as `{hook.title}` and `{hook.customer.name}`, and are read as information, never as instructions. Cards start as drafts unless the Owner allows queued. Calls per hour are limited, every call is a run in the history, and **New secret** or **Switch the secret off** ends the old address.
When a reply arrives	Someone replies to a mail that became a card. The reply is added to the card as a comment, and the automation runs for it too.
When an issue is labelled	A GitHub or Jira issue gets a label you choose. One of your workstations checks, using its own login.

Trigger	What it does
Only when I run it	No automatic trigger. Use **Run now**.

What (the action):

- **Create a card** from a template, with the date or the issue title in the name if you like. For automations that react to an event you can also **fill the card from the event**: each line sets the title, the context or any card field to a text with tokens such as `{card.ref}`, `{card.title}`, `{issue.title}`, `{issue.key}`, `{event}` and `{date}` (the editor lists them). What a token stands for is copied as it is and never read as a token again. Choose whether the card **starts as a draft** (it waits for the BA or you to specify it) or **queued** for the agents. Cards made this way are marked as made by an automation. An automation makes at most 20 cards an hour unless you set another limit; more are skipped and one notice on your desk tells you. **Repeats** can prevent a second card for the same source card or ticket, or with the same title.
- **Run a regression** (a full test run).
- **Ask DevOps** to do something on a workstation, or run repository hygiene.
- **Ask the CEO** to look at something and put the answer on your desk as a notice (schedules that were made with "Ask the BA" now ask the CEO).
- **Poll GitHub or Jira issues** and send each new one into **intake**.
- **Send a webhook** to Slack, Microsoft Teams, n8n, Zapier or your own code. Every request is signed so the receiver can check it came from you. Failed deliveries are retried a few times.
- **E-mail a digest**: choose **Floor report (organization)** (the organization-wide facts of the day) or **Project summary**, at a time you choose. There is no interests digest here: an interest delivers its own digest (4.9).

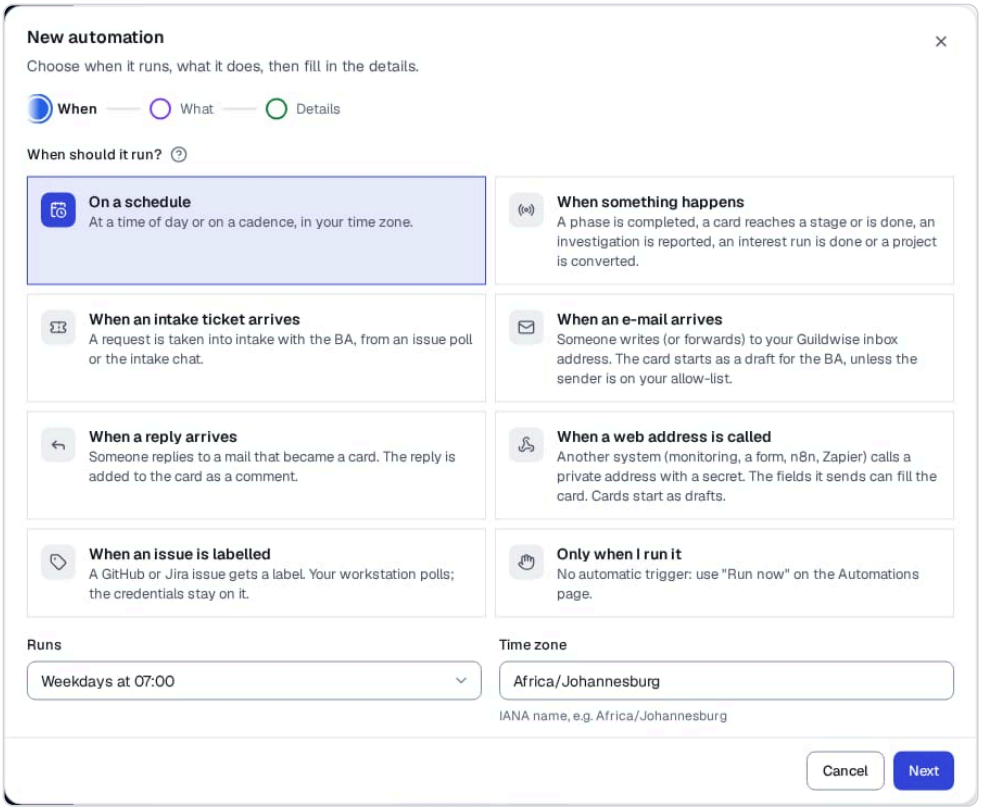


Figure 51 — The automation wizard

History on each automation lists every run, what triggered it, what it did and why it failed if it did. **Send test** sends one test delivery for webhooks and e-mails.

Who may do what. An automation inside a project can be made and run by any member of that project; a member's event automations make **draft** cards only, and an Owner or Admin can also let one queue its cards directly. An

automation that acts for the whole organization (**Ask the CEO**, hygiene, the organization digest) is for Owners and Admins. A suspended organization skips its automations.

From a workflow. In the workflow builder, **Starts automatically when** lists the automations that react to cards of that workflow and opens the same form with the workflow already chosen.

E-mail inbox. Every organization gets a **Main inbox** address automatically when it is created, so there is nothing to set up before you can use it. Under **Organization > E-mail inbox** (Owner and Admins) you see it and can make more, each with its own address, for example `acme-k3x9p2m7qd@in.guildwisehq.com`. **Copy** it, or use **New address** to replace it (the old address stops working at once). People can write to it directly, or you can **forward your own mailbox to it**: in Gmail, Settings > Forwarding and POP/IMAP > Add a forwarding address; in Outlook, Settings > Mail > Forwarding; in other systems use a forwarding rule or an alias. Your customers keep writing to support@yourcompany.com, and the **?** next to the forwarding note on the inbox page explains the same steps. The inbox page lists the recent messages and what became of each: *Draft card created*, *Card created*, *Added to a card* (a reply), or *Skipped* with the reason (looked like spam, the sender failed the DKIM check, an automatic reply, too large, too many in an hour, or no automation picked it up).

Then add an automation **When an e-mail arrives** and choose the inbox. **Fill the card from the event** with `{email.subject}`, `{email.body}`, `{email.from}`, `{email.date}` and `{email.thread}`. Mail is read as information, never as instructions: the text reaches the agents inside a marked block that tells them to treat it as data, HTML is turned into plain text, attachments are listed but not kept, and links are never opened. Cards from e-mail **start as drafts** for the BA or you to specify. The Owner can put senders (an address such as `ana@acme.com`, or a domain such as `acme.com`) on the inbox's **allow-list**; when the automation is set to *Queued for the agents*, a card from such a sender skips the draft step, but only if the sender's address could be verified (SPF or DKIM passed), because a From address is easy to forge. **Repeats** can limit it to one card per conversation or per subject and sender. A reply to a mail that became a card (by its reply headers or the address it was sent to) is added to the card as a comment and starts any **When a reply arrives** automation. **Reply.** On a card made from e-mail the card page shows the conversation with a reply box (also under **Conversation** in the inbox list). The Owner, Admins and the project's owner and managers may reply; it goes out as plain mail under your organisation's name, the answer comes back to the same card, and the reply is kept on the card. A reply that mentions agents, AI or Guildwise is refused so you can edit it. **Busy senders.** A sender who sends more than 20 mails an hour (`AOM_INBOUND_RATE_PER_SENDER_PER_HOUR`) is skipped and you get one notice a day.

Reply to a mail from Guildwise, and Draft with BA. On a card made from an e-mail (panel *E-mail conversation*) and on **Conversation** in the inbox page you can read the thread and **reply as your organization**; the reply goes to the sender of the latest accepted message and their answer comes back to the same card. Owners, Admins and the owner or managers of the card's project may reply. A reply that names an agent of the organization, "AI agent" or Guildwise is refused so you can take it out: your customers see your organization only. **Draft with BA** next to *Send reply* asks a business analyst to write a reply from the conversation and the card, as your organization's own person in plain professional mail. It takes a minute or so; the draft then appears in the reply box for you to read, change and send. Nothing is ever sent by itself, and the sent reply records that it started from a draft. You need a BA hired under Agents; without one the button says so.

Intake and the outbox. The **Intake** page (sidebar, Owners and Admins; it needs the integrations feature) is where you bring a ticket in, in **One ticket (chat)** or **Batch** mode. As the Owner you can press **Tell your CEO** (it opens the CEO chat with your request waiting, and the CEO has the BA write the spec), or **Work with the BA directly** (Admins see **Start intake** instead): paste a Jira key or a GitHub issue address and the BA reads it, asks you about anything unclear, maps it to a project and drafts the cards. Updates the agents want to post back to the ticket (a comment, a resolution) wait on your desk as **Outbound update** items. You can edit them, approve or reject. Nothing is posted without your approval, and agent names and internal details are scrubbed from the text. Jira and GitHub logins stay on your workstation.

Batch intake. To bring in many tickets without a chat per ticket, open **Intake**, switch to **Batch**, paste one ticket per line (Jira keys or URLs, GitHub issues; up to 50), optionally pick a project for all of them and add a note, then **Start**

batch. The BA works through the tickets in the background, two at a time, doing what it does in a chat: it reads the ticket, maps it to a project, writes the spec and creates the cards. Tickets that already have a card are skipped ("skipped: already P4-12"). When the BA cannot go on with a ticket (unclear, no project fits, missing access) it asks one question on your desk that names the ticket; your answer resumes that ticket and the others carry on. The batch page shows each ticket's status, its cards and the question, with **Retry** for failed tickets and **Cancel batch** (tickets the BA is already working on finish).

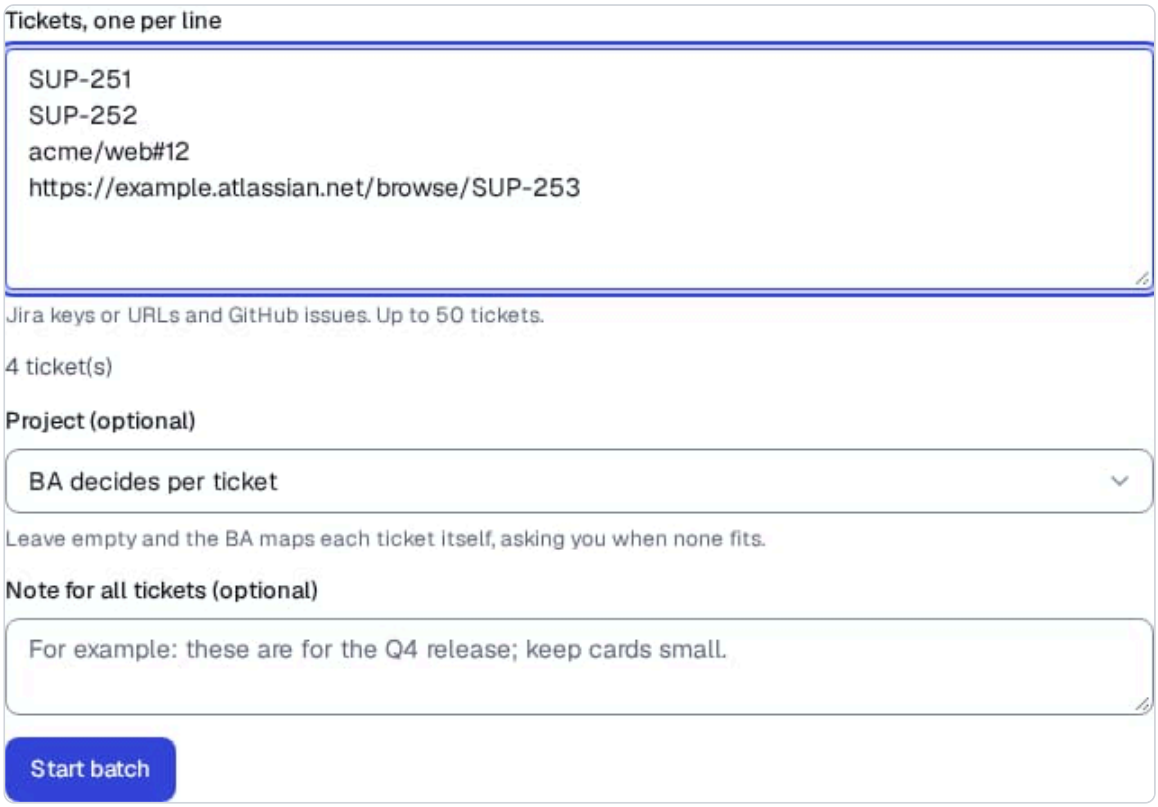


Figure 52 — The Batch form: one ticket per line

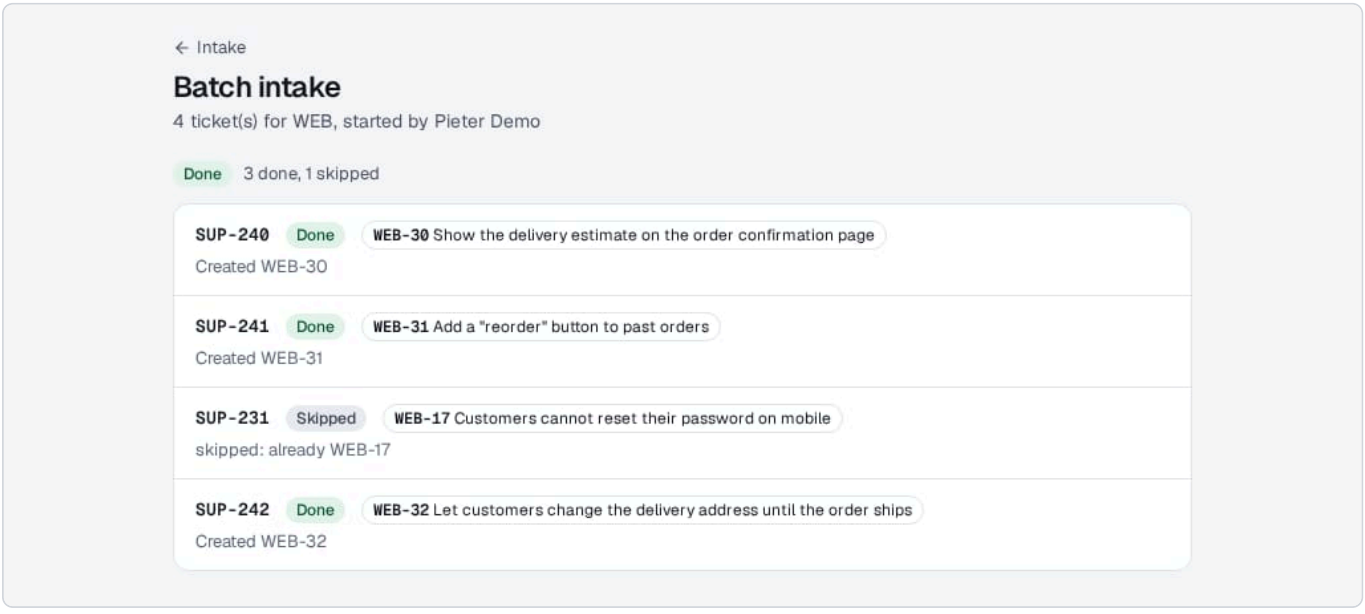


Figure 53 — A finished batch: each ticket with its status and its card

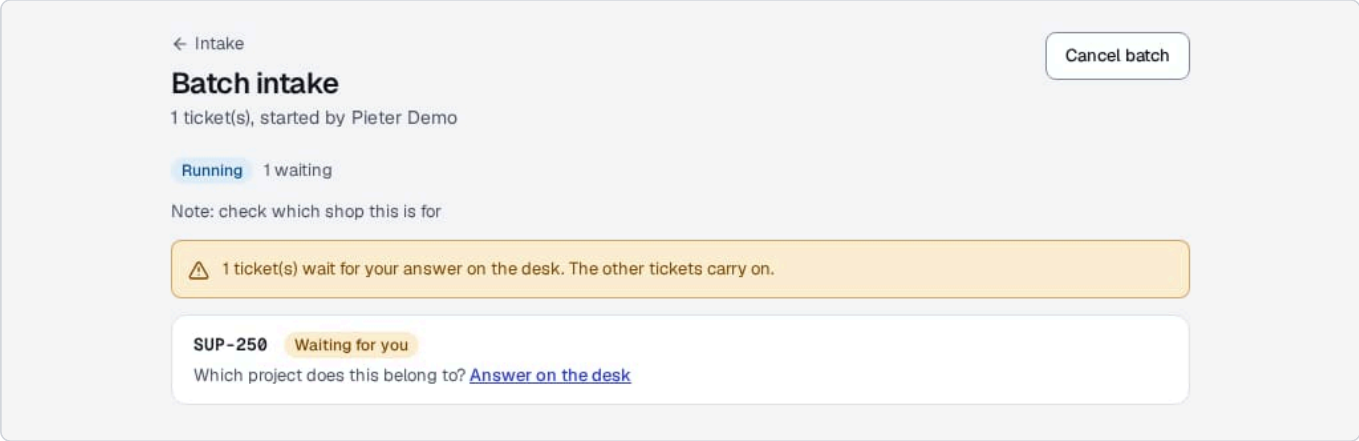


Figure 54 — A batch where the BA waits for your answer

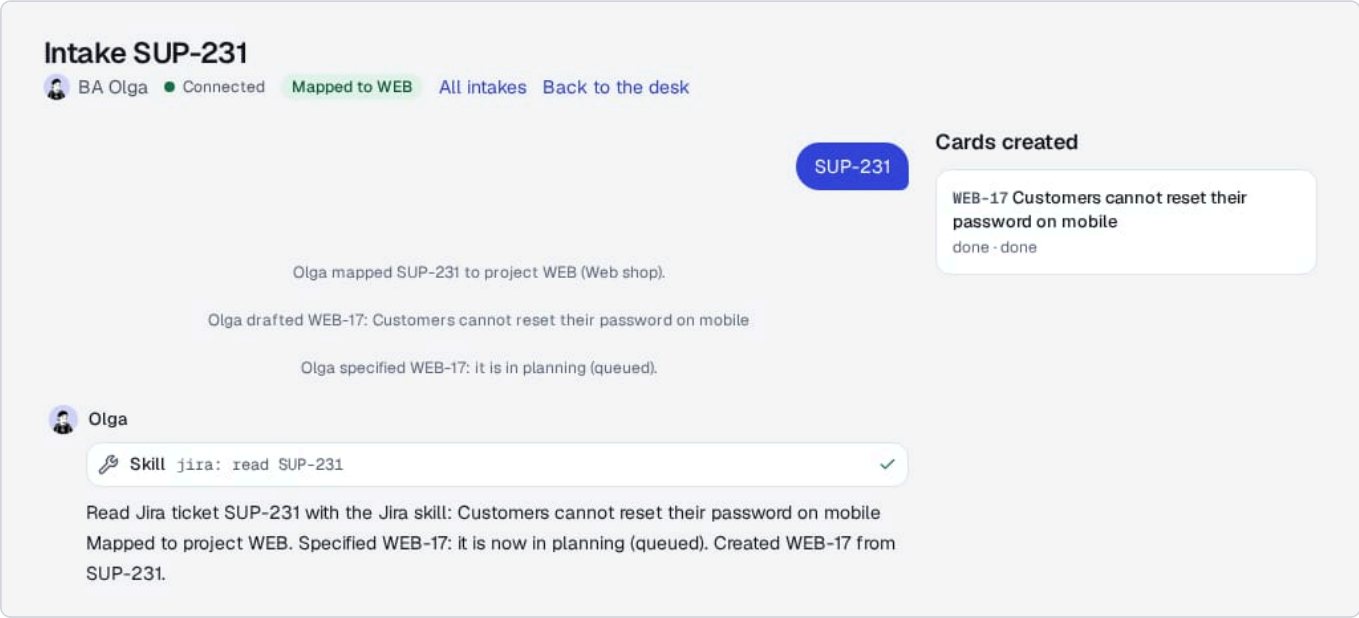


Figure 55 — Intake

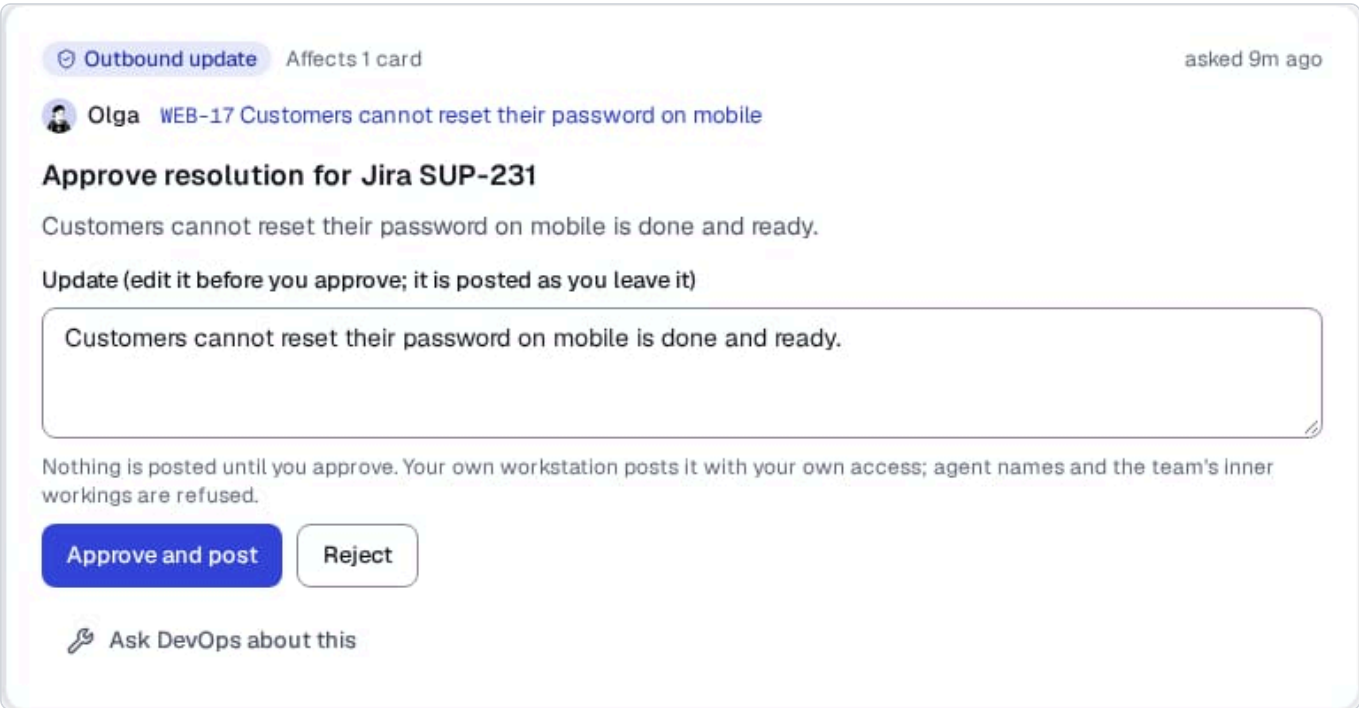


Figure 56 — An outbound update waiting for approval

Jira attachments (screenshots and design files). The Atlassian tool the BA reads Jira with shows the names of a ticket's attachments but not their content, and the agents' sandboxes have no internet. So the BA asks your **workstation's runner** to download them: it uses an API token that you save once on that computer and that never leaves it. On the workstation run `aom-runner jira-connect` (Jira Cloud: your Atlassian e-mail and an API token from https://id.atlassian.com/manage-profile/security/api-tokens; Jira Data Center: a personal access token and no e-mail). The Workstations page then shows **Jira: Connected as your name** (or **Not connected** / **Refused** with what to do). From then on, when you hand the BA a Jira ticket, it lists the ticket's attachments, downloads the images and design files (20 MB per file), looks at every screenshot and SVG, writes what they show into the cards and attaches the relevant files to the cards (see 3.7), so builders and testers can look at the same pictures. It only reaches the ticket you gave it, never another one. If the workstation is not connected the BA tells you and carries on without the files.

> **In the app**
> Help, "Automations and integrations" (`/help/automations-and-integrations` ; the old `/help/schedules-and-integrations` still works) and "Intake and outbox" (`/help/intake-and-outbox`).

4.9 Interests

An **interest** is a topic you follow. Agents look for new items on a **run schedule**, and deliver what they found to your desk on a **delivery schedule**. Keeping those two apart is how you avoid being flooded.

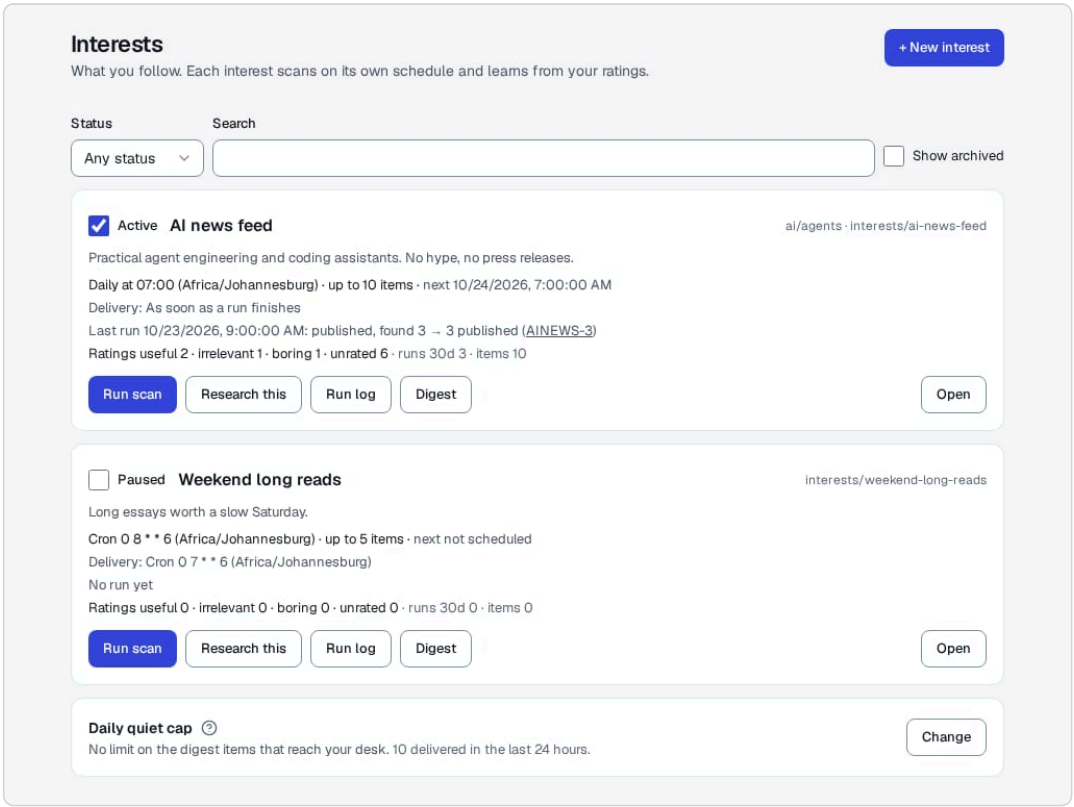


Figure 57 — The Interests page

Create one: Interests in the sidebar, then **New interest**. Fill in:

- **Name and description:** the angle, what to include and what to leave out.
- **What to collect:** articles, videos, podcasts, and the most items per run.
- **Run schedule:** for example "Daily at 07:00", or only when you press **Run now**.
- **Delivery schedule: As one digest at set times** (for example weekdays at 07:00) or **As soon as a run finishes**.
- **Preferred agents:** a scout, a curator, a researcher and a fact checker. This is a soft preference. Any available qualified agent takes the run, so nobody waits.

On the interest's page, **Overview** shows both schedules and what is waiting for delivery. **Run log** lists every run with its items, cost and agents. **Digest** is the running list of everything delivered, with rating buttons. **Settings** and **Taste** are where you tune it.

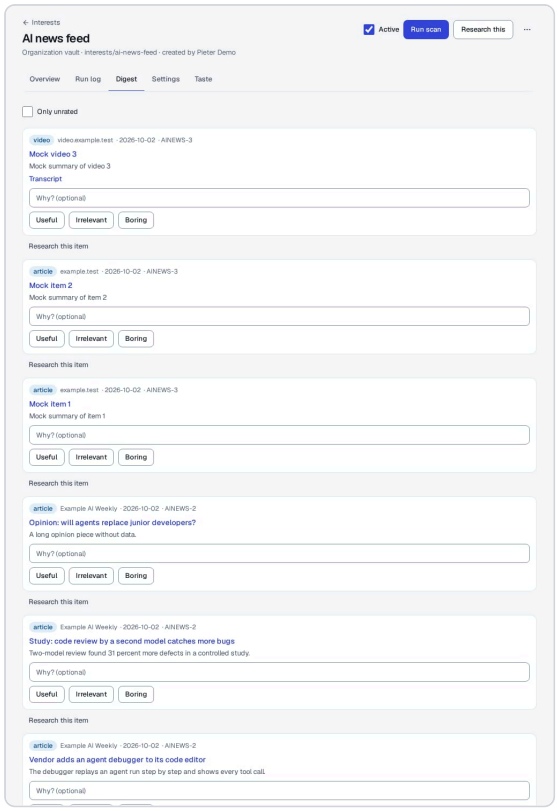


Figure 58 — An interest's Digest tab

Find and tidy. The list has a **Status** filter, a **Search** box and a **Show archived** switch. **Deliver N now** on an interest sends the N items that are waiting for the next delivery at once. The interest's menu also has **Archive** (**Restore** brings it back from the archived list) and **Delete permanently** (removes its cards, items, seen-list and run log; its vault folder is never touched).

Teach it your taste. Rate digest items **useful**, **irrelevant** or **boring**. The curators learn from the ratings and write rules into the interest's `taste.md`. You can also type your own rules on the **Taste** tab ("Skip beginner tutorials"). Your written rules win over the learned ones.

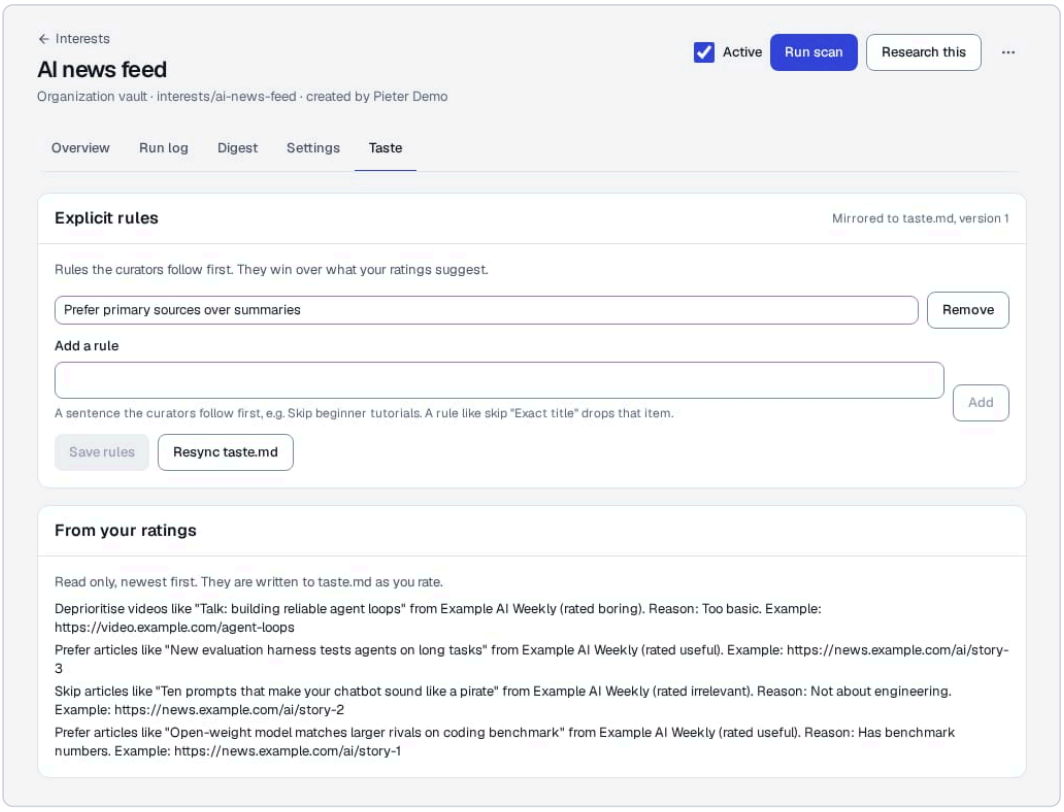


Figure 59 — Taste rules

Research this. On an interest or on one digest item, **Research this** starts a researcher and a fact checker, with the depth you choose (**Quick**, **Standard** or **Deep**), and publishes a note into the interest's folder. Research happens only on demand.

The daily quiet cap (bottom of the Interests page) limits how many digest items reach your desk in a day across all interests. Items over the cap wait for the next delivery.

Transcripts. Videos and podcasts come with a transcript so you can read instead of watch. Transcripts of video sites need **yt-dlp** on the workstation (the installer offers it).

Who sees an interest. Owners and Admins see all interests. An interest made by a Member or Guest is private to them until an Owner or Admin shares it. Whoever made an interest, or someone with an equal or higher role, may change it.

> **In the app**
> Help, "Interests" (`/help/interests`).

4.10 Phases and follow-ups

A **phase** is a named slice of a project's work, the cards you want to ship and check together. When all its cards are finished and merged into the working branch, your BA tells you and proposes what happens next: deploy, run the regression suite, something custom. **Nothing runs until you approve.**

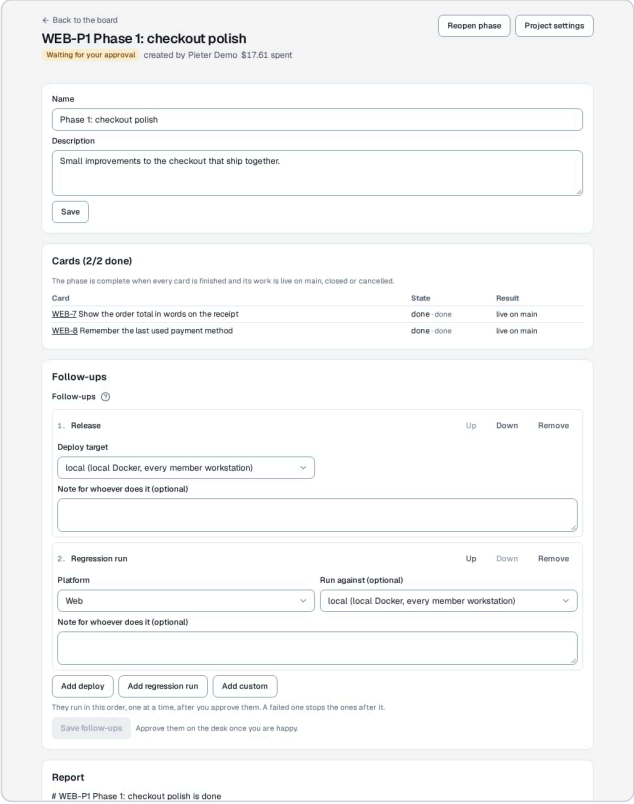


Figure 60 — A phase

Set up (Environments page): the **default follow-ups** every new phase starts with live on the project's **Environments** page, under **Rules**, as "What a new phase does when it is finished", for example "Release to the test site, then to the live site (it waits for you)". A follow-up that releases picks an **environment** (the test site, the live site, an extra site), not a technical target; the live site always waits for the Owner. Where each environment runs is set up once under **Places** (4.27).

Create a phase under **Project settings, Phases, New phase**, or let the BA propose one while you talk about the work ("this is phase 2"). Add cards from the phase page or from the card's **Phase** selector. A card belongs to at most one phase.

When is a phase done? The phase is complete when every card is finalized and its work is live on main (or closed or cancelled). In expert mode, if the app cannot see a squash-merged branch, click **Mark merged** on the phase page.

The "Phase done" item on your desk carries a report of what was delivered and what is outstanding. You can **Edit follow-ups**, **Approve all**, **Reject** (nothing runs), or **Reopen the phase**.

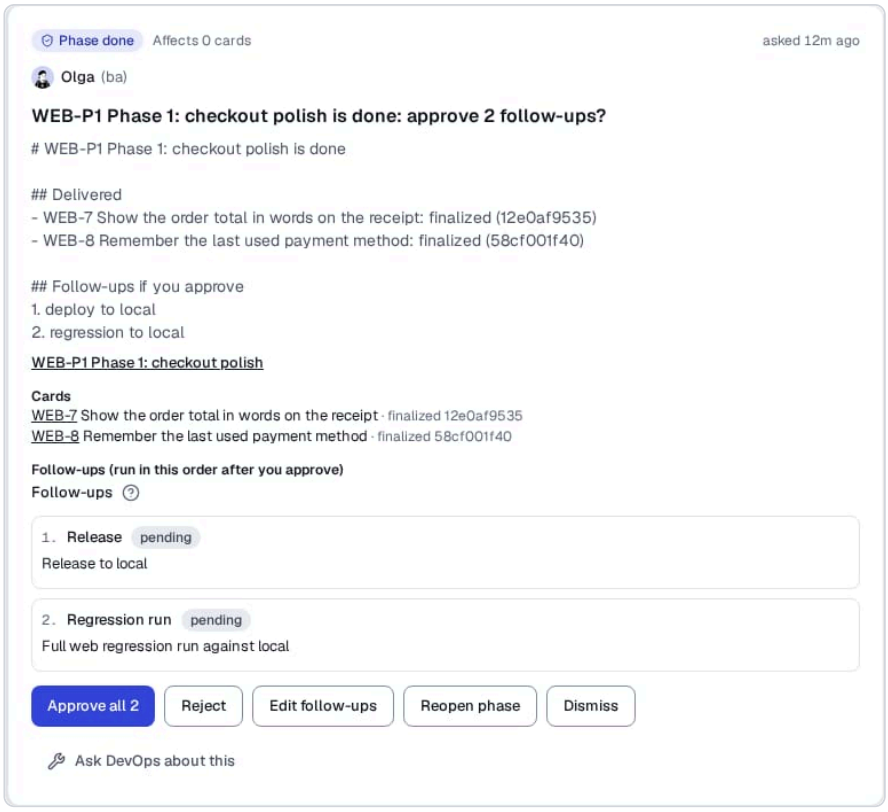


Figure 61 — The phase-done approval

What runs after you approve: the follow-ups run **in order, one at a time**. If one fails, the ones after it are skipped. At the end a **Phase results** notice lists each result with its evidence.

> **In the app**
> Help, "Phases and follow-ups" (`/help/phases`).

4.11 Your CEO reports to you

Your CEO is your eyes and ears on the floor, and it never slows an agent down. This section is about what reaches you and when; the CEO itself (its page, tabs, authority and chat) is in 4.22. The BA is a spec writer only and no longer reports. Reports it wrote earlier stay on your desk, and its "BA reports" chat is read-only.

What goes through the CEO. Urgent items such as blocking questions and approvals reach your desk **at once**, unchanged, and the CEO is woken for them too. Less urgent items wait up to **10 minutes** for the CEO, which passes them on, folds duplicates together, or dismisses noise it can show is covered. If the CEO is slow, **paused**, or its workstation is offline, items reach you unchanged: nothing waits for a CEO that cannot look, and if something urgent waits more than 30 minutes you get a notice and an e-mail. There is no switch for this; the CEO is always there, and **Pause** on the CEO page is the emergency stop.

Signals the server watches (every minute, without spending tokens):

Signal	Threshold	You hear
A card keeps failing	3 failed shifts on one card in 10 minutes	At once
The same approval asked again and again	3 times in 24 hours	In the daily report
Blocked too long	A blocked card waits more than 4 hours	In the daily report
Nobody can take it	A queued card nobody can take for 30 minutes	In the daily report
Repeated failures	A card in rework round 3, or finalize failed twice	In the daily report

Signal	Threshold	You hear
Repository hygiene problem	A conflict, wrong branch, login failure or missing clone	In the daily report
Budget	80% of a monthly budget, or 100% (paused)	80% in the report, 100% at once

The daily report. At the report time you set on the CEO page, **Reporting & alerts** tab (08:00 by default, in your time zone, 4.30), the CEO puts one report on your desk, titled "Daily report <date>", on days with something to say. It lists what needs you, what the CEO decided (with Undo), phases waiting, stuck and backing-off cards, repeated approvals, failures, open DevOps requests, **spend**, the new backlog suggestions from agents and highlights from your interests. Open **The facts behind this report** for the same lists straight from the server, and talk to the CEO about anything in it. When the CEO cannot run for two hours the server posts a plain template report with the same facts. Scheduled tasks that ask the CEO for something are in 4.8.

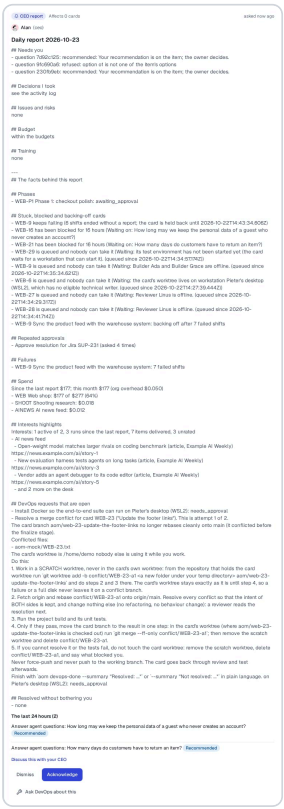


Figure 62 — The CEO's daily report on the desk

> **In the app**
> Help, "The daily report and what is watched" (`/help/ba-reporter`) and "Your CEO" (`/help/ceo`).

4.12 Testing, finalizing and risk

Once a reviewer approves, the card moves to **Test**. A tester runs the tests of the test plan. If they fail, a bug card is created on the same branch, and the original card waits ("waiting on bug") until the bug is fixed and the tests pass.

Risk tier. The app computes it from the size of the change: **Small**: one reviewer and one tester. **Large** (200 or more changed lines, or changes in the architectural areas you configured, or a refactor): two different senior reviewers. You can override it on the card (**Change** next to the risk tier) with a reason. A 50-line change to a critical system may deserve large-tier review.

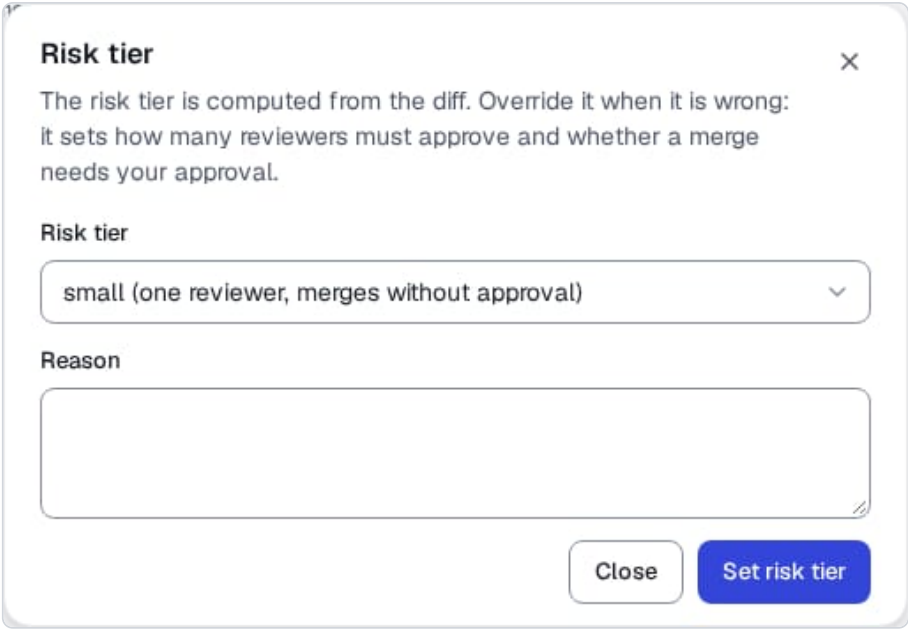


Figure 63 — Setting the risk tier

Finalize. The BA completes the card the way the project's **How finished work lands** says (4.4): committed and pushed to the working branch, or as a pull request for you. In expert mode a card can have its own completion action: **Commit and push to the working branch** (no pull request), **Pull request** (push the card branch and open a pull request into the working branch). A card branch is only ever pushed to the git host when the work goes out as a pull request; otherwise it stays on the workstation. **A large change that would be committed to the working branch waits for your approval** on the desk, and the card stays in the Finalize column with an "Awaiting your approval" badge.

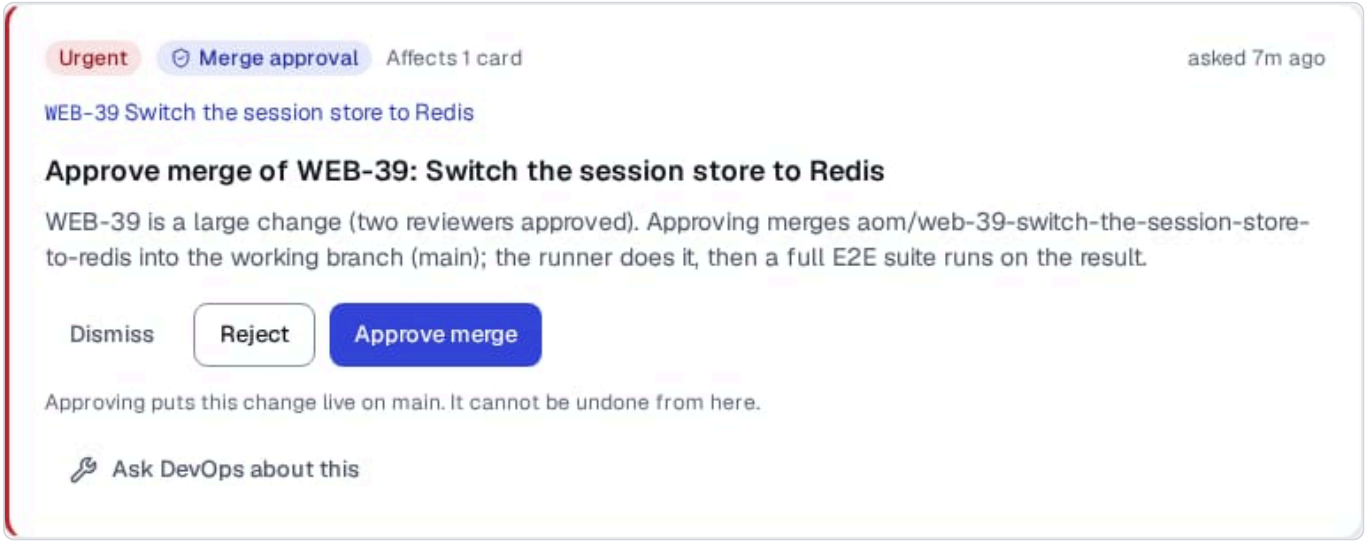


Figure 64 — A large merge waiting for approval

> **Watch out**
> In project settings, **Merge large changes without my approval** lets large changes merge as soon as they are finalized. Only the two reviews, the tests and the post-merge full suite then stand in between. It is off by default, only the project owner can change it, it asks you to confirm, and every change is recorded.

Manual QA. When a card is finalized (merged, pushed or turned into a pull request) it does not go straight to Done. It goes to the **QA** column, assigned to the person who started it: whoever ran the intake chat or batch, else the card's creator, else the project owner. An agent (the tester, or the BA when no tester is hired) writes the test steps on the card, grouped by scenario (happy path, edge cases, error handling, regressions, UI and data checks). The assignee

gets a desk item and the card shows under **Waiting for my QA (n)** on the board (a card that waits for your approval, 4.26, shows under **Waiting for my approval (n)**). They choose:

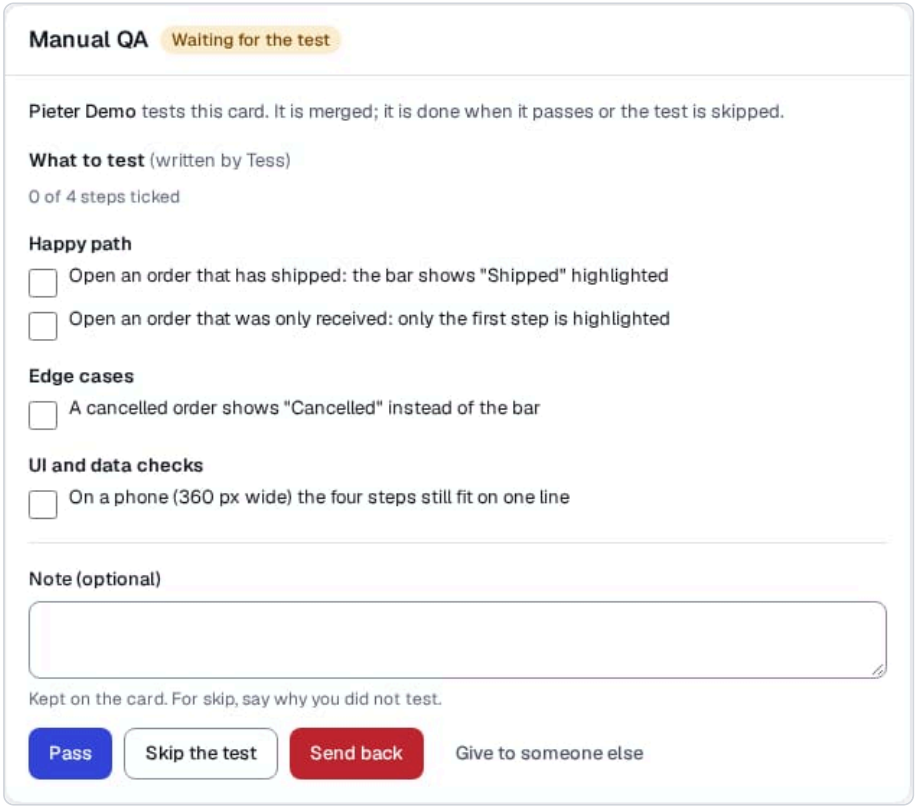


Figure 65 — A card in QA: the test steps and Pass, Skip the test, Send back

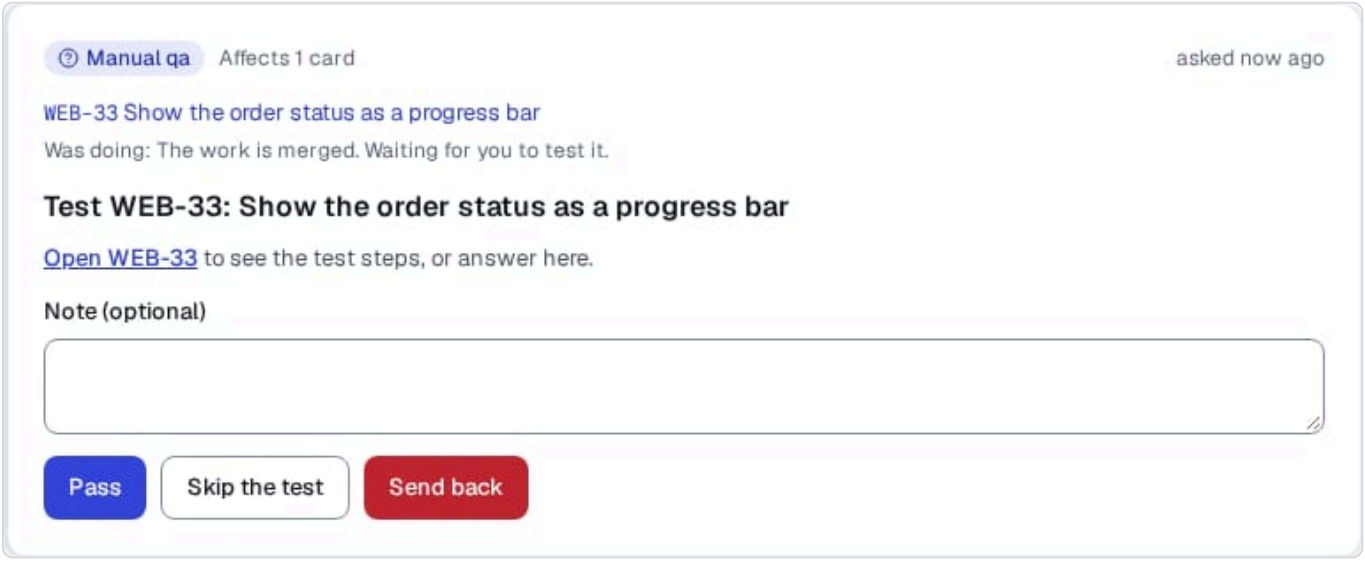


Figure 66 — The QA item on the desk

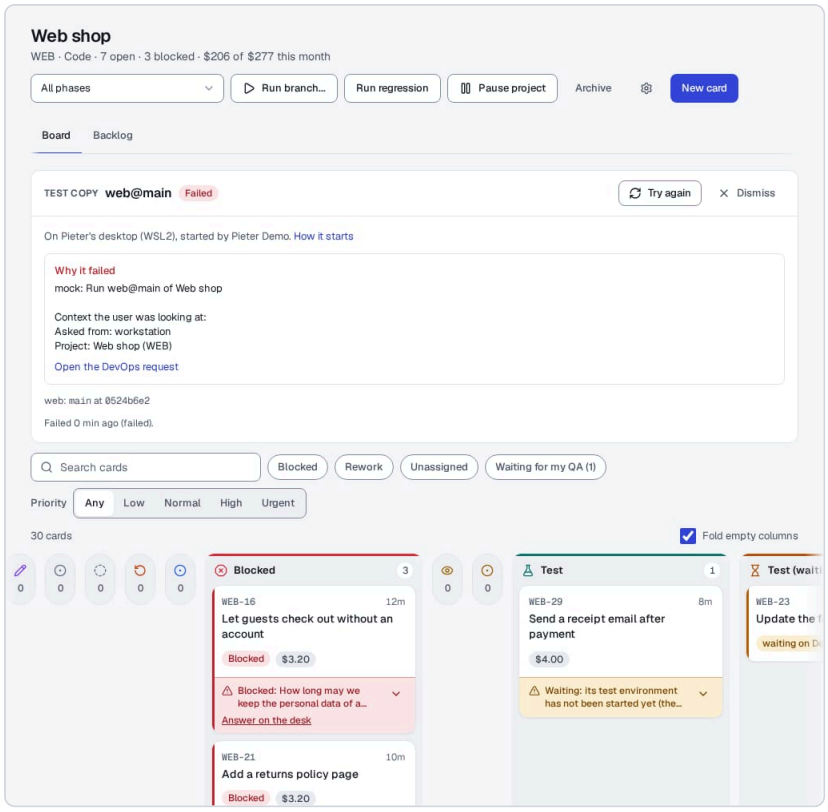


Figure 67 — The board with the Waiting for my QA filter

- **Pass**: the card is accepted and moves to Done.
- **Skip the test**: not tested; the card moves to Done and the card says so. Add a reason if you like.
- **Send back**: a comment is required. The card returns to Build as rework with your comment as a review comment for the builder, in the same branch that already holds the merged work, and goes through review, test, finalize and QA again. You never have to reopen a closed card.
- **Give it to someone else**: pick another member of the project; they get the desk item.

The update that the BA drafts for the Jira or GitHub ticket is held while the card is in QA. **Passing the card or skipping the test approves it**: it is posted to the ticket at once from the card owner's workstation, with no further approval on the desk. A card that is sent back keeps its update held until a later pass. The assignee, the project's owner and managers, and the organization's Owners and Admins can act on a card in QA.

Manual QA is on for every project. The project Owner and the organization's Owners and Admins can switch it off in the project's **Settings**, **Manual QA before done**. The setting counts when a card is finalized: a card already in progress follows whatever is set at that moment, and a card that is already in QA stays there until someone decides. Scheduled (automatic) cards and investigation-only cards have no QA.

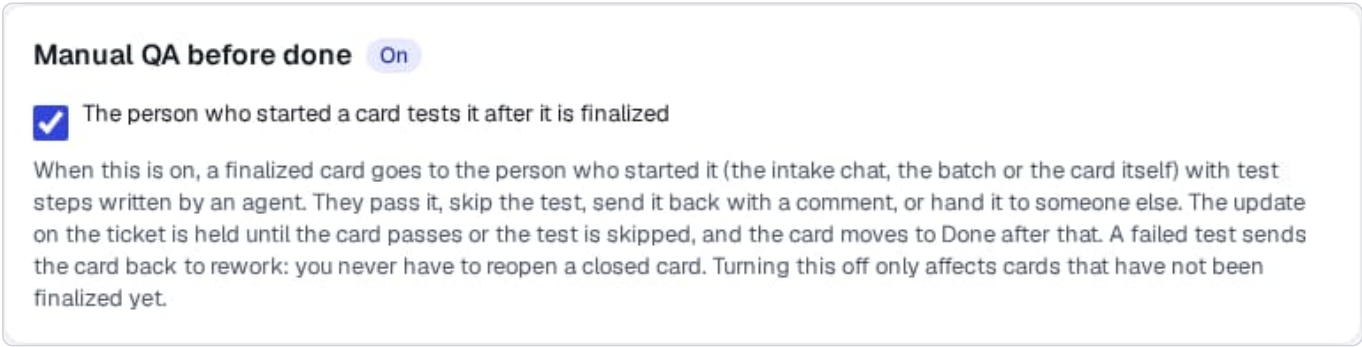


Figure 68 — Manual QA before done in the project settings

After a merge, a **full suite** card runs the entire end-to-end suite once. If it fails, a bug card and a desk notice follow. **Run regression** on the board runs the whole suite on demand.

> **In the app**
> Help, "Testing and finalization" (`/help/testing-and-finalization`).

4.13 Conversion, the Research tab and research cards

Research cards in any project. Pick the card type **research** on the New card form to ask a question in any project. It runs on the research workflow (question, research, fact check, publish) and gets a **Research** chip on the board.

Converting a project. A project that started as research converts to a delivery project when the questions are answered. Owners and Admins do it in **Project settings, Stage, Convert project** (or the **Convert to project** button on a research project's board). A short dialog asks:

1. **Workflow:** the target, usually Code.
2. **Repositories:** a workflow that works in code needs at least one. Add one, or **request a new GitHub repository**. The request lands on your desk and your own workstation creates it with your GitHub login when you approve. (A new repository on GitLab, Bitbucket or Azure DevOps is created from the project settings instead, 3.6.)
3. **Open cards:** for cards that run on another workflow, choose **Keep** (they finish on their own workflow) or **Cancel**.
4. **Hand-over:** the published notes are listed in the project's `PROJECT.md` so every agent that works there reads them.

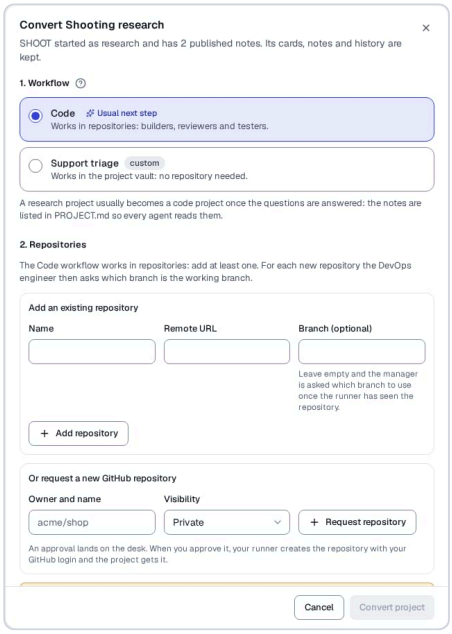


Figure 69 — The Convert project dialog

Cards, notes and history stay as they are. For each repository added, the DevOps engineer asks which branch is the working branch.

The Research tab. A project with published research notes (or one that started as research) has a **Research** entry in the sidebar. It lists the research cards in progress and every published note with its path in the vault, a preview and its sources.

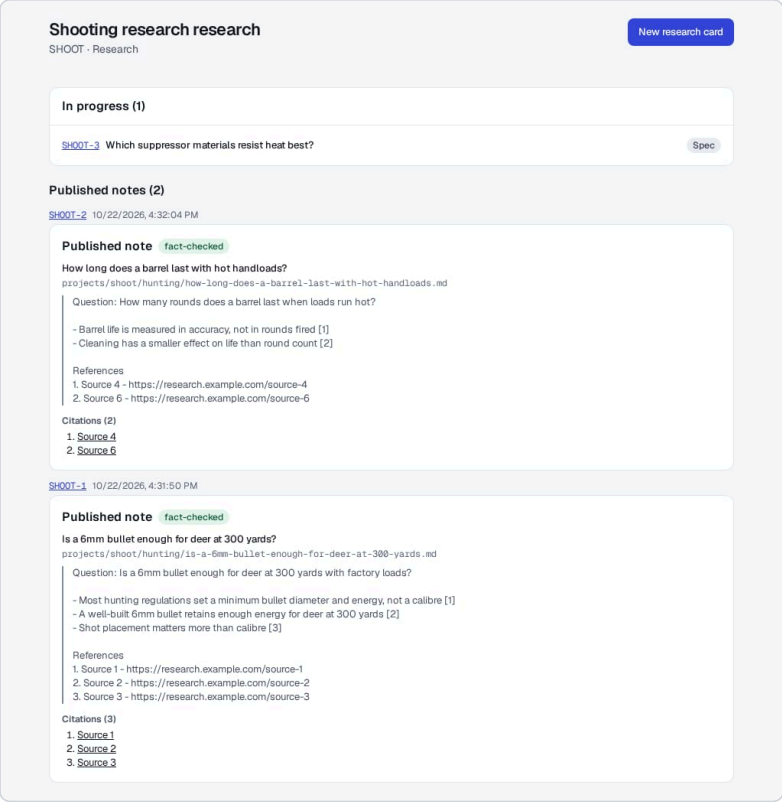


Figure 70 — The Research tab

> **In the app**
> Help, "Converting a project" (`/help/project-conversion`).

4.14 Archive and delete

Archive a project you no longer use: **Project settings, Archive, Archive project**. The dialog lists what will stop (running shifts, open cards, schedules and open desk items) before you confirm. Branches and history are kept. Agents are not fired. They simply stop getting the project's work. **Restore** it from **Projects, Archived**. Cards the archive closed stay closed.

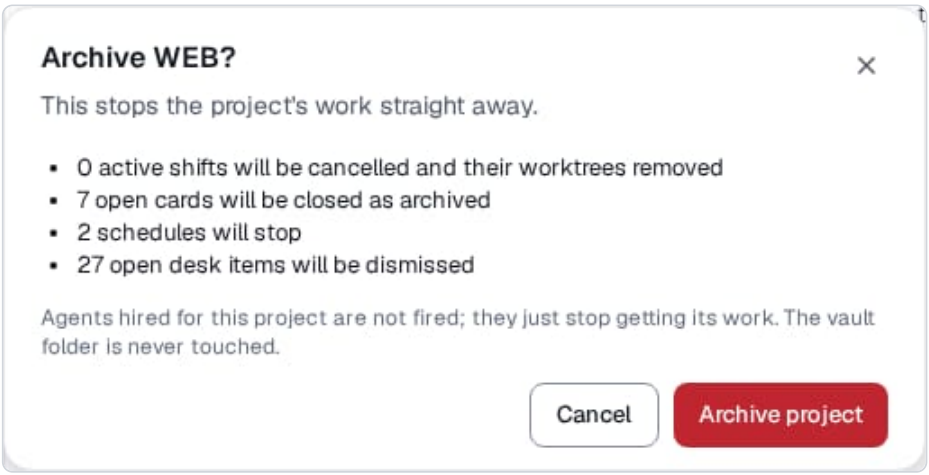


Figure 71 — Archiving a project shows what will stop

Delete permanently is possible only for an archived project, only for the project owner, and asks you to type the project key. The project's cards, threads, schedules and notes are removed from the database and cannot be recovered. The audit log keeps a record and the vault folder is never touched. An agent that was allowed on that project only is **benched**, and the desk names the benched agents so you can reassign them.

4.15 Security and two-factor login

Everyone can turn on two-factor login under **Your settings** (3.2). As Owner you can **require it for the organization** on **Organization, General** (see the General tab in 4.1). Members who have not set it up are then held at the setup screen until they do. You need it on your own account first.

If a member loses their phone and their recovery codes, you reset their two-factor login on the **Members** tab (**Reset two-factor login**, Owner only). They set it up again at the next sign-in.

Reset a member's password (Owner and Admins). An Owner may reset a Member or an Admin; an Admin may reset a Member only (never an Owner or another Admin), and nobody resets their own password this way (use **Forgot your password?** on the sign-in page). If a member cannot get the reset email, open the actions menu on their row on the **Members** tab and choose **Reset password**. Guildwise HQ makes a strong temporary password and shows it to you **once**, with a **Copy** button: send it to them yourself, in a message only they can read. No email is sent and we do not keep the password. The member is signed out everywhere, and the next time they sign in with the temporary password the app asks for a new password before anything else (two-factor login still applies). A Guildwise HQ account is one account for every organization: if the member also belongs to other organizations, the new password applies there too. The reset is recorded in the organization's activity and never contains the password.

> **Tip**
> A suspended organization (unpaid, trial over) keeps its data. Running shifts finish, nothing new starts, and only the Owner can still sign in to see settings and members. Everything resumes where it stopped when the platform administrator reactivates the organization.

4.16 Plan and limits

Organization, Plan & limits shows your plan, status, licence date, how much you use, and which features are switched on. Organizations set up by invitation are on the free **Founding** plan with every feature and **no limits**; they stay free until the Owner subscribes (4.17). The platform administrator can also give an organization the **Unlimited** plan (no billing, no limits). If a feature is switched off, its page leaves the sidebar, but its data is kept.

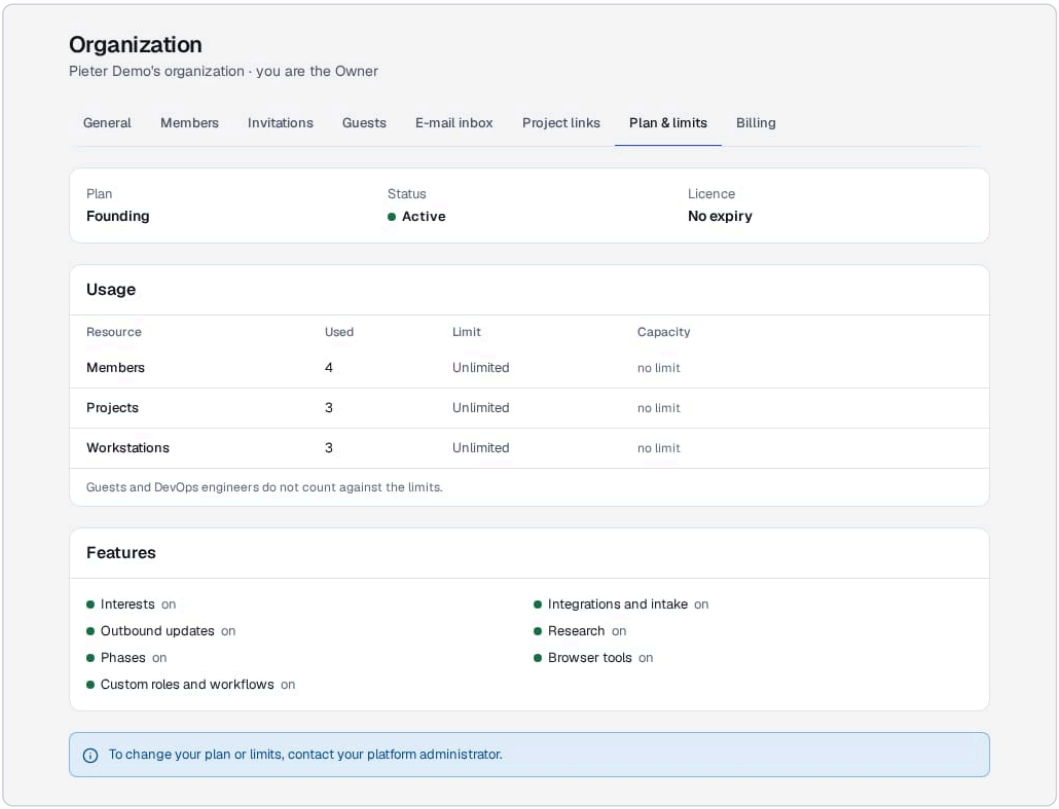


Figure 72 — Plan and limits

4.17 Billing

Only the **Owner** sees **Organization, Billing**. Plans differ only in limits (members, workstations, projects); every plan has every feature and **no limit on agents**.

Plan	Per month (US dollars, VAT included)	Members	Workstations	Projects
Starter	$19.00	2	1	3
Team	$49.00	5	3	10
Business	$149.00	20	10	Unlimited

- **Signing up.** Choose a plan at **Start free trial**, confirm your email (required), then add a card on the full-page **Start your 7-day free trial** screen that replaces the app until a card is saved (Sign out and Contact us stay available; a sign-up without a card is removed after 14 days). The **7-day free trial** starts; the first invoice is charged when it ends, then monthly. A reminder is emailed two days before.
- **Company name.** Guildwise HQ is sold to businesses, so sign-up asks for your company name.
- **Charged in rand, VAT included.** The price is a fixed dollar amount that includes 15% VAT. Each charge converts it at the day's exchange rate. Every invoice shows the dollar price, the VAT it contains (in dollars and rand) and "charged as R x at R y / USD on <date>". We never see or keep the card number: you enter it on Paystack's secure page and we keep a secure token with the brand, last four digits and expiry (we email you before it expires). **Update card** replaces it.
- **Billing profile.** Under Billing the Owner edits the company name, address, country and VAT number (optional). They are printed on your invoices; paid invoices keep the details they were issued with.
- **Tax invoice. View / print tax invoice** next to an invoice opens a printable page (use Print, then Save as PDF).
- **Change plan.** Takes effect at once and is prorated for the rest of the month: you pay the difference now, or get a credit on the next invoice. A plan too small for what you use is refused.
- **Business add-ons.** Add members, workstations or projects (priced per unit). They start with the next billing cycle and never go below the Business base.
- **Cancel.** The organization stays active until the end of the paid term (or trial), then is paused. **Keep my subscription** takes it back before then.
- **Failed payments.** Three attempts (now, after 1 day, after 3 days); you are emailed each time and can update the card. After the third failure the organization is **paused**: agents stop picking up work and only the Owner can sign in. The Owner sees a full-page **Resubscribe to continue** screen (reason, plan, amount due, **Update card**, **Resubscribe now**, Sign out, Contact us) instead of the app, and **Resubscribe now** charges a new month and resumes everything. The same screen appears when the subscription was cancelled and its term ended. Members see a banner asking them to contact their Owner.
- **Platform administrators** see the active payment provider and its sandbox or live mode, and edit prices (VAT included), limits, add-on prices, the VAT rate, the invoice details (company name, address, VAT number printed on tax invoices) and the exchange-rate override under **Platform, Billing**, and can pause, unpause or assign **Unlimited** from an organization's page (each with a reason, audited).

See the help article *Plans and billing*.

4.18 Chatting with agents

Click **Chat** in the top bar (or on the Desk), pick an agent and choose **Start chat**. Ask about a card, discuss a blocker, or ask the BA to draft cards. The BA works with your rights, so it can only use projects you are a member of. Conversations are saved, and a chat tied to a project is marked as visible to that project's managers.

What an agent can read in a chat. A chat with an agent that works on code (a builder, the Architect) about a project can read the project's own repositories (read-only) when they are cloned on the agent's workstation, plus the project's **Reference repositories** (project settings). A chat about a card whose work folder is on that workstation reads that folder, plus the reference repositories; if the card has not been started there, it falls back to the project's repositories.

The BA reads no code: it works from the ticket, the project notes, the vault and the ledger, and puts code questions into the card for the Architect (turn on **Investigate & design** for such cards). The agent also reads the **knowledge vault**, read-only: the project's vault (or the organization vault when the project has none) in a chat about a project or a card, and the organization vault in a chat with no project, the latter only on the workstation of an Owner or Admin. The same vault is open to the agent in questions and the business analyst's tasks. If the vault is not cloned on that workstation the agent says so. Nothing else on the machine is open to the agent, and it cannot change any of it. To let an agent compare another repository, ask the project owner to add it under **Reference repositories** in the project settings. (The workstation's DevOps engineer is different: it works as you and can read everything.)

A card with no repository (projects with several). You never have to pick a repository for a card, and neither does the CEO. On **New card**, choose **Not sure: let the BA find out** under Repository (it appears when the project has two or more repositories), or leave the repository empty and use **Send to BA** on the draft. The BA finds the repository through the project's code graph (it still reads no source code), the project notes and the vault. If the card belongs to one repository, the BA sets it and the card is specified. If it touches several, or has clearly separate sections, the BA **splits** it into 2 to 8 cards, each with its own repository and with dependencies between them where one must land first. The original card is then cancelled as **split**: its page shows **Split into** with links to the new cards, and each new card shows **Split from**. Nothing needs your confirmation. If no BA is hired, or the graph does not cover every repository yet, an Architect does the same by reading the repositories. When nobody can tell, the CEO gets the card first and only reaches you if it cannot decide. The repository of a card cannot be changed once the card has a worktree or a branch. This needs a runner of version 0.1.40 or later on the workstation of the BA (or Architect).

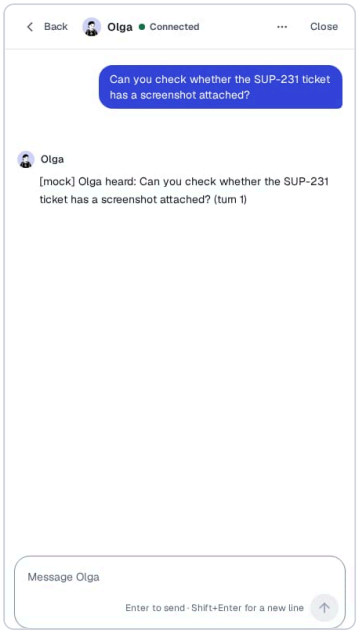


Figure 73 — A chat with the BA

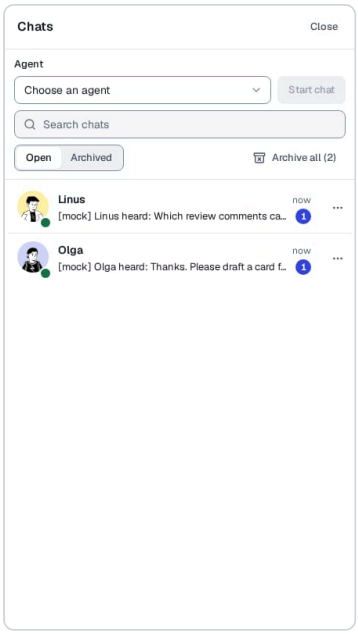


Figure 74 — The chat start screen lists earlier conversations

> **In the app**
> Help, "Chat with agents" (`/help/chat-with-agents`).

4.19 Cloud workstations: a VPS or a Codespace

You do not have to leave a computer switched on. In **Workstations**, **Add a workstation**, choose where the agents run:

- **A VPS (SSH).** Enter the address, port, user and a password or SSH key of any Linux server. Guildwise logs in once, installs the runner and pairs it by itself. The password or key is used for that one login and is not stored. A VPS is always on; start and stop it at your VPS company. A guide for renting and preparing one is in `docs/BYO-VPS.md`.
- **GitHub Codespaces.** Connect GitHub with a token that has the `codespace` scope, pick the repository and machine, add the generated `devcontainer.json` to the repository (it holds no secret), and create the codespace. It installs the runner and pairs by itself. It stops after 30 minutes with no agent working (you can change this), wakes by itself when a card is queued, and can be kept asleep outside optional **office hours**. **Wake** and **Stop** buttons are always there.

By default an organization has one cloud workstation, shared by all its projects. Each one shows an **estimated monthly cost**. You pay your VPS company or GitHub directly; Guildwise does not charge extra. If your Codespaces credits run out or the codespace cannot start, a notice appears on your desk, you get an email, and the card shows **Needs attention**; fix it on GitHub and press **Wake**.

Docker. A Codespace cannot run Docker. If you deploy Docker images you still need a workstation of yours or a VPS for that, and your deploy targets must point there. The Workstations page reminds you when you only have Codespaces.

Claude sign-in. Use your own Anthropic API key (the default): on a VPS run `read -rs K; printf %s "$K" | aom-runner auth api-key`, in a Codespace add the Codespaces secret `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY`. A Claude subscription also works but is for one person's own use, so the page warns about "individual use". You can also paste the API key (or sign in with `claude setup-token`) on the **Integrations** page, sealed in your browser for that workstation (3.4a). Guildwise never receives or stores a Claude key or token.

> **In the app**
> Help, "Cloud workstations (VPS and Codespaces)" (`/help/cloud-workstations`).

4.20 The architect: investigate and design

The **architect** is a senior agent on the most capable model (Opus, high effort). Before a builder starts, it reads the card's code and the organization's other repositories, compares options, searches the web for best practice and writes a report. For a card that will be built the report is the **design**: the files to change, the data model, the risks and how each acceptance criterion maps to the design; the builder reads it first. It never builds the change itself, and it costs more per shift than a builder, so the step is **off by default**.

Turn it on. Hire an *Architect* (4.4), then open the project's settings, **Architect**, tick **Investigate & design before build on new cards** and **Save**. If no architect is hired the page warns you and a notice goes to your desk, because cards would wait in the new **Investigate & design** column. On a single card, **Investigate & design before build** in the New card or Edit form overrides the project (switch it off for a typo, on for an uncertain approach).

Investigation-only cards. Tick **Investigation only** for a comparison, a "how should we ..." or a spike: nothing is built. The architect writes the report; the BA records the result as a ledger entry (a decision when it is one) and adds it to the **Investigations** list in the project's `PROJECT.md`, which every later shift reads; then the card is done. Such a card needs only a title, context, requirements and a repository. The card page shows the report (summary and a link to the file on GitHub, GitLab, Bitbucket Cloud or Azure DevOps).

Where the report goes. By default a markdown file in the repository, `docs/investigations/<ref>-<title>.md`, committed on the card branch and merged with the card. In the project settings you can change the folder, or choose the **knowledge vault** (nothing is committed; the BA then finishes the card without a merge). One card can name its own **Report path**, or `vault:<path>`.

Merge the latest main branch first. When a repository has a main branch and a different working branch, the runner merges the main branch into the working branch and pushes it before work on a card starts, so the card branch is cut from up-to-date code. If the working branch is protected or changed meanwhile the card branch takes the merge instead; a **conflict** is resolved by the architect (conflict files only, no behaviour change), and on a card without an architect the merge is skipped with a note on the card and on your desk. On by default; the project setting or a card (**Merge the latest main branch first**: Project default / Yes / No) can switch it off.

What the architect may do. It writes only documentation (`docs/**`, `*.md`) and its report; the runner checks this after the shift. It reads every repository of the organization's projects that is cloned on its workstation, read-only, with secret files blocked, plus every git repository under an **organization source folder** if the workstation's owner sets one: on the **Workstations** page the row **Organisation source folder** (visible to the owner only, for the current organization) shows the folder or "not set", how many repositories it holds and whether it is ok or invalid with the reason, offers the folders the workstation reports or a typed path, and has a **Clear** button (the CLI `aom-runner org-folder set|clear|list` does the same on the machine). The workstation validates the folder and can refuse it; the architect may read every repository in it, read-only, and secret files stay blocked. It cannot push, fetch or pull from its own shell: the runner publishes the card branch for it on request. **Dependencies.** A dependency counts as satisfied once its work has *landed* in the working branch: the card is done or cancelled, or it passed Finalize with a merge (even while it still waits in Manual QA or an approval step; a pull-request card counts once its merge is seen, else at done). A card's first branch-creating step (Build) waits for that. The architect does not have to wait: it may design a card before its dependencies landed, in a read-only copy of the working branch with no card branch. It builds on the dependencies' specs and designs and records its assumptions (assumption, which dependency, what changes if it is wrong). The card then waits in the design stage; when the dependencies have landed the architect gets a short follow-up shift to check each assumption against the landed code and either confirms the design or revises it, and only then does the card go to Build. The card page shows "Design made before P5-14 landed: assumptions to review" and afterwards "Assumptions reviewed: 3 confirmed, 1 revised", and under **Depends on** whether each dependency is "waiting to land" or "landed (in manual QA)". An investigation-only card still waits, and a send-back of a dependency in Manual QA does not stop cards that already started (its rework lands in the working branch later). The report of such a design is saved in the project vault, or carried on the card and committed by the builder at the start of Build.

Good to know
A card already in Build cannot get a design step afterwards, and switching the step on for a project does not touch cards that are already past Spec.

In the app
Help, "The architect: investigate and design" (`/help/architect`).

4.21 Run a branch to try it

You can start a project on any branch of any repository to try it, without leaving the app. It runs **on one of your workstations** as ordinary processes (links open `http://localhost:<port>/` there).

Start it. On a card that has a branch, press **Run this branch**: the card's repository runs at the card branch and the project's other repositories at their working branch. On the project's board, press **Run branch…**: choose the workstation, tick the repositories and pick a branch for each, and, when the project declares several services, tick the ones you want (the ones they need are ticked for you). Only online workstations with an up to date runner that hold a clone of the repository are offered.

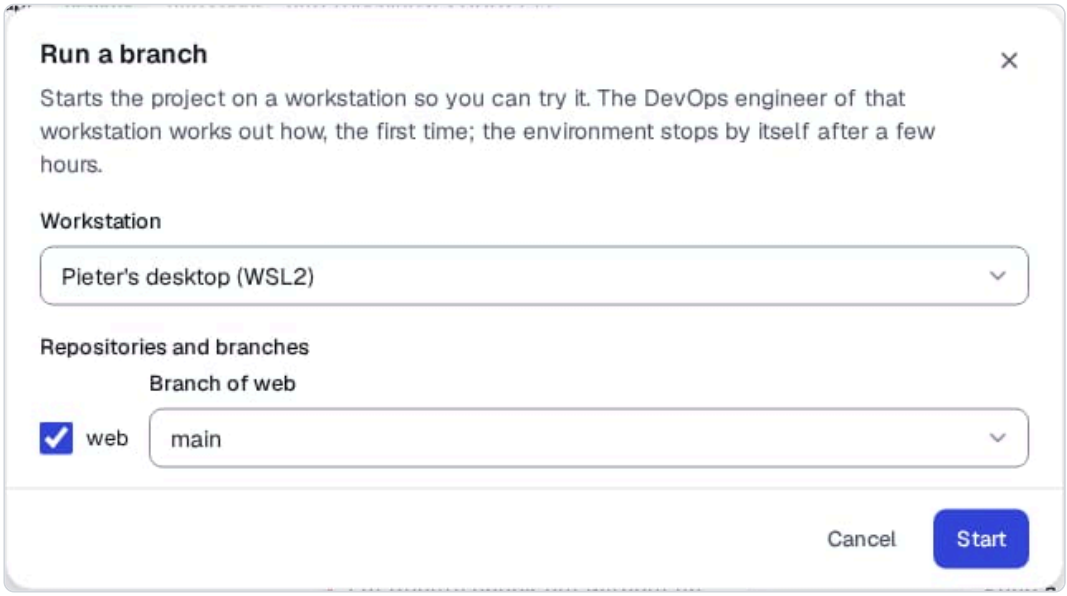


Figure 75 — The Run a branch dialog

What happens. If the project has **run steps** (see below), the workstation replays them in seconds. If it has none yet, the workstation's DevOps engineer reads the repository's `BUILD.md` and the **run instructions** in Project settings, works out how to run the project, starts each service and checks it is healthy; what worked is saved as that workstation's plan. You watch the panel: its state (preparing, starting, running, degraded, failed), every service with its state, ports and links, the commit each repository runs at, and **Logs** (the last 500 lines, then live). If a replay fails, the engineer repairs it for that workstation and saves a new version. Nothing is added to your repositories.

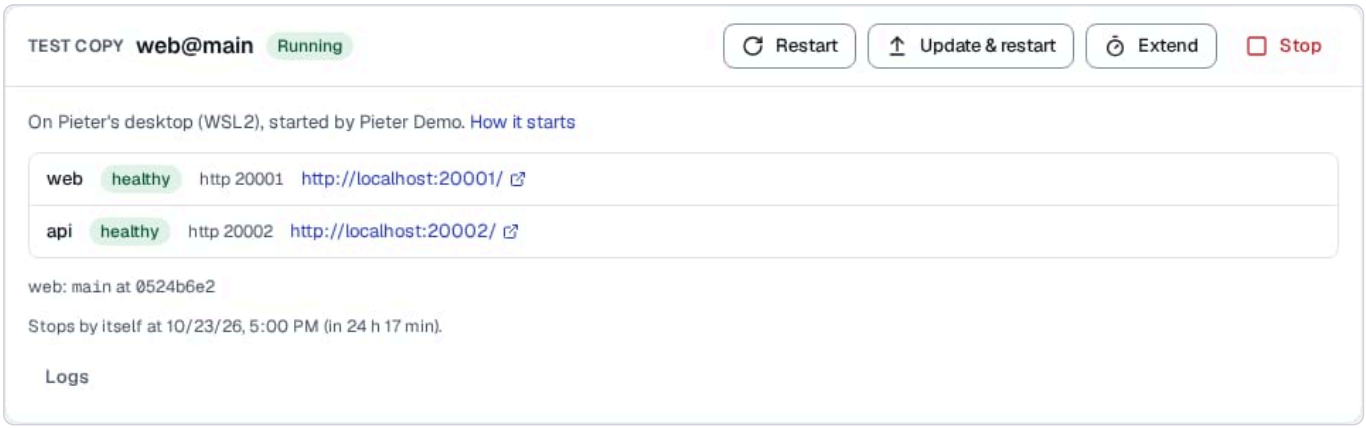


Figure 76 — A running environment: services, links, commits and the stop time

Restart. Restart starts the services again at the same commit. **Update & restart** first brings the run copy of the code up to the head of its branch (it refuses if the branch was rewritten) and runs the install steps that need it. A stopped environment keeps its run copy for a day, so Restart brings it back quickly.

Stop it. Stop ends the services; the run copy of the code is kept for a day, then removed. An environment stops by itself after the project's time (8 hours by default); **Extend** adds the same again. A workstation runs at most two environments at once. The **Workstations** page lists everything running on a machine, for all projects.

Environments, Your app: the run steps. This is where you tell Guildwise how to start your app, in plain words (it used to be under Project settings, Run and test; the old link still lands here). You do not need to know how to code. It shows whether the app is **set up** ("Starts in 4 steps on any computer of this project. Last start: worked 2h ago") and offers two ways in:

- **Scan with DevOps.** Choose a computer that has the project's code and press **Start the scan**. DevOps only reads the project (the README, package files, Docker files and so on); it does not start, install or change anything. After a few minutes a **suggestion** appears with **Review**. Every part is marked **Found** (DevOps read it in a file and says which), **Guessed, please check** (press **Looks right** or **Edit**) or **Needs your answer**. The questions are at the top, in plain words ("Which page shows that the website is ready?"); **Answer** opens the part. **Use these steps** is available once every question is answered; **Test first** starts the app once from the suggestion; **Dismiss** puts it away. Nothing is saved until you press **Use these steps**.
- **Set up myself** (or **Edit steps**). Two lists: **Before starting** (things that run once, such as installing packages, a build, or preparing the database) and **Parts of the app** (what keeps running: the website, a database in Docker). **Add a step** or **Add a part** opens a short list ("Install packages", "Start the website or app", "Start a database or service (Docker)", ...); each asks only what it needs, in words ("Which folder?", "Which port does it use?", "How do we know it is ready?"). Move a card up or down, edit it, or remove it. Problems are explained in words ("Two parts are both called web").

Test these steps starts the app once on one of your computers from the steps on screen (saved or not) and says what happened: **Started. Open it:** with the link, or **The app did not start** with the reason. **Use these steps** saves them for the whole project: every computer replays them, a card test included. The owner's steps are never replaced behind your back: if a start fails, DevOps repairs it **for that computer**, and the page lists it under **Computers with their own steps** with **Use the project version here** and **Make this the project version**. Docker steps need Docker allowed for the project; the page offers **Allow Docker** when it is off.

Show technical details keeps what developers set: free-text run instructions for the project and for each repository (they win over `BUILD.md`), the build guide, the stop time, whether the branch's code may use Docker (off by default; with it on, Docker steps run outside any sandbox, so only for projects you trust), the declared **services** (name, repository, folder, command, ports as `name:default:ENV_VAR`, health check, what it starts after, the path of an env file on the workstation), the saved plans of each computer, and, on every step, its real command, settings and stop command. Put secrets in an env file on the computer, never in the settings: only its path is stored.

Build guides above the repositories. If your repositories sit side by side in one folder (for example `src/dcode/sources/`) with a `BUILD.md` in that folder, the workstation finds it too (it looks in the folders above each repository, up to your code folder, never in your home folder) and gives it to the DevOps engineer with the repository's own `BUILD.md`. The **Build guide** field under Your app, Notes for DevOps (technical details) takes the full path(s) of the guide(s) on the workstation instead, if you would rather name them. Git submodules are fetched into the run copy. Services can read your .NET user secrets (`~/.microsoft/usersecrets`), read-only.

When it cannot run. A failed environment stays on the board, the card and the Workstations page with its reason (the DevOps engineer's report) and a link to the DevOps request; press **Try again** (same repositories and branches) or **Dismiss**. When the DevOps engineer is stuck on something only you know, the panel says **Waiting for you** with its question and the options; answer on the DevOps request (Workstations page) or the desk and it carries on.

> **Good to know**
> The links point at `localhost` on the workstation. If your browser is on another machine, the panel shows the `ssh -L` command that forwards the ports. The services run in the runner's sandbox: they use the machine's network, but can write only to the run copy and cannot read your credential folders. Docker services (only if you allowed Docker) run outside the sandbox, and the panel says so.

> **In the app**
> Help, "Run a branch" (`/help/board-and-cards#run-a-branch`).

4.22 Your CEO

The **CEO** is the agent you talk to first. It runs the floor for you: it watches every project, agent, workstation and budget, unblocks what is stuck, answers the routine questions it is allowed to answer, recommends the rest, keeps the team the right size, hands work to the BA, the team and DevOps, and writes you one report every morning. It replaced the BA's daily floor report, the BA's triage of held desk items and the BA's urgent notes (the BA reporter is gone: the BA is a spec writer only and keeps intake, specs, finalizing, phases and design chats). **Every organization has exactly one CEO, built in:** there is nothing to appoint, hire or dismiss, and it does not count against your plan's agent or workstation limits. Only the **Owner** configures and talks to it. Admins can read its page and activity log and can pause it.

The CEO page. Open **CEO** in the sidebar (Organization group, `/org/ceo`). The Owner sees nine tabs: **Overview**, **Authority**, **Reporting & alerts**, **Persona & instructions**, **Memory**, **Tasks**, **Topics**, **Activity log** and **Workstations**. Admins see the Overview and the activity log, and can pause the CEO.

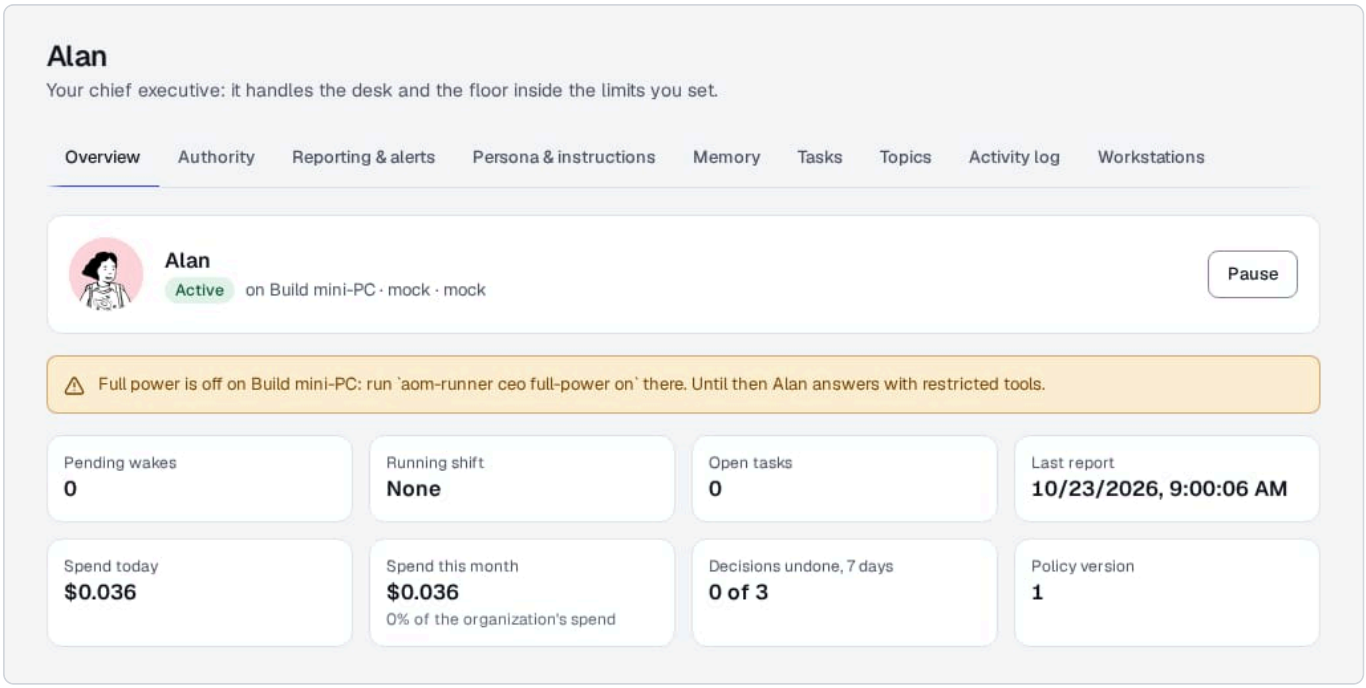


Figure 77 — The CEO page, Overview tab

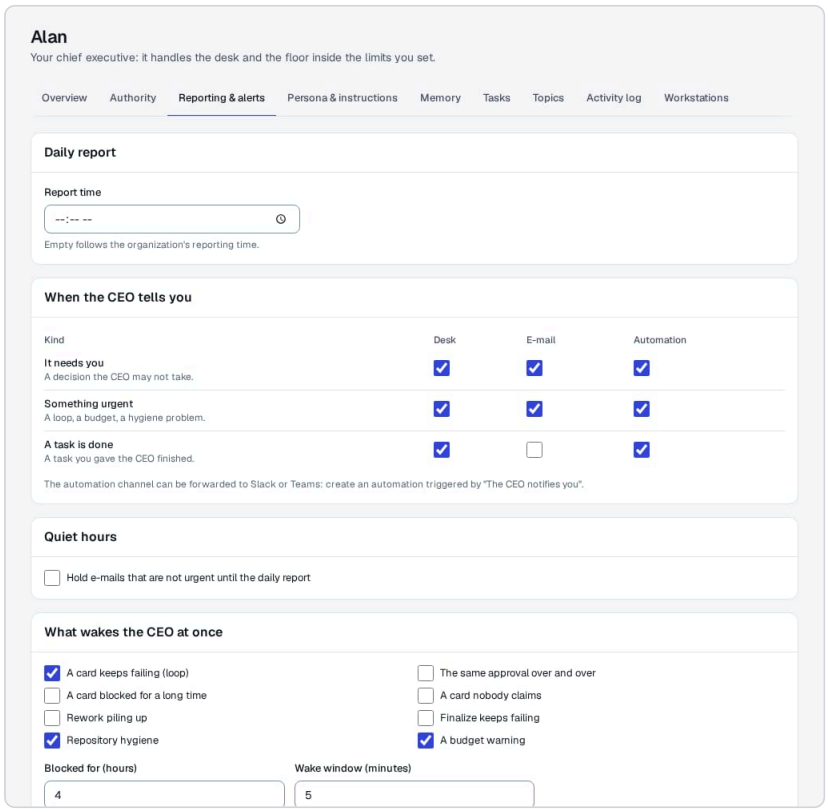


Figure 78 — The Reporting & alerts tab of the CEO page

Where it runs. The CEO lives on the Owner's own workstation (the first one they pair). To use another of your own workstations, open the **Workstations** tab and press **Move the CEO here** on it. Until a workstation is paired the page says "Pair a workstation to talk to <name>". Its background work (wakes and the daily report) is restricted: read-only, no web, one command, `aom`. **Pause** is an emergency stop: it may read but not act.

There is no training period. The CEO decides what your policy allows from day one; the Owner reviews and corrects what it did (see **CEO decisions** on the Desk and the **Correct** buttons below). Organizations that had a CEO in training were graduated when this shipped.

Full power in your own chat. When **you** talk to the CEO it is a real Claude Code session on your workstation: your own `~/.claude` settings, skills, plugins and MCP servers, your home directory and no Guildwise sandbox, and it can also act in Guildwise through `aom ceo`. That is the power you have yourself, so it is off until you switch it on **on that machine**: run `aom-runner ceo full-power on` and restart the runner (the Overview says "Full power is off on <workstation>" until then, and your messages still work in the restricted mode). Nothing but your own message starts such a turn: events, agents and your team never do. Set the session's fixed working directory under **Persona & instructions** (empty is your home directory); the session continues from message to message (it starts a new one, with a short handover, after 24 hours, a long context, another working directory or another model runtime). The runner's own program and secrets (`~/.aom-runner`) are off limits to it, and it restarts the runner only with `aom runner restart` after it has answered, never with `systemctl` or `kill`. Attached files are not supported yet.

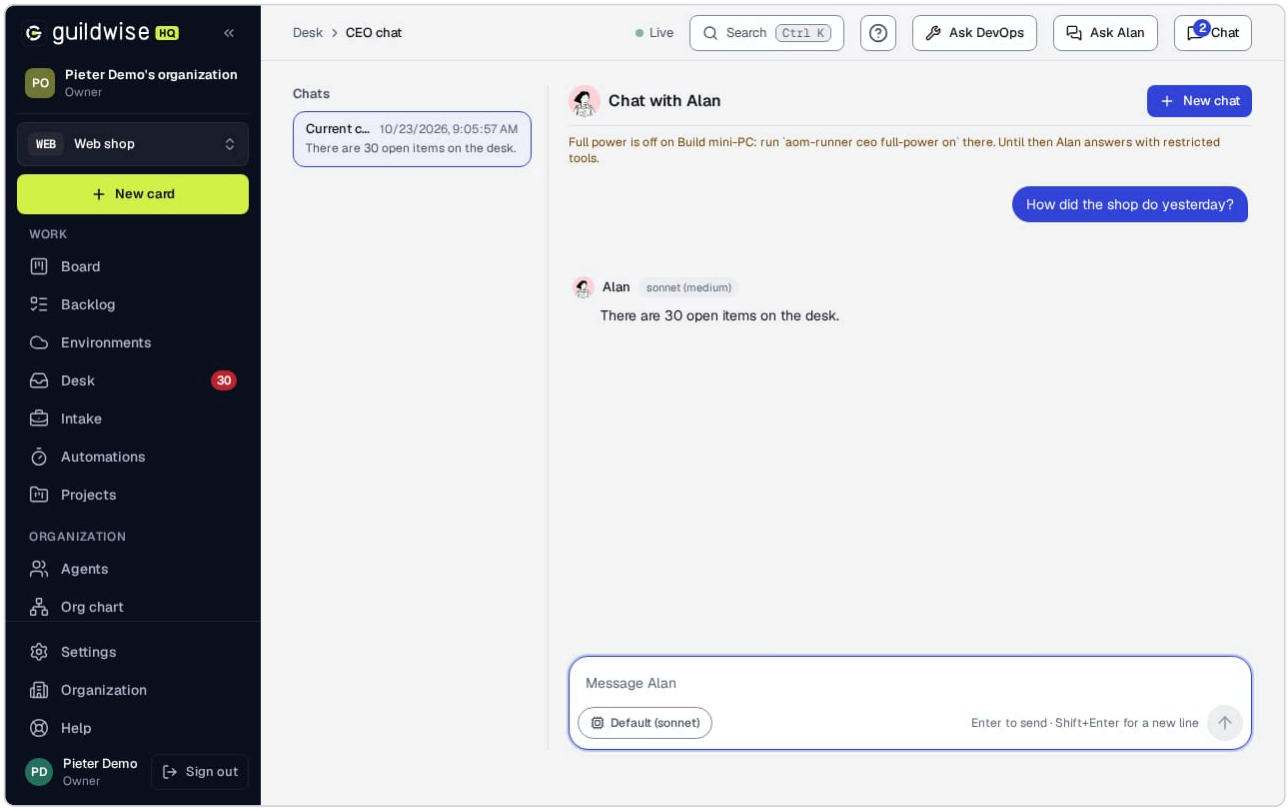


Figure 79 — A chat with the CEO

Authorize this execution. Turns run in auto mode: nobody types "allow" at a terminal. When the runtime needs a permission it does not have, you or any Admin of the organization get a question on the Desk, **Authorize this execution** (the tool, what it wants to run and why). **Authorize once**, **Authorize for this turn** or **Deny**. No answer within 10 minutes is a Deny. A phone notification only points to the Desk item. In your chat the question also appears as a card.

The model switch. The chip in the chat composer shows the model ("Default (Sonnet)"). Choose another model and effort for **this message** or for **this conversation**; **Back to default** returns to what the Persona & instructions tab says. The same runtime keeps its session when you change model; another runtime starts a new session with a handover. The reply shows which model answered. Opus costs more: the chip stays visible while a conversation override is set, and the Costs page shows the CEO's spend.

When your workstation is offline. Your message is saved and **queued** ("Queued: <name> answers when <workstation> is back"; a push says so too). When the runner is back the messages are sent one at a time, in order, and each reply says how long it waited. A message older than three days asks first ("This waited 3 days, still want it?": **Send** or **Drop**). A CEO turn is not lost when the connection drops: its reply arrives after the reconnect.

Use the system first. The CEO puts work about a project's product on the board (a card through the BA, with a ticket number and card type where there is one), hands installs, Docker and environment repairs to **DevOps**, and does one-

off jobs and research itself without ceremony. A job it did itself with tools is written to a log; the first edit inside a Guildwise project clone in a turn is stopped once with a reminder to use the board (say "do it directly" and it logs that and goes ahead). When you ask for the same kind of thing **4 or more times in 7 days, or 10 or more times in 30 days**, the daily report gets a section **Things you keep asking me** with buttons: **Make it a feature** (a card for the project), **Make it a skill** (a Claude Code skill in your `~/.claude/skills`, written in your own turn), **Automate it** (a schedule), or **Not a pattern** (silent for 90 days).

DevOps works through the CEO. There is no DevOps chat any more: **Ask DevOps** buttons open your CEO chat with the question filled in, and the CEO delegates, follows the request and tells you the result (it can wait for DevOps for a while in the same turn, then carries on in the background). Old DevOps chats stay readable. Approvals, the two-party rule and the DevOps guard are unchanged, and the Hygiene and Setup buttons still file their requests directly.

Corrections. Say "you did X, I'd rather Y" in the chat, or press **Correct** on a row of the **Activity log** tab, on a CEO decision on the Desk, or on a decision or an order turn in the daily report. A dialog asks what it should have done, whether to **make it a rule for next time** (on by default) and, when the action can be reversed, to **undo** it or **redo** it your way. The correction is remembered at once (an active memory of the kind *correction*), ranks **first** in every brief above your rules, preferences and anything the CEO inferred, and the memories the corrected action relied on lose confidence. An Admin can record the rule but cannot undo or redo.

Blog research topics. The CEO notices the problems you and your team run into (jobs it did by hand, things you keep asking for, corrections, parked cards, failed DevOps work, questions that waited hours for you) and can turn the ones other developers probably meet into **one general question**, such as "How can AI agents authorize production deploys without bypassing safety checks?". These are suggestions for the Guildwise blog, which researches each from public sources. Only the question and its area are ever sent: no names, no numbers, no project, repository or host, and no description of what happened. The server checks every question three times and refuses one that names anything of yours. Nothing is sent until you press **Accept**: the daily report has **Research topics from this week** with **Accept**, **Edit** (the question is re-checked as you type) and **Reject**, the **Topics** tab on the CEO page lists everything with its status, and the Desk shows one item, "These might make good blog articles for the community. May I send them to Guildwise as research topics?" (Approve sends them all as written, Reject drops them). Say "make that a blog topic" in the CEO chat to propose one yourself. In your own (customer) organization **only the Owner** decides, and only while **Share diagnostic data with Guildwise** is on in the organization settings (**Organization, General**). That switch is not available to customer organizations yet, so until it is, nothing is sent from them; at most 4 topics a month are sent once it is. Turning the setting off withdraws topics that have not been written yet. When an article is published from one of your topics, the report lists it under **Published from your topics**. In the platform organization an Owner or Admin decides and no setting is needed.

Orders it carries out with full power. A **standing order** on the Ledger can be marked **Give the CEO full power**: only the Owner can, and only on an order that is his (written by him, or proposed by an agent and approved by him on the Desk). An order an **Admin** wrote only qualifies after the Admin presses **Escalate** and you take it over and mark it. The dialog shows the exact wording the mark is pinned to, which projects it covers, optional triggers (for example bug reports only) and which owner-reserved matters it may touch (ticked one by one). Any edit that is not yours with **Keep full power** ticked voids the mark ("edited since: mark it again"), and retiring the order, **Revoke** or a change of Owner end it. When an event clearly falls under an order, the CEO starts a separate full-power turn that carries out that order and nothing else: the event arrives as quoted data, the turn declines and asks you when unsure, a permission it lacks is raised as a Desk question without the turn waiting, at most 5 turns per order a day (and one per subject every 6 hours). Every order turn, with its commands, is in the daily report and the Activity log tab with an "I'd rather you didn't" button.

What it may decide: the Authority tab. Each kind of action has a radio: decide, recommend or never. Matters that are yours by default (approving a merge or a finalize, passing or skipping manual QA, posting to outside systems, production deploys, destructive DevOps work, budgets, new roles and workflows, vault conflicts, repository creation, cancelling more than three cards at once) stay recommendations unless you **delegate** them one by one, after a confirmation that names the risk. Some things are never the CEO's: its own policy and settings, members and billing, secrets, widening an agent's permissions, raising a budget. A decision below the confidence threshold, without a cited

ledger entry or rule, or over a limit becomes a recommendation, and so does anything triggered by text from a card, ticket or e-mail (the CEO reads that text as data, never as instructions).

Which working branch to keep. Answering "keep this branch as the working branch, or use another?" is routine, so by default the CEO decides it itself (the *Choosing which branch a repository works on* delegation, switched on by default and shown on the Authority tab; switch it off to have the CEO only recommend). The branch is stored as if you had answered, and the decision shows under **CEO decisions** on the Desk for you to acknowledge or correct.

Recommendations on the desk. A recommendation is a desk item ("Ada recommends: ..."), or a block on the question it advises on with the option preselected. **Do it** runs the action with your say-so; **Not now** declines. Items the CEO answered show "Answered by Ada: reason (confidence)" with an **Undo**.

The activity log (the **Activity log** tab) lists everything it decided, recommended or was refused, with the reason, confidence, the evidence and the policy version in force, and an **Undo** where one exists: pausing and resuming, priorities, models and seniority, benching, hires (retired if the agent never worked, benched otherwise), cancelled cards, drafted cards, proposed standing orders and answers to questions (the question opens again if no card it released has been taken since; otherwise a correction is posted on the card and on your desk). An undo is recorded as a correction: the rules the decision cited lose confidence and the CEO does not repeat the same action on the same subject for a day. Releasing a claim, ending a back-off, stopping a shift, DevOps requests, messages and retiring cannot be undone and say so.

Talking to it. Press **Ask <name>** in the top bar. The chat has its own page (`/ceo-chat`): **New chat** starts a conversation, **Chats** lists the earlier ones, and **Go to the current chat** brings you back to the one that is running. It is your single entry point: ask what is going on, give it a task ("find out why builds are slow"), or state a rule ("never touch the billing project without asking me"). Rules you state are kept as **memories**; you see, edit, retire or really delete them on the **Memory** tab, and the "Remember this for the CEO" box on a desk answer keeps your own answer as a rule. Only you can read them; they go only to your workstation. Tasks you give it appear on the Tasks tab; when one is done you get a notification.

Reports and alerts. The daily report arrives on your desk and by e-mail at your report time: what needs you, the decisions it took (with Undo and Correct), issues and risks, budget, tasks, proposals, what it learned from your answers and corrections, the order turns of the last day and **Things you keep asking me**. When no CEO is available the server writes the report from a template and says so. The CEO notifies you immediately only when it cannot decide, when something is urgent, and when a task is done: on the desk (pinned for urgent), by e-mail (one per subject per hour; non-urgent mail waits out your quiet hours) and as an event an automation can forward to Slack or Teams ("The CEO notifies you" trigger). Set the report time, quiet hours and an optional **organization monthly budget** on the **Reporting & alerts** tab: at 80% you are told, at 100% the CEO only writes the report and answers in chat until next month.

When it is offline. If its workstation is offline or its Claude sign-in expired, wakes wait, desk items reach you unchanged (nothing is held), you get one notice after 30 minutes if something urgent waits, and the daily report is posted from a template after two hours. **Pause** stops it acting (it may read, not act); nothing is handed back to the BA, which no longer reports. There is no button to disable or retire the CEO: it is built in, and **Resume** puts it back to work.

Cost. Its spend is shown as **Management (CEO)** on the Costs page. Wakes, the daily review and the chat run on Sonnet by default; only a **handover**, when it hands work over to the team, runs on Opus (all four configurable on the Persona tab; an organization that still had the older defaults was moved to these by a one-off migration, a model you chose yourself was left alone).

Once per subject. The CEO deals with a subject once until it changes: a card sitting in Manual QA wakes it and notifies you once, however many reminders the card raises, and again only when the card moves on. Notices about one subject share one desk item with a counter ("x3"). The "CEO offline" notice is raised once and is cleared only after a CEO shift has actually run, so it no longer comes and goes. There is no cap of its own; it is bounded by its wake limits (twelve shifts an hour at most), its action limits and the budgets above.

Good to know
The CEO acts with your rights but the events show it as the actor; everything it does is in the activity log. It never names agents or Guildwise to clients: cards it drafts go through the same checks as any other card.

In the app
Help, "Your CEO" (`/help/ceo`).

4.23 Integration tests run by the tester

Unit tests are run by builders and reviewers. **Integration and end-to-end tests** need a running copy of the app, so only the tester runs them, and only when you switch them on for the project. They start **off**. With them off the Test step still runs, as the **plain tester**: the tester checks the card's branch against its test plan with what it can run in its own copy of the code, without a running app (end-to-end tests that start their own server, unit-level checks, build and lint), and says in its evidence what it could not check. With them on, the tester also gets a running copy of the card's branch and your suites, as described below.

Switch them on. Under **Environments, Test copies, Tests and settings** choose "Yes, on the workstation that has the card" (a deployed target comes with the next phase). The tester needs the project to be runnable first: the **run plan** above (the DevOps engineer works it out the first time and the runner replays it afterwards). Then list the **suites**: a name, the repository and folder, the command, whether it is integration or end-to-end, the longest it may run, an optional JUnit report path and whether it writes or deletes data. With none listed, the tester reads `TESTING.md`, `BUILD.md` and the test config, runs what it finds and proposes the suites here, marked "Proposed by a tester", for you to **Confirm**. **Keep a failed card's copy for** says how long the running copy of a failed card stays up so you can open it, and **Run a failing suite again** is how many times a failure is retried before it counts.

What happens to a card. When the builder and reviewer are done and the project has the setting on, the card waits in Test while its workstation starts the card's branch (first rebased onto the working branch; a conflict sends the card to Rework with the files, as before). If there is no run plan yet, or it fails, the DevOps engineer is asked and the card waits for that request; a second failure puts a blocking item on your desk. When the app is healthy the tester runs every confirmed suite against it and reports each run. A suite that fails and then passes on the retry is recorded as **flaky**: it counts as passed, the card shows it, and the tester cannot pass the card while a confirmed suite has no passing result. The copy is stopped when the tester gives its verdict, or kept for the time you set after a failure. The **card page** lists every run (result, counts, time, which commit, a link to the log) under "Integration tests", and the environment panel shows the copy while it exists.

One card. In **Details** a card has an "Integration tests" switch that follows the project setting when the card is specified. Turn it off for a documentation-only card; it can be changed until the Test step starts.

Cards already under way. A card still before review when you upgrade moves to the newest workflow version as review approves it (this includes cards on the version that skipped Test when integration tests were off: they now go through Test), and then follows the project setting; a card already in Test or beyond finishes the way it started. Custom steps can need a running environment too: in the workflow builder tick "Needs a running environment" on a step the tester works (for example a smoke test after review).

A deployed target instead. Choose "Yes, against a deployed target" to have the tester test what is already deployed (a staging site) instead of a copy per card. First opt the place in under **Environments, … menu, Edit, Used for card tests** on the environment: tick "The tester may test this target" (it needs the app URL), add any extra hosts its sandbox may reach (for example a separate API host) and the **names** of the test accounts it gets (such as `TEST_USER_PASSWORD`). A **production** target can never be tested. Suites that write or delete data run only against a target where you ticked "Tests may write or delete data here"; elsewhere the tester reports them as skipped. Set the values of the test accounts under the same target, per workstation: they are encrypted in your browser for that workstation's runner (the way the sudo password is) and stored only there, in a private file the tester's tools read; they never reach Guildwise or the card. The tester's shell reaches exactly the target's hosts and the package registries,

nothing else. A target that does not answer stops the card with a blocking item for you. Remember that a deployed target shows what is deployed there: a card's branch has to be deployed before the tester can test it, so this mode suits suites, regression runs and a project that deploys every merge.

> **Good to know**
> The tester reaches the app on the same `localhost:<port>` it has on the workstation, through a tunnel the runner opens only for that copy, and nothing else on the machine. Builders and reviewers still run unit tests only and name the suites they left out in their handoff. Passwords for test accounts never go in the settings: use an env file on the workstation, as for the run plan.

> **In the app**
> Help, "Integration tests" (`/help/board-and-cards#integration-tests`).

4.24 When the Claude usage limit is reached

A Claude subscription has a session limit and a weekly limit. When it is reached, Guildwise **pauses the work** instead of letting every card fail and retry. The board and the project settings show **Paused until 18:00 (usage limit on <workstation>)** in your time zone. Cards stay in their queue with a note ("Paused: the model usage limit resets at 18:00"), no shift is counted as failed, and nothing needs doing: when the limit resets the workstation checks with one tiny request and work continues by itself. Your desk gets one notice (and one e-mail) *Claude usage limit reached on <workstation>*, which closes by itself. Projects that also have agents on another workstation keep working there. A chat started meanwhile says when it can be used again.

4.24a Claude accounts per project

By default every project's tickets run on each workstation's main Claude account. On the project's settings page, under **Claude account**, you can name a second Claude subscription for the project (a short key such as `work`). Each workstation that works on the project then needs to sign in to that account once. The status line under the setting shows *ready*, *sign-in needed* (a link opens that workstation's Integrations page) or *provisioning*. A workstation that has more than its main account also shows a **Claude accounts** table on the Workstations page: for each account the folder, who it is signed in as (and the plan), the login state and whether usage is available or limited until a time.

- **The fallback checkbox.** "If this account is out (usage limit or login), use the workstation's main account." It is **off by default**. Off means the project's tickets **pause** while its account is out. On means they run on the main account until the project's account works again.
- **Usage limit.** The board and the project settings show the project as paused, or on the main account, with the time the limit resets. The card goes back into the queue without penalty.
- **Expired or unfinished login.** Treated exactly like a usage limit: the project pauses or falls back, and you get a desk notice with the sign-in link.
- **Recovery is automatic.** When the limit resets or the login works, new ticket work goes back to the project's account by itself. Shifts already running finish on the account they started with.
- **What always uses the main account.** CEO, DevOps and chat work, and BA work that is not about a ticket. Questions and BA work on a ticket follow the project's account.

4.25 How many shifts a workstation runs at once

Each workstation runs a limited number of agent shifts at the same time; further cards wait in the queue. Open the workstation on the **Workstations** page and set **Shifts at once**: **Runner's own value** (what is in the runner's config file, normally 4), **A number**, or **Unlimited**. Only the workstation's owner can change it. It takes effect at once, with no restart, and the runner remembers it. **Unlimited** means Guildwise sets no limit; the computer's memory and CPU and your model's usage limit still apply, so watch the machine the first time. The platform administrator can also set a ceiling for the whole platform: when it is lower than your choice the page says which number applies. A runner from before this feature (0.1.20 and older) keeps using its own value and the page tells you to update it.

4.26 The lean team workflow (code version 6)

New projects start on the **lean team** workflow; a project made earlier keeps its own workflow until you switch it (see below). It changes where the cost goes: every card is designed and reviewed by the strongest model, the builder proves the code builds and passes its unit tests, reviewers only read, and the testers run only the end-to-end tests of the areas a card touches.

The stages, in order. Spec (the BA) → **Planning** (a short, cheap code-research pass by the *planner*: which areas and files the card touches, relevant documents, overlaps with other cards; it also groups related cards and records their order) → **Investigate & design** (the architect, Opus, for *every* card, also a small one; it adds a short *Card Brief* for the builder) → **Build** (the builder; the handoff carries the build and unit test evidence) → **Pre-review** (a Sonnet pass for the basics: obvious bugs, rule violations, missing tests; findings go straight back to the builder) → **Review** (Opus, on every card, read-only: the reviewer reads the diff and the code and relies on the builder's evidence; it never builds or runs tests) → **Owner approval** (large and high-risk cards, see below) → **Test deploy** (the server starts the test environment, no agent) → **Test** (the tester runs the E2E tests of the card's areas) → Docs → Finalize → QA steps and Manual QA as before. A **Merge review** stage sits beside Review: after a merge conflict at Finalize, the reviewer reads only the resolution (see Merge conflicts below). A project without a hired planner lets the architect plan; without a pre-reviewer the reviewer does that pass too, so hire both for the intended cost.

Groups. Cards in one group (the planner or architect sets it) go to the same builder. The first builder that takes a card of the group keeps the rest of the group; each card still has its own worktree and branch, and the builder continues one session from card to card while it stays small enough (the runner starts fresh above 120K tokens or after 4 hours). Order between cards is a hard rule: until a card's dependency has merged only its design may run.

High risk. The server flags a change as high risk from the paths of its diff, never from what an agent says: authentication, permissions and secrets, data and migrations, tenancy and billing. A high-risk card needs a *second* Opus approval (from another reviewer when you have one) and always the owner's approval; the project setting below cannot switch that off. The flag is recomputed at every handoff.

Build evidence. A build handoff must name the build and the unit test run (command and what it printed). The evidence is bound to the commit the runner measured; when the branch is at another commit than the evidence, a review shift sends the card back to Build instead of reviewing code nobody tested. A clean rebase before the review moves the evidence along with the commit.

Owner approval. After the Opus review the project owner reads the **final diff** on the card page or the desk item (**Show the diff**): unified, one block per file you can collapse, added lines green and removed lines red, with the commit, why you are asked (large change, high risk, or your project setting), the builder's evidence, the review verdicts and the design note. The diff the runner uploads is kept up to 2 MB; a bigger one is cut with a note. The approval is **for that commit**: if the code changes, the approval is refused with "the code changed after the diff was shown" and the card asks again for the new commit; a merge of a changed branch never happens on an old approval. This step replaces the old approval at Finalize, so you approve once. In **Project settings → Owner approval after the review** you choose *large and high-risk cards* (the default: a small low-risk card is approved automatically, and the card thread says so) or *every card*. A project that already used "merge large changes without my approval" keeps that for large cards that are not high risk.

Test deploy. After the review (and the approval) the **server** starts the project's test environment for the reviewed commit, without rebasing the branch, and moves the card to Test when it is healthy at that commit. No agent works here. If the start fails, the usual DevOps request is raised and the card stays in *Test deploy*; a problem nothing can fix by itself raises one desk notice. A project that tests without an environment (**Project settings → Testing without an environment**), a project with integration tests off and a card with them off skip this stage with the reason on the card. A tester never starts on a card without a healthy environment.

Area E2E and the full suite. The tester's prompt lists only the specs of the areas the card's changed files belong to. By default an area is a spec file (or folder) under the E2E folder, matched by name against the changed paths; a project can list its own mapping in `e2e/areas.json` in the repository, or through the API (`PUT /api/projects/:id/e2e-areas`). When nothing matches, the core specs run. The **full suite no longer runs after every merge** in this

workflow: press **Run the full suite now** in **Project settings → Full test run after each card** (10 to 20 minutes) when you want a regression run. This holds for every card on the lean team workflow, whatever the old "after each card" setting says: a lean team card never starts the suite by itself (there is no opt-in for it; the manual run is the way).

Merge conflicts. DevOps resolves a conflict at Finalize in a scratch worktree, so the card's own worktree is never left on a conflict branch. A card that was reviewed and approved stays in Finalize while DevOps works; the resolution then gets a *merge review* (the reviewer reads only the difference between the reviewed and the resolved commit) and the earlier approvals stand. If the resolution changed more than the merge, the reviewer sends the card back to Build for a full review. The branch is rebased on its base before the review starts, so the review sees what will merge.

Review rounds. Two Opus review rounds at most, then the card's architect decides (the existing stop-loss); the pre-review is not counted as a review round, but its loop is capped by the build passes.

Existing projects. There is nothing to switch: the lean team workflow is version 6 of the built-in **Code** workflow, and every project on Code starts its new cards on the newest version, as it did for the earlier versions. Cards in flight finish on the version they started on. Hire a planner and a pre-reviewer for the intended cost; until then the architect plans and the reviewer does the pre-review, and a role nobody covers makes a card wait at its stage until you hire one.

Who approves. The owner approval is asked of the project's creator when they are an organization Owner or Admin, else of the organization's Owner, else an Admin (a person made owner of that one project by hand comes before the organization's Owners). The approval can name the commit you read: the web sends the commit of the diff it shows, and the server refuses with "the code changed after the diff was shown" (409 `approval_stale`) when the branch is at another commit.

4.27 Environments and deploying with a recipe

The **Environments** page (sidebar, under the board, for projects that deliver code) is where you say how your app starts and where it runs: **Your app: how to start it**, **Test copies** (one temporary copy per card), the **environments** (the **test site**, the **live site** and any extra site such as a demo), **Places** (the computers and servers), **Rules** and **History**. When an environment is set up and approved, a **Releases** switch at the top (**On** or **Paused**) turns the project's releases on or off: pausing asks "Pause releases?", and while releases are paused the environment cards show **Releases paused** and **Update now** is off. Only the project owner changes the switch, and it needs an approved environment first. Where the releases go once they are ready (the queue, what is live, the rules) is on the **Releases** page (4.28).

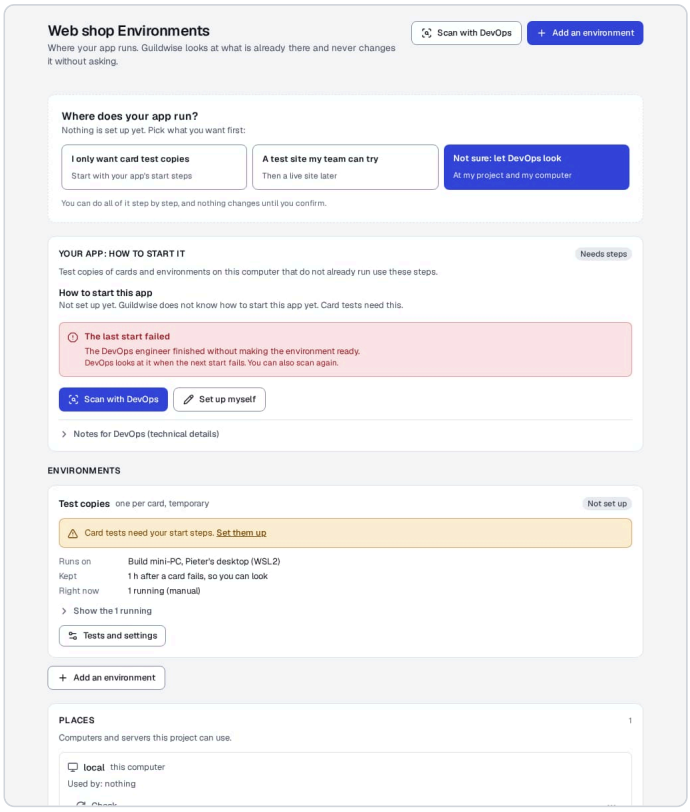


Figure 80 — The Environments page of a project

An approved setup turns "how we deploy" into something you approve once and that then runs the same way every time, **without a model running any deploy command**.

What the setup is made of. Behind the page is a folder `delivery/` in the **project vault** (never the organization vault), holding `recipe.yaml` and one script per environment. The recipe lists its **environments** in order (for example `local`, then `production`). Each one names where it goes (one or several of the project's **deploy targets**), the script and its arguments, **when** it runs (after a merge, after a phase, or only on request), how long it may take, the **health check** that says it worked (a web address, a port, or a line the script prints, such as `P5 DEPLOY READY`), an optional **smoke check**, the **names** of the secrets it needs, and the **gate**. It also says **who releases it** (below). A script must do the same steps every time, check itself and exit with a reason when something is wrong, be safe to run twice, and honour a dry run (`AOM_DEPLOY_DRY_RUN=1`: check inputs and access, print the plan, change nothing).

Where the vault is. Every project has a vault. A **git** vault is recommended: it is backed up with its repository. Without one, the project's vault is a **folder on the Owner's workstation**. Guildwise does not back it up: keep that folder somewhere that is (OneDrive, iCloud or another backed-up folder). The Vaults page says which one you have (4.3a).

Setting one up without coding: the Environments page. Open **Environments** (sidebar, under the board). It has one block per thing: **Your app** (how to start it), **Test copies** (one temporary copy per card), the **environments** (the **test site**, the **live site** and any extra site such as a demo), **Places** (the computers and servers), **Rules** and **History**. **Add an environment** asks four plain questions on one screen: **What is it for?** (test site, live site or something else), **Where does it run?** (a place that is already listed, or **Add a server**), **How is it started?** and **When should it update?** Guildwise then *looks* (read-only: Docker on the computer, the servers it already knows from its ssh settings, and for a server the app folder, the containers, the proxy and the backups; it never reads your keys or settings values) and lists what it found: the Docker app that is already running, or an app that runs directly on the machine (a system service, a pm2 process or a program, with its folder and port). If yours is not there, **My app is somewhere else** takes a folder, and when nothing is found the page says where it looked. A server asks one more question, **How should new versions get onto the server?**: **Build here and copy it** (the default), **Download a ready-made app from a registry**, or **Build it on the server**. For an app that runs directly, each update gets the new version, builds it in a new folder, switches to it and restarts it the way you confirmed (the service, pm2, or a command), and keeps the last versions so you can go back. Then **What we found** shows **Found and will be used**, **Each update will** (the exact steps in words),

Will not be touched (every other container, volume and proxy, by name), and **Needs your answer** when something is unclear. **Save** writes the steps into the project's files; nothing runs and nothing is approved yet. Each environment card shows **Saved**, **Tried**, **Approved**: press **Try it without changing anything** (a dry run: it checks and prints what it would do), and the Owner presses **Approve**. Approval needs a successful try of exactly that version. A test site defaults to **Automatically after each merge** (it waits 2 minutes so a few merges become one update); the live site is **Only when I press Release**, **only after the test site is healthy on the same version** (for 10 minutes) and **I approve each release**. Guildwise only ever restarts the app part, never stops the database or the rest, backs up the database first (a failed backup stops the update), and puts the previous version back if the site does not become healthy (the database is never rolled back automatically).

DevOps asks real questions. Scan with DevOps reads the project and your computer and suggests the start steps and the environments. Its questions show as fields (a few choices as buttons, yes or no, a number or text with DevOps' guess in words), the answers are kept, and **Use this** works once each question is answered. It saves a draft; nothing changes until you save and approve.

Places, once. A computer or server is added once under **Places** and chosen by any environment. **Add a server** uses a sign-in this computer already has, or **Connect a new server** (see below). A place says what uses it and whether it can be reached; **Check** and **Reconnect** are there when it cannot. A place that looks like another one (same server, same computer) offers **Merge**. A place nothing uses can be **Removed** (optionally with Guildwise's own key on the server); one that is used says which environment uses it.

Changing and removing. … on an environment: **Edit**, **Change server** (point it at another place you already connected, or move the live site with its data), **Go back to an earlier version** (live site) and **Remove**. Removing says what happens and what does not: the app that runs is left exactly as it is, and the setup needs a new approval. **Old setups and drafts** under technical details cleans up an unfinished draft and files in the deploy folder that Guildwise does not make (nothing is deleted unless you tick it).

Scan with DevOps (deploys). Not sure what is running? **Not sure: let DevOps look** has the workstation's DevOps engineer read the project and the fixed read-only probe, and suggest the whole setup. You review it field by field (guessed parts are marked, open questions must be answered) and **Use this** makes it the wizard's draft; you still see Found / Will change before saving.

A server with no sign-in yet: Connect a different server. Under the sign-in question press **Connect a different server** (or **Set up a sign-in for it** next to a server that asks for a password). Choose the computer that signs in, give the server's **address** and **user name** (usually `root`; your hosting company's email has both) and **how you sign in**: **with a password**, **with a key file my host gave me**, or **my hosting panel has a place to paste a key**. Guildwise first asks the server for its **fingerprint** (its own ID) and shows it in plain words: check it against the one your hosting company shows, then press **It matches** (or **I can't check, continue**, which is marked); nothing is trusted before you confirm, and if it ever changes later Guildwise stops. A **password** is typed once, sealed in your browser so only that computer can read it, used one time to add a key of Guildwise's own to the server's list of allowed keys (one line in `~/.ssh/authorized_keys`, after a dated copy of that list), and dropped: it is never stored and never in a log. A **key file** is treated the same way. With a **hosting panel** Guildwise shows you a public key with **Copy** and the steps; paste it into the panel and press **I pasted it, test the connection**. The last step is a **connection test**. The private key never leaves the computer that made it; Guildwise never edits your own ssh settings or removes a key it did not add. For a server this computer **already** signs in to you can also press **Also add a dedicated Guildwise key (recommended)**: optional, shown with the exact change first, and the sign-in the computer already has keeps working.

A server that is not ready: Set up this server. When the server has no Docker, no app folder or no web address, Guildwise lists what it would **add** and what is **already there and kept as it is**, lets you **try it without changing anything**, and changes something only when you press **Set it up**: it installs Docker with the system's own packages (Debian and Ubuntu, with root or passwordless sudo), makes the app folder and a backups folder, copies the project's compose file into the folder (never over a file that is there), and sets up **HTTPS for the one address you give** with Caddy (an existing Caddy gets one site added after a dated copy and a check; nginx, Traefik or something else on the web ports is never touched and is explained). **On this computer**, **Start a new copy** does the same for a folder of its

own and starts the supporting parts (such as the database) of the project's compose file under a project name of its own; what already runs is not touched. In **Details** you can add **database updates before the app restarts** (a command such as `npm run migrate`): it runs with the new version after the backup and before the restart, and if it fails the app is not restarted.

Moving to a new computer: Reconnect. Each server on the target cards shows whether the computer that deploys it can sign in (**Can sign in**, **Needs a sign-in**, **Cannot reach the server**, **Server identity changed**, **Never checked**), how, and when it was last looked at. A server you connected here with Guildwise's own sign-in (password, key file, hosting panel) is looked at by itself once a day and right after a deploy to it failed; a server that uses your own saved ssh sign-in (**Use an existing sign-in**) is never looked at behind your back, only when you press **Check** or when a deploy runs. **Check** looks now. When it cannot, **Reconnect** (shown as **Use another computer** when the place can already be reached) runs the same guided flow for that server with the new computer's own key; afterwards the old computer's Guildwise key is listed with **Remove**, which deletes exactly that one line (shown by its fingerprint) from the server after you confirm. **An improved version of these steps is available** appears on the overview when Guildwise has a newer way of writing the steps; **Update the steps** saves your choices again and the Owner approves the new version. Every part, also one edited by hand, is tried without changing anything before it is approved.

Moving to a new server: Move to a new server. On the card of a live server press **Move to a new server**. You choose a server that is already connected, or connect a new one (the same guided steps as above), and Guildwise looks at it and sets up the folder and Docker if they are missing. Then it copies everything over while the old site keeps running: the compose file and the settings files (their contents are never shown), the app itself, and a new empty database. Nothing changes on the old server in this part. When the new server is ready you read what comes next and press **A short downtime is fine: move now**: the app on the old server is stopped (its database keeps running), a last backup is saved on the old server and kept there, the data is put on the new one, and the new app is started and checked. The site is down only for that time, usually a few minutes. If a step fails, Guildwise says whether the old site is still running; **Try again** continues, and **Give up the move** or **Go back to the old server** starts the old app again. Then comes **Point your domain to the new server**: Guildwise shows the address to put at the company that manages your web name and checks live whether the name points to the new server yet (you can also say you handle the address another way). Only the Owner presses **Make it live**: from then on deploys go to the new server, and the old one becomes a **Standby (fallback)** that nothing deploys to. Nothing is deleted on it. When you are sure, the Owner presses **Retire** on the old server: Guildwise removes only the keys it added there (the data, the app, the settings and the backups stay; Guildwise never deletes anything on a server). The Places list shows the old servers.

Technical details (the developer view) shows the same setup as the structured fields, the generated `recipe.yaml` and scripts, and what the computers found. **Edit the script by hand** marks that part **custom** (Guildwise leaves its script alone and the guided view shows it as a script); **Back to guided** regenerates it and needs a new approval. A recipe written by DevOps or by hand without a setup is shown as a script too. A computer whose Guildwise is too old shows "needs an update for guided setup"; the developer view still works.

Setting one up: talk to the CEO. Say "set up deploys for this project: local first, then production". The CEO asks about the environments and their order, which deploy targets (it asks you to confirm before creating a missing one), the triggers, who releases each environment, the gate ("use your standard rule: the test environment healthy for 30 minutes, regression passed, weekdays 08 to 16?") and the secrets, by name. Then it asks **DevOps** to write the scripts (modelled on the ones you already use), save them into the vault and **try them**: a trial of a local environment really runs; production only gets a dry run. The CEO shows you the result and the recipe's **hash** (a fingerprint of the folder).

Approving. On the **Environments** page you see the environments, who releases each, the gate, the lint (a secret in a file, a missing or non-executable script, an unknown target, an automatic production environment with no gate must be fixed first) and, once a version was approved, **what changed since**. Only the **Owner** presses **Approve**, and the button approves the exact hash on screen. Nobody can approve by typing a message to the CEO. When anyone edits the recipe afterwards, Guildwise notices (it re-reads the vault when it syncs, or press **Check for changes**), shows it as "changed: needs a new approval", puts a notice on your desk and **refuses every deploy from the recipe** until you

approve the new version. Once an environment is approved, the **Releases** switch at the top of the page decides whether the project's releases and updates run from it (**On**) or are **Paused**.

> **In the app**
> Help, "Phases and follow-ups", section "Deploying with a recipe" (`/help/phases#delivery-recipes`).

4.28 Releases

The **Releases** page (sidebar, Organization group; the old address `/deploys` leads here) shows, across all projects, which version is live on each site, what is waiting for you and what was released. Setting up where an app runs happens on the project's Environments page (4.27). A project whose releases are **Paused** shows a **Releases paused** badge here and on its environment cards.

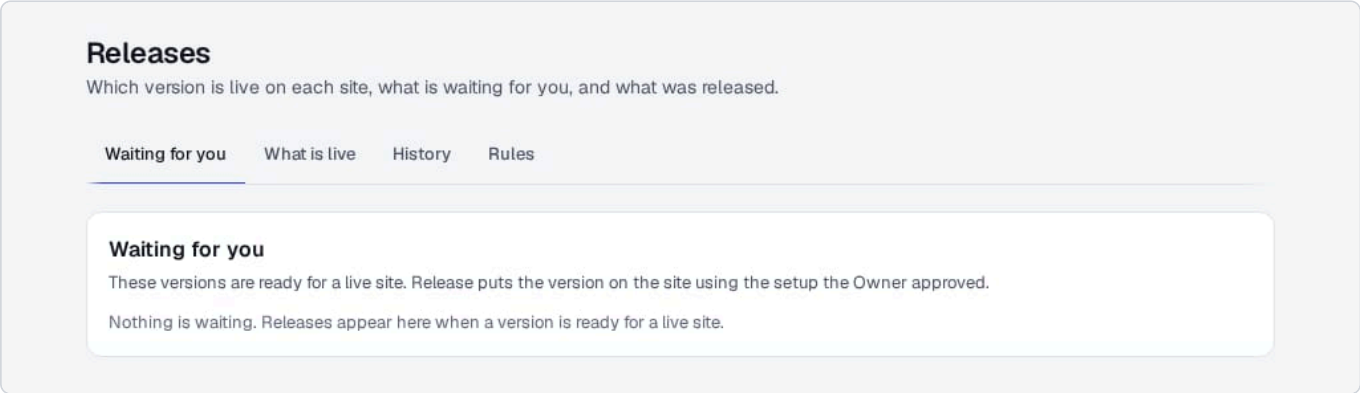


Figure 81 — The Releases page

Who releases an environment. The recipe decides, and you approved it:

- **The Owner or an Admin** (the default): a ready release waits in the **release queue**. Nothing runs until one of you presses **Release**.
- **The CEO**: only where the recipe names the CEO, it releases by itself once the gate holds. Where text from outside (a card, a ticket, an e-mail) may have caused the request, production still waits for you.
- **Automatic**: a trigger (such as "after a merge") releases it once the gate holds. A production environment may not be automatic without a gate.

The CEO is never the releaser unless the recipe says so, and an Owner or Admin can always release.

The tabs. The page has four tabs. **Waiting for you** (Owners and Admins) lists versions that are ready: the version, the site and the places. Press **Release** (when a version can go to several places, **Release to N of M** releases to the ones you tick) or **Not now** to leave it for later; a release that is not allowed yet says what it waits for ("Waiting for: the test site healthy for 3 more minutes") and **Release** stays off. **What is live** shows, for every project and site, the version, since when, whether it is healthy and where it runs. **History** (it has filters) shows every recent deploy with its audit: which approved setup version, which rules held, who asked and who released, and a **Rollback** badge when an earlier version was put back. **Rules** (Owners and Admins) holds **The standard rule** of the organization in plain sentences (for example "Only on weekdays between 08:00 and 16:00"), **Freeze all releases** (press it to stop everything going live; the button then reads **Lift the freeze**) and, under **Advanced: rule sets**, the named rule presets. Owners and Admins release; everyone else sees **What is live** and **History** read-only. **Go back to an earlier version** (on the live card of the Environments page) lists the last successful releases, says that your data is not rolled back and where the backup of the newer release is kept, and puts the earlier version back at once when the Owner or an Admin confirms; it is recorded in the history.

Gates. A gate lists what must be true before an environment is released: an earlier environment healthy on the same commit (for some minutes), regression, end-to-end or CI checks passed, the commit being a done phase, a time window, a freeze you can switch on. A recipe names a preset (such as `standard`) or carries its own gate; a rule you

bind to a project always applies on top and a recipe cannot loosen it. An unsatisfied gate refuses the release and lists everything that is missing.

How a deploy runs. Asking (the CEO's `aom deploy run`, a trigger, a phase follow-up, **Update now** or **Release** on an environment card, or the button in the CEO chat) only asks Guildwise. Guildwise checks that the Owner approved this exact version and that the gate holds, then sends your workstation a command pinned to the approved hash. The workstation takes the files from the approved vault version, recomputes the hash (a mismatch refuses), reads the secrets it holds by name, prepares a clean checkout of the commit, runs the script outside any model with a time limit, then the health and smoke checks. The log has secrets hidden. A refusal or failure is an answer, never a blind retry, and the CEO is told. A missing secret refuses the run and puts a notice naming it on your desk; set it on the Environments page under **Show technical details**: the value is encrypted in your browser for the workstation you choose and kept only there (like a test account of a deploy target), never on the server, in the vault or in a prompt.

Phases. For a project whose releases are **On**, a phase's **deploy** follow-up names an **environment** ("Release to Live site") instead of creating a DevOps request: it finishes with the deploy run (a release waiting in the queue holds the phase until you release or cancel it). While the project's releases are **Paused**, follow-ups work as in 4.10 (a DevOps request written in words).

> **Good to know**
> A model only ever asks. The CEO's rights to deploy follow the recipe you approved and your CEO settings (**Authority** tab); in the chat, if its call to Guildwise is ever blocked, release from the card in the chat or the **Releases** page: it is the same server path from your session.

> **In the app**
> Help, "Phases and follow-ups", section "Deploying with a recipe" (`/help/phases#delivery-recipes`).

4.29 Metrics

Metrics (sidebar, Organization group) shows what the team delivered, where it waited on you and where quality slipped. Everybody who can see the organization can open it.

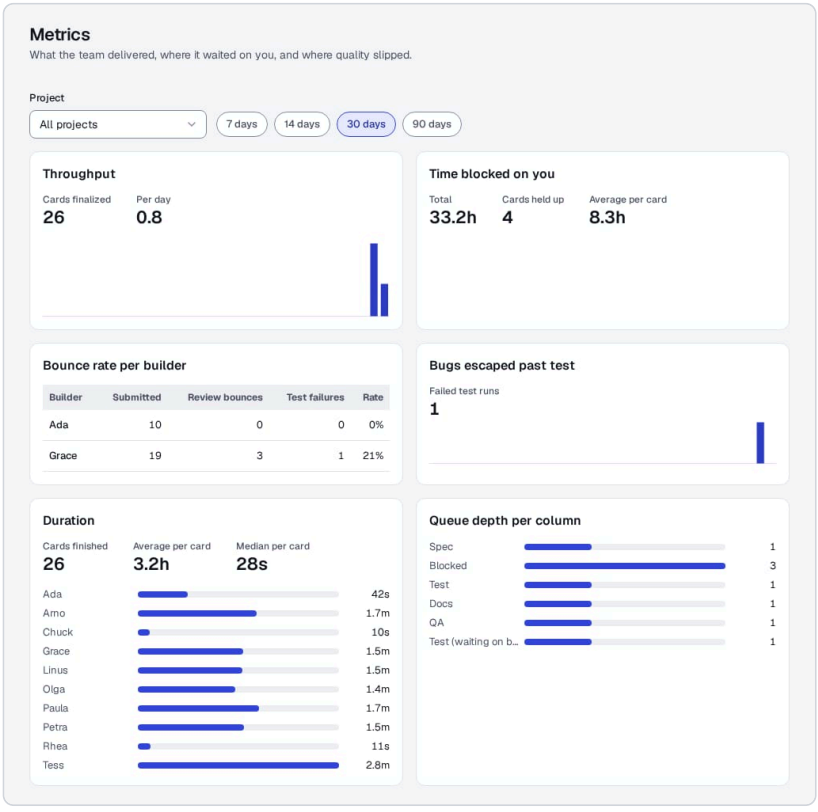


Figure 82 — The Metrics page

At the top, the **Project** filter (shown when you have more than one project; **All projects** is the default) and the range chips **7 days**, **14 days**, **30 days** and **90 days** decide what the panels count. The panels are:

- **Throughput:** cards finalized in the range, the average per day and a bar for each day.
- **Time blocked on you:** the total time cards waited for an answer or an approval from you, how many cards were held up and the average per card. A high number here is the cheapest thing to fix: check the Desk (4.5).
- **Bounce rate per builder:** how often a review sent each builder's work back (4.4).
- **Bugs escaped past test:** failed test runs, with a bar for each day.
- **Duration:** cards finished, the average and the median time per card, and **Shift time per agent**.
- **Queue depth per column:** how many open cards sit in each board column.

Costs have their own page (4.6).

> **In the app**
> Help, "Agents" (`/help/agents`).

4.30 Your settings

Settings (sidebar, at the bottom; also **Your settings** in your avatar menu) is the page for you as a person, not for the organization (that is **Organization**, 4.1). Everybody has it, whatever their role.

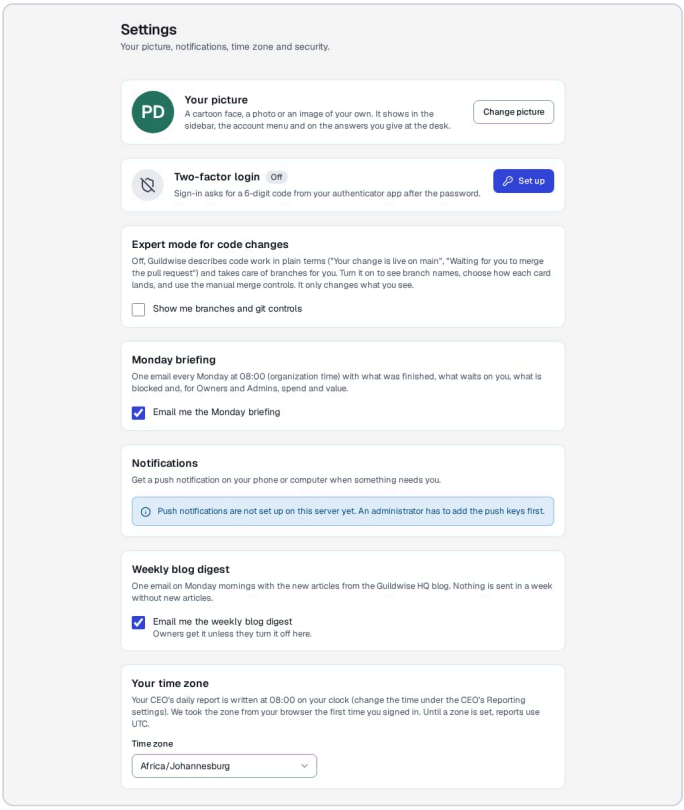


Figure 83 — Settings

It has these panels, top to bottom:

- **Your picture: Change picture** picks a cartoon face, a photo or an image of your own. It shows in the sidebar, the account menu and on the answers you give at the desk.
- **Two-factor login: Set up** (3.2), later **New recovery codes** and a switch-off when your Owner does not require it.
- **Expert mode for code changes:** the box **Show me branches and git controls**. Off (the default) the app talks in plain terms and takes care of branches; on it shows branch names and commit hashes, the per-card completion action and the manual merge controls (4.4). It only changes what you see, and only for you.

- **Monday briefing: Email me the Monday briefing**, one mail every Monday at 08:00 (organization time), on unless you switch it off (4.6).
- **Notifications:** push notifications for this browser or phone. **Enable notifications on this device** asks your browser for permission; **Your devices** lists every device and lets you remove one; **Send a test notification** checks it works. **What to notify me about** has a switch for each kind of notification, and **Quiet hours** (start and end) holds the rest back at night. On an iPhone or iPad, add Guildwise to the Home Screen first (iOS 16.4 or later). If the server has no push keys yet the panel says so.
- **Weekly blog digest: Email me the weekly blog digest**, one mail on Monday mornings with new blog articles. Owners get it unless they switch it off; for everybody else it is off until they switch it on (7.7).
- **Your time zone:** the zone your reports and times are shown in. It was taken from your browser the first time you signed in; **Use this browser's zone** resets it. The time your CEO writes the daily report is not set here: it is on the CEO page, **Reporting & alerts** tab (4.22).

> **In the app**
> Help, "Two-factor login" (`/help/two-factor`) and "Getting started" (`/help/getting-started`).

5. For Members

A **Member** works inside the projects an Owner or Admin has added them to. You do the day-to-day work: write cards, answer questions, hire your own agents and follow the board. You do not manage the organization.

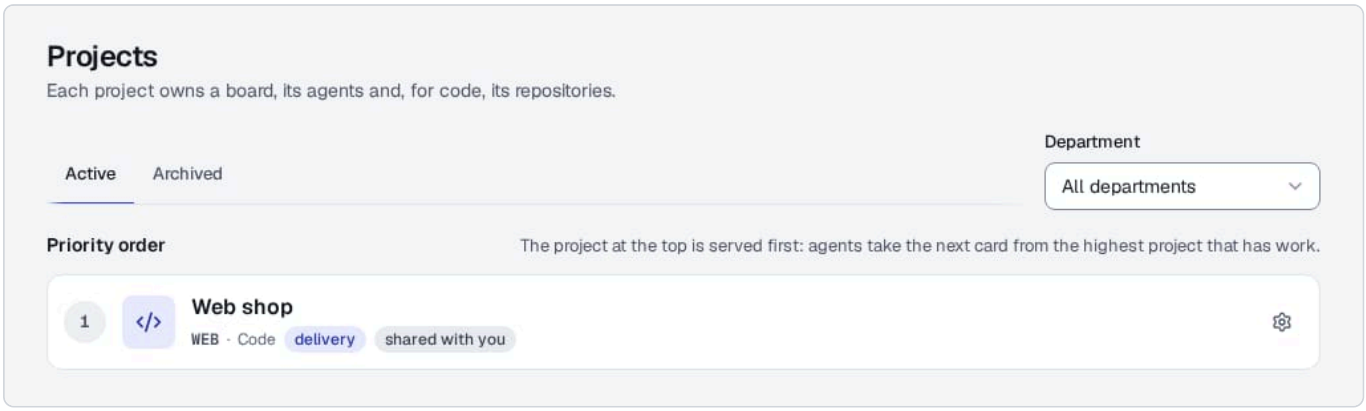


Figure 84 — What a Member sees: the projects they were added to

5.1 What you can do

You can	You cannot
See the board, desk items and cards of **your** projects	See other projects, create a project or change the priority order
Create and edit cards, and comment	Add or remove people, or change project settings
Move, release, cancel or reopen **your own** cards	Manage cards of other people (ask an Owner or Admin)
Answer questions on your own cards	Answer project-level decisions (Owners and Admins do)
Pair **your own** workstation and hire agents on it, for projects you are on	Hire agents on someone else's workstation, or widen an agent's permissions
Change or fire the agents **you** hired	Change other people's agents
Chat with the agents allowed on your projects	See Costs, Intake, Plan and limits or the Invitations tab
Create interests, and automations inside your projects (event automations make draft cards)	Create automations that act for the whole organization
Turn on two-factor login, and leave the organization	Change roles or remove people

The **Members** list under **Organization** is visible to you, read-only.

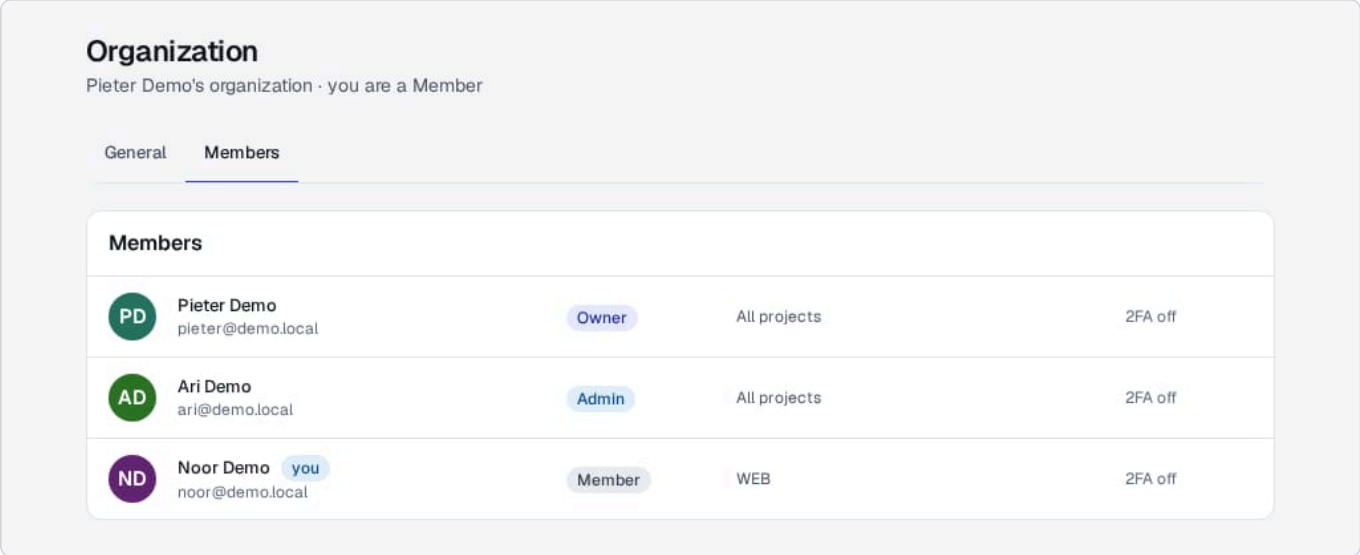


Figure 85 — The read-only Members list for a Member

5.2 Your first day

1. **Sign in** and take the tour (3.1 to 3.3). Turn on two-factor login (3.2).
2. **Open the board** of a project you were added to. The sidebar's **Board** entry opens the project you used last. The project switcher at the top of the page changes project.
3. **Create a card** (3.7), or ask the BA in a chat to draft one for you. Only cards you created, or that were assigned to you, show actions such as **Move** and **Cancel**.
4. **Answer questions.** The desk shows questions about your cards. Questions about other people's cards are read-only for you, unless the project's decision policy allows any member to answer.
5. **Use your own computer if you like.** Under **Workstations** you can add a workstation (3.4) and hire agents onto it. Those agents work for the projects you are on, and for no one else. Hire them with the allow-list limited to the projects you are on.

5.3 Good habits

- Write cards like a briefing to a new colleague. A clear card is the cheapest way to get good work.
- Use the **Chat** button to ask the BA when you are unsure how to phrase something.
- Check the desk once or twice a day. Blocked cards wait for answers, and waiting costs time, not money.
- Keep an eye on the budget bar in the board header. If the project nears its budget, tell an Owner or Admin before the pause starts.

> **In the app**
> Help, "Board and cards" (`/help/board-and-cards`) and "The Decision desk" (`/help/desk`).

6. For Guests

A **Guest** is someone from another organization who was invited to work in one project of this one. You keep your own organization and your own account. The invitation adds one project, and nothing else.

6.1 Accepting the invitation

1. Sign in with the account the invitation was sent to. (There are no guests without an account in some organization. If you have none, ask for a Member invitation instead.)
2. Open **Projects**. At the top, the **Project invitations** inbox names the organization that invited you. Click **Accept invitation**.
3. The project now appears in your project list with a "Guest" label and the other organization's name. The organization switcher in the sidebar lists it under "Guest in".



Figure 86 — The Project invitations inbox on the Projects page

6.2 What you can do as a Guest

- See the project's **board** and its cards, create cards, comment and answer questions on your own cards.
- **Chat** with the agents that work on this project.
- **Hire agents onto your own workstations**, for this project only. An agent of yours never works on the host organization's other projects, whatever its allow-list says.
- Leave the project when you are done.

6.3 What you cannot do

- You see **nothing at organization level**: no org settings, members, costs, org chart or agents of other people.
- You cannot change project settings, add people or archive the project.
- You cannot see the host organization's vaults, ledger entries that belong to other projects, or other projects at all.
- You never see the money: a paused project shows only that it is paused, not the amounts.

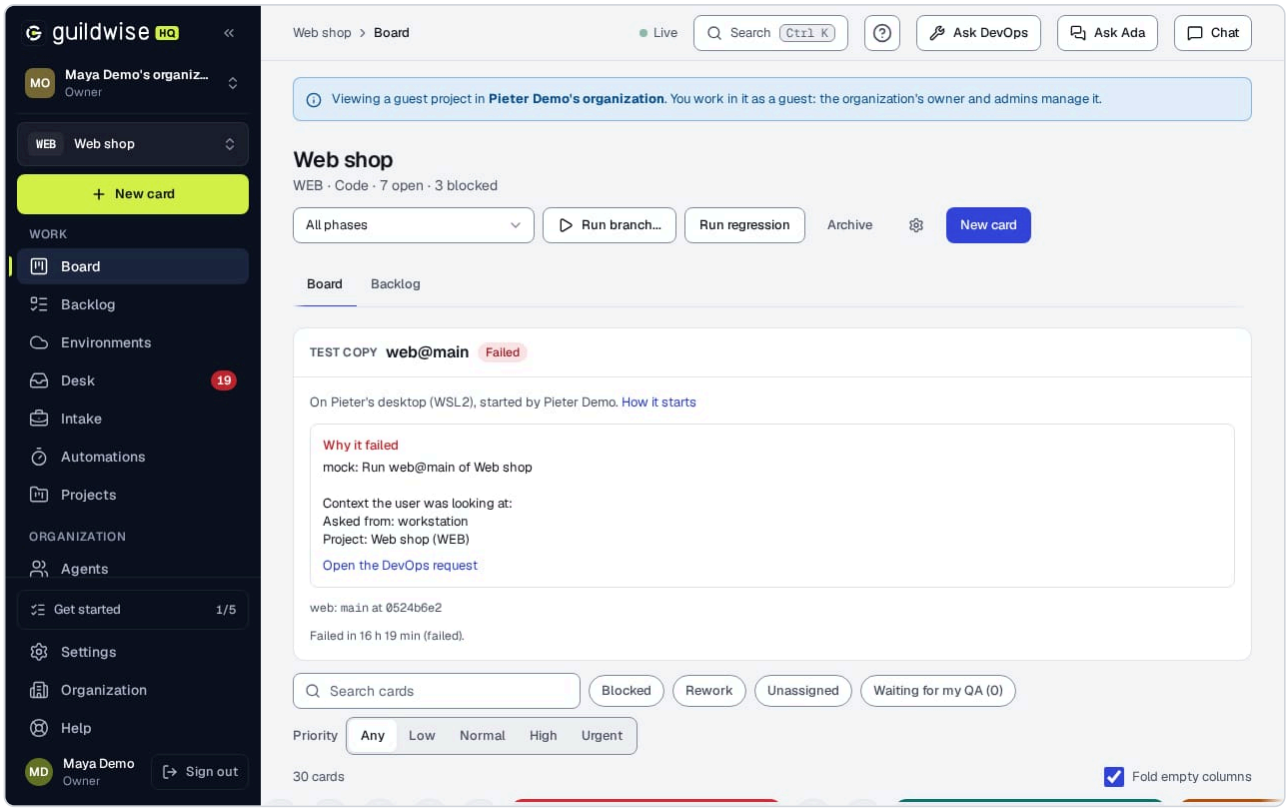


Figure 87 — A project seen by a guest

If you are removed from the project, the agents you hired for it move back to the owner of the project, and cards they held go back into the queue.

7. For the platform administrator

The **platform administrator** (also called the **super admin**) runs the Guildwise HQ service itself, not any one organization's work. You sign in at the same address as everyone else, but you see only the **Platform** area. You can never see an organization's cards, desk, vaults, ledger, chats or agents. That is by design.

7.1 First sign-in and two-factor login

A platform account is created on the server with a command (see `docs/DEPLOY.md`). At your first sign-in the app holds you at the two-factor setup: type your password, scan the QR code, type the first code and **save the ten recovery codes**. Two-factor login is mandatory for platform accounts. If you lose your password, use **Forgot your password?** on the sign-in page like everyone else (your two-factor code is still asked), or another platform administrator can send you a reset link (7.4). If the second factor is lost too, an operator resets it on the server (`superadmin-reset-password --reset-two-factor`).

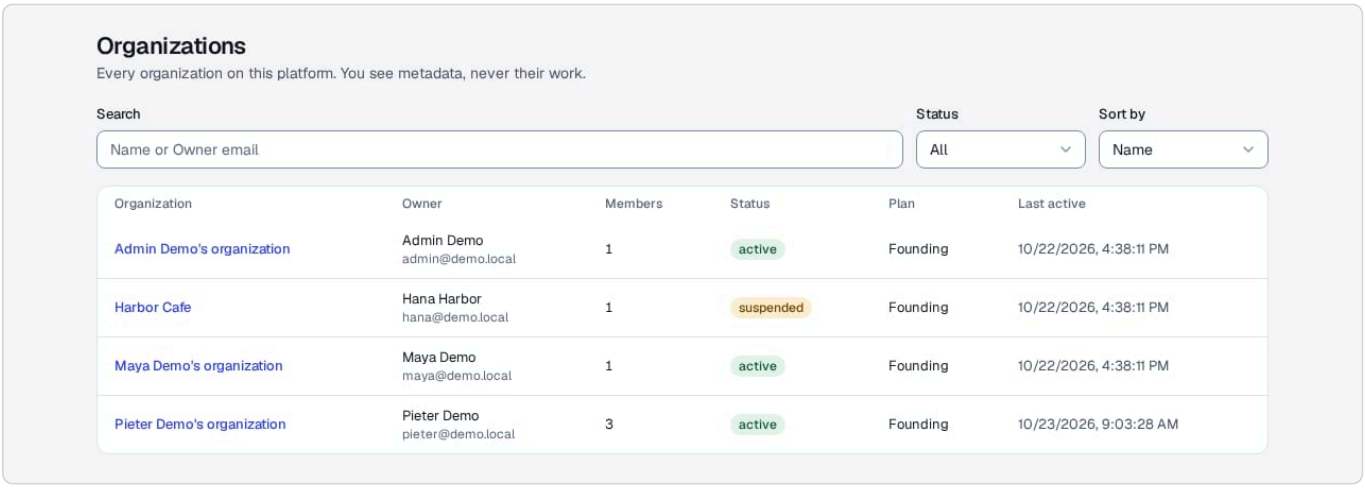


Figure 88 — The platform area, Organizations

7.2 Organizations

Organizations lists every organization with its status (trial, active, suspended, cancelled), its Owner, its plan and its usage (members, workstations, agents, projects). Click one for its detail page.

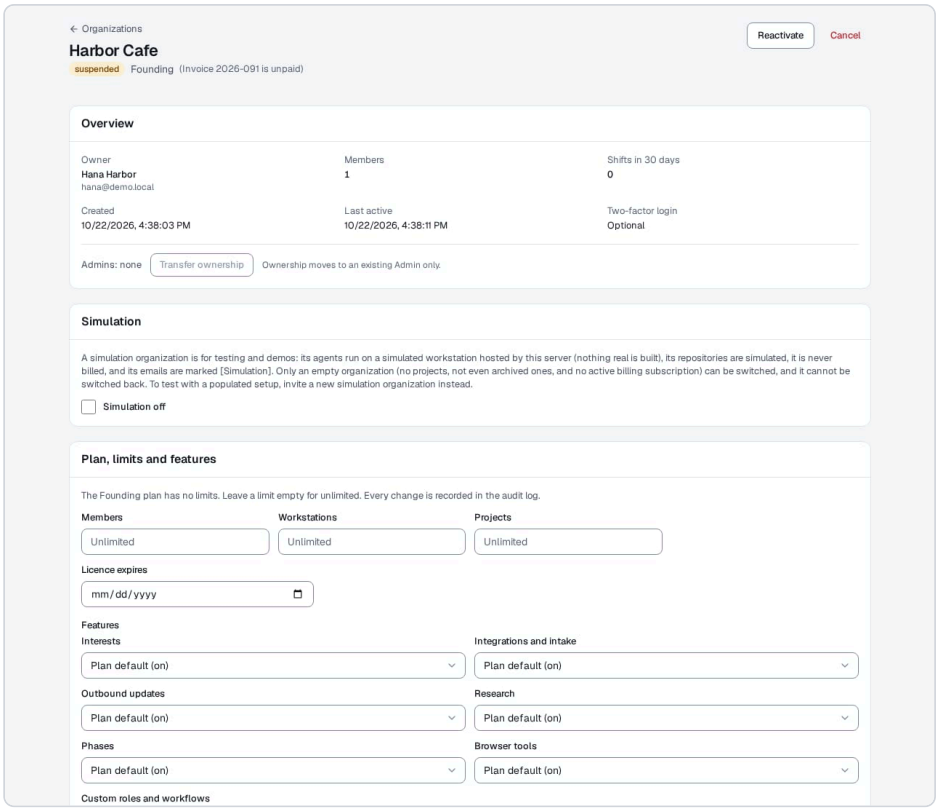


Figure 89 — An organization's detail page

On the detail page you can:

- **Suspend** an organization (unpaid, trial over, licence date passed). Running shifts finish and nothing new starts. Scheduled runs are skipped and recorded. A banner explains it. Only the Owner can still sign in, with read access plus organization settings and members. **Reactivate** it and everything resumes where it stopped.
- **Cancel** an organization.
- Change the **plan, limits, licence date, grace period and feature switches** (Interests, Integrations and intake, Outbound updates, Research, Phases, Browser tools, Custom roles and workflows). Every change needs a **reason**, and it goes into the audit log. Organizations you invite start on **Founding** (free, no limits) until their Owner chooses a paid plan; self-service sign-ups use **Starter**, **Team** or **Business** (4.17); **Unlimited** is assigned from the organization's **Billing** panel.
- **Transfer ownership** to one of the organization's Admins, for example when the Owner left the company. This needs a written reason and is audited.

7.3 Invitations: starting a new organization

Most new customers sign up themselves on the website (3.1). **Invitations** is for starting an organization for someone yourself. Type the **Owner's email** and the **organization name** and click **Send invitation**. The invitee receives a link, chooses a name and password, and becomes the Owner of the new organization (they may rename it). Invitations can be resent or revoked from the **All invitations** list.

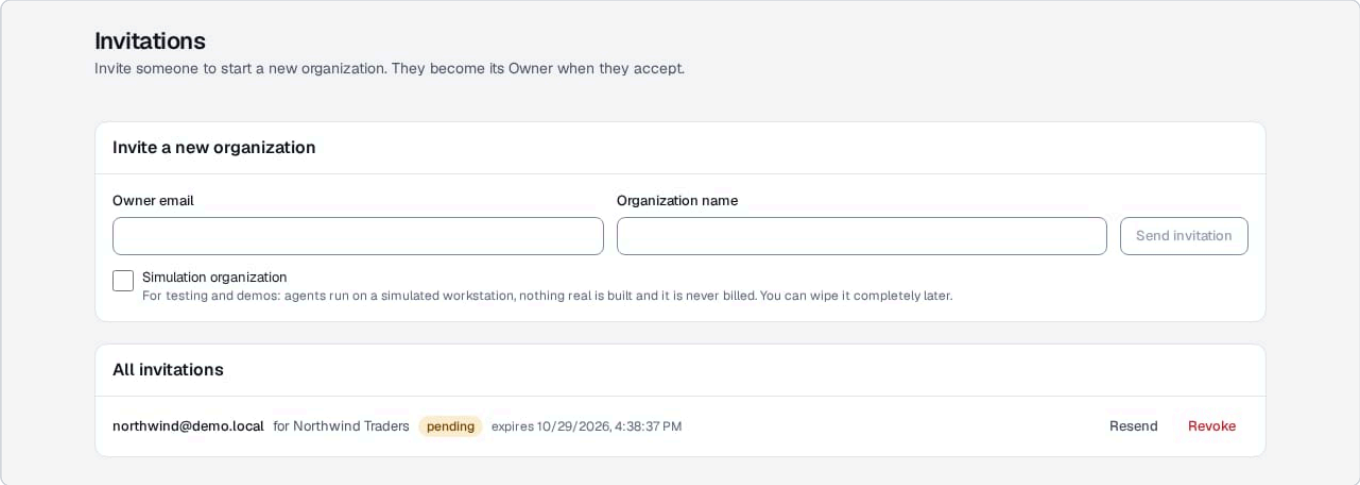


Figure 90 — Inviting a new organization

7.4 Accounts

Accounts lists every login. You can **deactivate** and reactivate an account. Deactivating someone unlinks their workstations, parks their agents and releases cards they held. You can also **reset a person's two-factor login** if they lost their phone and their recovery codes. **Send reset link** emails the person a one-time link to choose a new password (valid for an hour); the page shows when the last link was sent, and the send is recorded in the audit log. It also works for other platform administrators. Organization Owners and Admins cannot send links, but they can give a member a temporary password (4.15). The last active Owner of an active organization cannot be deactivated. Transfer ownership first.

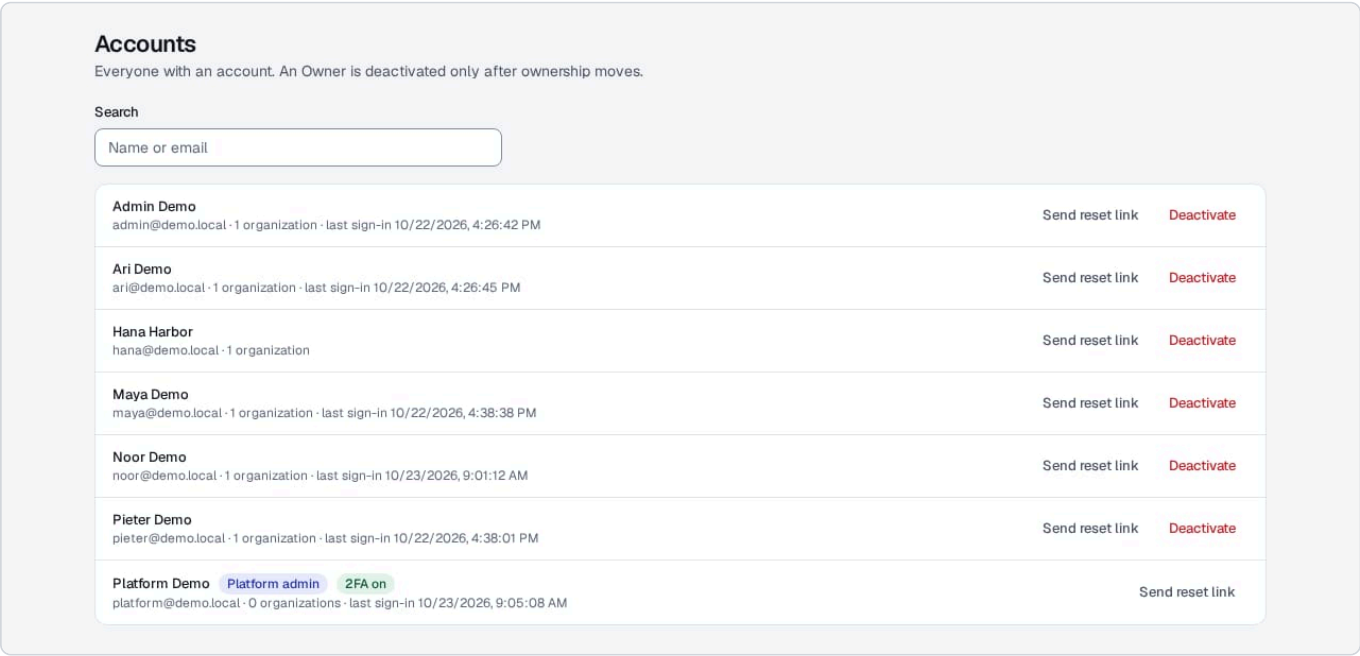


Figure 91 — Accounts

7.5 The Support inbox

Support collects every **Contact us** request from every organization and from visitors who are not signed in (chapter 10). Filter by status (open, answered, closed), type or organization, and search by reference, name, email or subject. Open a request to see who wrote, from which organization, the page they were on, the app version, browser and recent errors, and any screenshot. Then **reply** (the reply is emailed to the person and shows under **Help, My requests** in the app) or **reply and close**. A reply to an answered or closed request from the person reopens it. When inbound e-mail is set up (see DEPLOY.md), the person can also answer by e-mail: every support mail carries a private reply

address (`support+<token>@<inbound domain>`), their answer is added to the request as their message and reopens it, and a new e-mail to the support address `support@<inbound domain>` (forward your support@ to it) opens a new request that is acknowledged like the Contact us form. Automatic replies are ignored and never acknowledged.

Everything that lands on this console is emailed to the support address(es): new requests, Contact us messages and a person's reply or reopening on a request, always. Two more notifications are switches under the addresses, off until you turn them on: **New organizations and sign-ups** (an organization is created or an invitation is accepted) and **Platform audit events** (one mail per audit entry; switching it on starts from now, the history is not mailed). Each event sends one mail.

At the top, set the **notification addresses** (one address or several, separated by commas). The **support address** receives new requests from signed-in users and every follow-up; the **Contact us address** receives the messages visitors send from the public Contact us page, and falls back to the support address when empty. Both are emailed with the writer's address as Reply-To, so your team can work from its own mailbox as well. The person who wrote in gets an acknowledgement with their reference, what happens next and when to expect an answer (within 24 to 48 hours).

The **Landing-page assistant** panel on the same page turns the public **Ask Guildwise** chat on or off, shows today's messages and spend against the daily budget, and lets you change that **Daily budget** (it starts at $2 a day; **Use the default** puts it back). It is paid by Guildwise, answers in English from the reviewed product facts (`docs/assistant/product-facts.md`) and an outline of the help articles, and keeps no conversations.

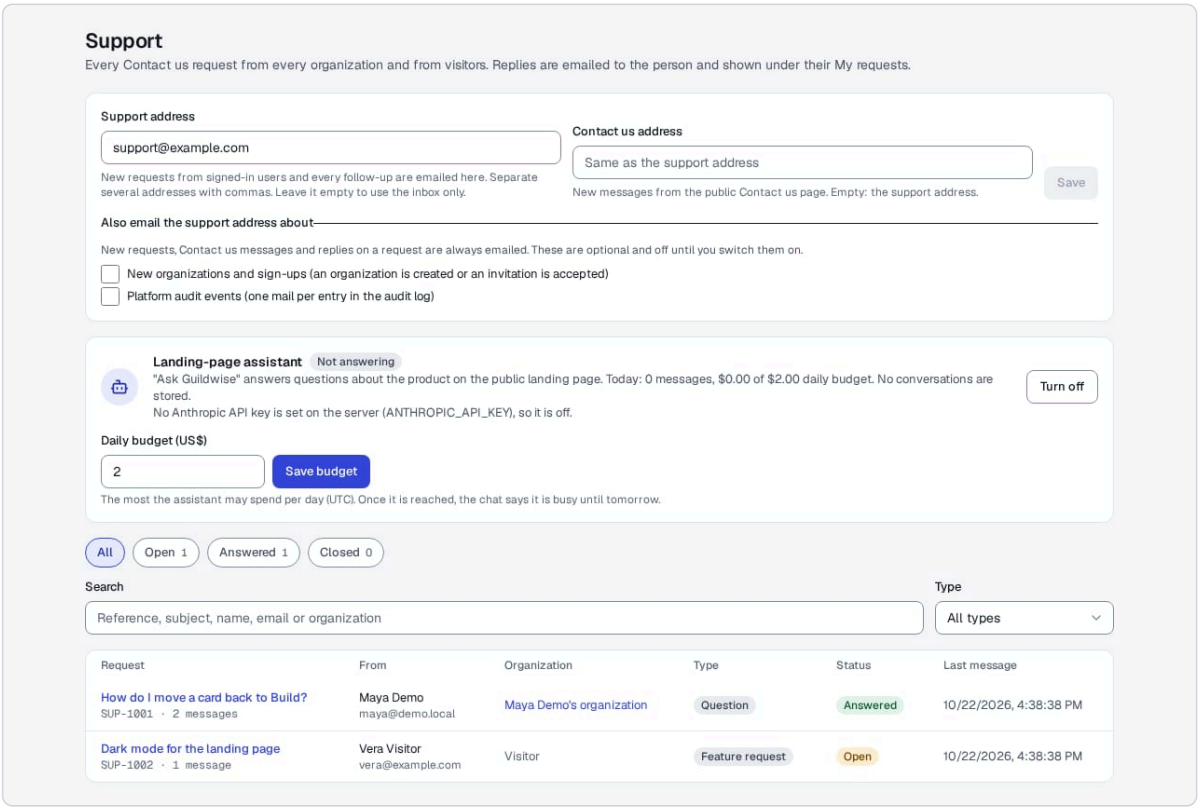


Figure 92 — The Support inbox

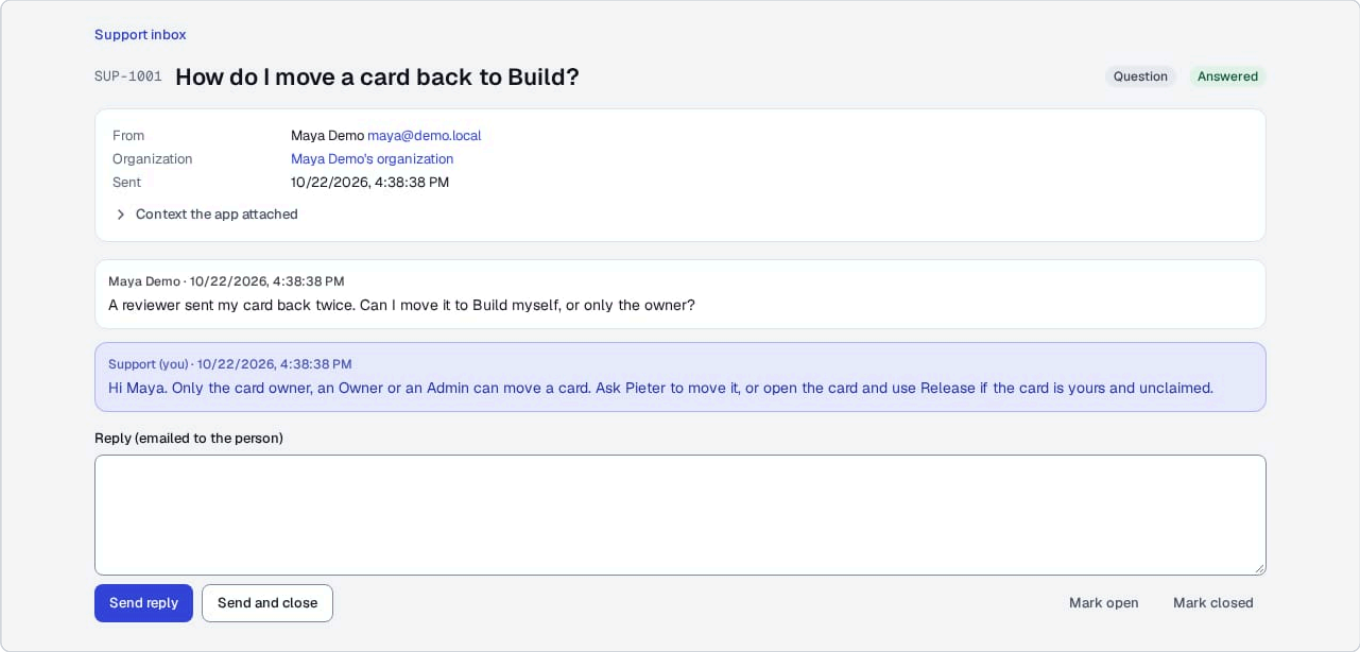


Figure 93 — One support request

7.6 The audit log

Every platform action (suspending, plan changes, invitations, ownership transfers, resets) is recorded in the **Audit log** with who did it, when, and the reason given. It is kept forever and cannot be edited. Filter it by action.

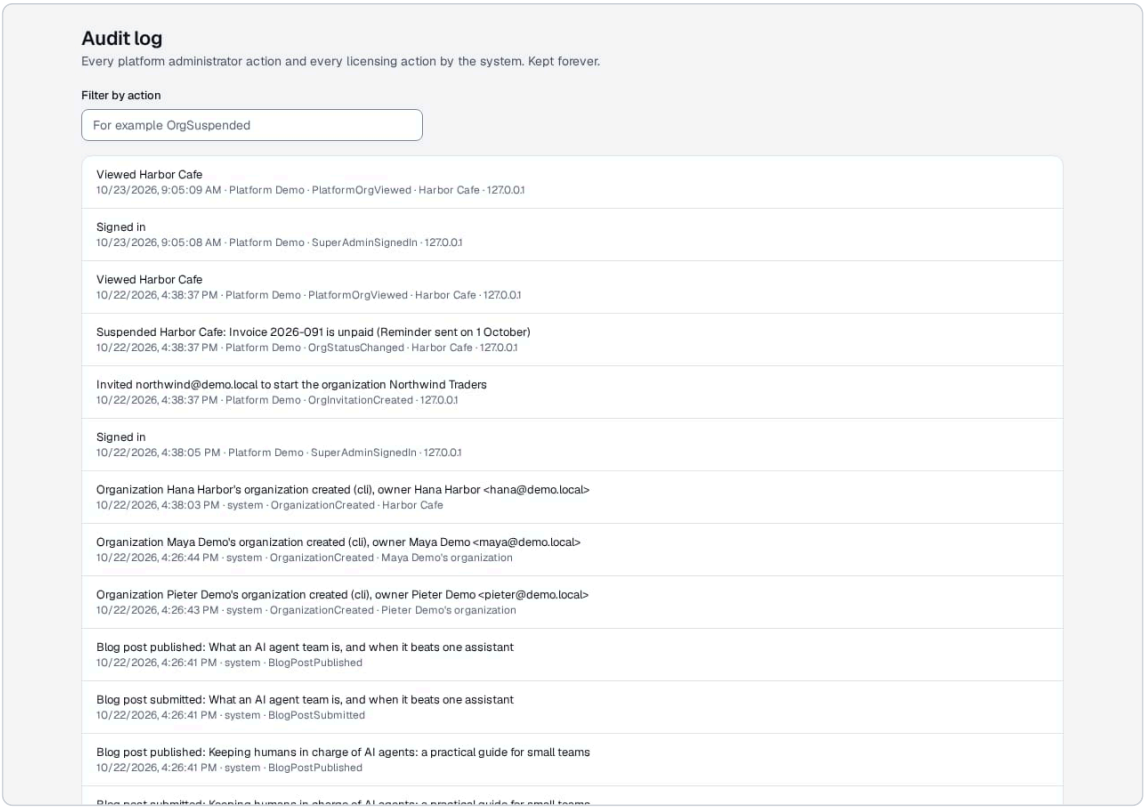


Figure 94 — The audit log

7.7 The blog, API keys and social sharing

Blog is where the Guildwise HQ blog is run (details for the blog API used by outside tools: `docs/BLOG-API.md`).

- **Writer.** The blog writes itself on the Guildwise server: switch the **Writer** on (it is off by default) and it writes 1 or 2 articles a day (08:00 and 15:00 Johannesburg) from your **topics** list, researching each on the web, and sends

them to the review queue. It uses the platform Anthropic key (the landing assistant's) and has its own **monthly cap** (default $10, searches included); before each article it checks that this month's spend plus one more article fits, otherwise it skips the article and mails you once that month. The panel shows this month's spend, every run (tokens, searches, cost, errors) and **Write one now**. The model is Claude Haiku 4.5 by default; another model needs its price entered first.

- **The switch.** *Switch the blog off* is the kill switch: the writer and API tools are refused when they create posts (the API answers 503), nothing is published (by you or automatically), and no digest or social post goes out. Public articles stay readable. Switch it on again to carry on.
- **The review queue.** Posts arrive *In review* (the badge on **Blog** counts them). Open one to read it exactly as it will look, edit it, then **Approve and publish** or **Reject** with a reason. You review every post until the date under **Auto-publish starts on** (by default two weeks after the first post). After it, a post with no content warning publishes by itself once it has waited the **hold** (3 hours by default). A post with a warning (for example a link that is not in its sources) always waits for you. **Unpublish** takes a post down.
- **Weekly digest.** On Mondays at 08:00 (Johannesburg) one mail goes to every organization Owner who has not opted out and to everyone else who opted in. Nothing is sent in a week without new posts. You can switch it off, send a test to yourself and see what each week did.
- **API keys.** The blog's outside tools use the keys on their own page, **API keys** (7.11); the built-in writer needs none.
- **Social sharing.** Paste the credentials of each network (stored encrypted and never shown again): the Facebook Page and LinkedIn organization tokens; for X the API key, API secret, access token and access token secret of a developer app with "Read and write" access (X charges for API use, so keep credit on the account); for Bluesky the handle and an app password from Settings, App passwords. Each article gets a caption per network, taken from its summary when missing. Published articles are shared automatically. If a token is refused or about to expire you get an email and a banner, and that network pauses until you paste a new token. Unpublishing does not remove a post that was already shared.

Everyone else reads the blog under **Help**, **Blog**, and can turn the weekly digest on or off under **Settings**.

> **In the app**
> The platform area has its own Help (`/platform/help`): the full Help centre with its articles, the glossary and the tour, but without Contact us and My requests (you answer those under Support, 7.5). Platform accounts get their own tour, one step for each entry of the platform menu (Appendix A).

7.8 Simulation organizations, demos and deleting them

A **simulation organization** is a safe sandbox for testing (for example your family member trying the product) and for demos. Everyone in it sees a **Simulation** banner. Its agents run on a **Simulated workstation** hosted by Guildwise, so nothing real is built, no model is used and nothing is billed. A hire there without a chosen runtime is a mock agent (no real model), and commits there carry a built-in simulation identity when the project has no **Commit as**. Repositories added there are throwaway copies on the server, whatever address is typed, and repositories that the BA or a DevOps engineer asks for are simulated the same way (you still approve the request on the desk; nothing is created on a git host). Chats are answered with prepared replies for typical questions (status, scope, acceptance criteria, estimates, risks, tests, deployments). Emails still go out, with **[Simulation]** at the start of the subject whenever the email is about the simulation organization (an invitation, a support request, a notice), even for someone who also belongs to a real organization. Your own workstations receive no work from it.

- **Create one:** on **Invitations** tick **Simulation organization** and invite the Owner. Or open an existing organization and switch **Simulation** on. That works only while the organization is **empty**: no projects (archived ones count) and no active billing subscription. Otherwise you get a clear message and should invite a new simulation organization instead.
- **No way back:** a simulation organization cannot be switched off. It stays a simulation until it is deleted, so test data can never turn into a real organization. Only the pace can change.
- **Pace:** Fast (tests), Normal or Slow (demos, so people can watch cards move).

- **Load demo scenario:** on an empty simulation organization it adds two projects with repositories, a team for each, cards at several priorities, two desk questions, a draft idea and a schedule. It refuses when the organization already has projects.
- **Delete simulation organization:** removes the organization and everything in it, including its history. You type its name to confirm. Accounts that belong only to it are deleted so their email addresses can be used again; accounts that also belong elsewhere only leave this organization. The audit log keeps a short record. The server does not back up the database for you: on a live system take a backup first (`docs/DEPLOY.md`).

7.9 Platform team: Guildwise repairs itself

Guildwise repairs itself with a normal team. You, the platform administrator, only pick which organisation and project run it; the approvals and reports land on **that organisation's desk**, not yours.

Set it up. Platform, Platform team: choose one existing organisation and paste the id of one of its projects (Project settings shows it), then Designate. The project keeps its decisions at project level. Until you do, bugs are recorded but no cards are filed. Clear removes the designation.

What happens automatically.

- Runner crashes, server errors, loops (a card failing 3 times, or asking question after question), rejection storms on a workstation and failed role self-tests become one bug card per problem in the platform project, with a counter ("seen 10 times"). The platform architect triages it: close as invalid, or set a severity and a fix size and design the fix, then the normal flow runs (review, test, deploy).
- A **critical** bug (a stage cannot complete, or the same failure 3 or more times) pauses only what it hits: that project and stage, or that workstation. You see a banner on the affected project and a badge on the workstation; running shifts finish, new ones do not start. It resumes by itself when the bug card is done, or from Platform team, Resume. The platform project itself is never paused.
- Every pause, resume, deploy and approval is a note on the platform organisation's desk.

Deploys. A fix that passed review, tests and UAT may go live without anyone's consent when it only unpauses current work; the platform organisation is told. A **high-risk** fix (login, permissions or secrets; data or migrations; organisations or billing, decided from the files the fix changes) and any deploy with **downtime** wait for the platform organisation's approval on its desk. Every deploy is in the audit trail (version, risk, who approved, how to roll back). The deploy script asks `POST /api/platform-team/deploy/check` and records with `.../deploy/record`; Guildwise does not deploy anything itself.

Client privacy. A bug that hit another organisation shows the platform team only a cleaned-up error (error type, function and file names, counts, versions): no paths, secrets, card content or user data. The team can ask that organisation for more of one bug; the Owner or an Admin approves on their desk, the access lasts 24 hours at most 72, every read is logged and they can revoke it at any time (Platform team, Grants; `POST /api/platform-team/grants/:id/revoke`).

Safe mode. If a runner release is bad, pin one workstation or all of them to the last good version (Platform team, Safe mode). The runner downloads exactly that version, even an older one, and does not follow newer releases until you unpin. The Workstations page shows "Pinned to 0.1.20".

For the platform organisation. Its members open Platform team (`/platform-team`) to read pauses, bugs, pins and the audit trail; its Owner and Admins can pause, resume and pin there. Fix cards that use up their budget (small 2 rework rounds / 2 reviews / 10 shifts, medium 3/2/15, large 4/2/25) go to the architect, then to the desk.

7.10 Billing

Billing (platform menu) is where the plans are priced. The page names the payment provider and whether it is in test mode, and has these panels: **Payment provider**, **Plans** (price in US dollars with VAT included, and the limits of each plan) and **Add-ons, VAT, exchange rate and invoice details** (the Business add-on prices, the VAT rate, the company

details printed on tax invoices and the exchange-rate override). Every change needs a **reason** and is written to the audit log. How customers see their plan and invoices is in 4.17.

7.11 API keys

API keys (platform menu) holds the keys for the agent API (`/api/v1`), used by outside tools such as a blog tool (the calls are in `docs/BLOG-API.md`). In **New key** give the key a name and only the scopes it needs. A key is stored hashed and **shown once**, in a **Copy the key now** window: copy it before you close it. Revoke a key at any time. The list shows when each key was last used and how much it did in the last 24 hours, and **Recent requests** is the audit.

7.12 Runners

Runners (platform menu) controls the automatic updates of the runner program on every workstation. Runners check the server once a day and update themselves when it offers a newer version (3.4). The **Automatic runner updates** panel shows whether updating is on; press **Pause automatic updates** when a release turns out to be bad (runners that already updated are not changed) and **Resume automatic updates** later. A banner says "Runners are not updating" while it is paused, and workstations show *Updates paused*. To hold one workstation or all of them on a known-good version instead, use Safe mode in 7.9.

7.13 Inbound mail

Inbound mail (platform menu) is the health page for the mail that organizations receive at their own Guildwise addresses (4.8, E-mail inbox). All of it arrives through one provider webhook. The **Provider** panel says whether inbound e-mail is configured ("Inbound e-mail is not set up" when it is not; the set-up is in `docs/DEPLOY.md`) and the **Last 24 hours** panel counts what was **Accepted**, **Skipped** (with the reasons), came to an **Unknown address** or was **Refused (bad credentials)**.

8. Everyday workflows

Four situations you will meet again and again, start to finish.

8.1 A feature, from intake to deploy

You want: the order history page gets a CSV export, and it should be live for customers.

1. **Say what you want.** Open a chat with the BA (**Chat** on the desk): "Customers keep asking for a spreadsheet of their orders. Add a CSV export to the order history page." Or paste the Jira or GitHub issue into **Intake**. The BA reads it, asks you what it cannot decide (which columns, which delimiter) and drafts the card with requirements and acceptance criteria. For a Jira ticket with screenshots or design files, the BA downloads them through your workstation (see "Jira attachments" in 4.8), looks at them and attaches the relevant ones to the cards it writes.
2. **Check the card.** Open it. If the draft is not quite right, **Edit** it (possible while it is a draft or queued and not yet claimed). Click **Specify** when it reads well.
3. **Let the team work.** The builder builds, the reviewer reviews (sending the work back with comments if needed, which shows as *rework*), the tester tests. Open **Timeline** and **Handoffs** any time to see why.
4. **Answer questions.** If the builder asks "should the CSV include cancelled orders?", the question reaches your desk with options and a recommendation. Pick one and add it to the ledger as a **decision**, and nobody will ask again.
5. **Finalize.** The change is committed and pushed to the working branch (or arrives as a pull request, if the project works that way). A large change waits on your desk for **Approve merge**.
6. **Group it into a phase** if several cards ship together. When they are all merged, the **Phase done** item arrives with a report. Approve the **Deploy** and **Regression run** follow-ups and watch **Phase results**.
7. **Done.** The card is in the Done column and says *"Your change is live on main"* (and, after the phase, it is deployed and tested).

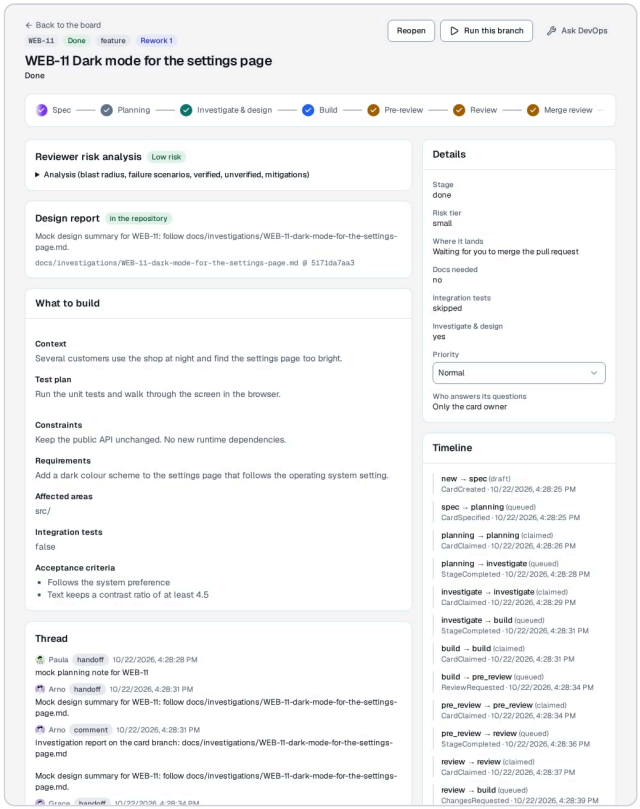


Figure 95 — A finished card with its timeline

Reopening a finished card

A card that is **Done** or **Cancelled** can go back to work. Open it and click **Reopen** (the card's creator and the project owner see it). Pick the stage to reopen into (it starts on the first stage an agent works, usually Build), give a reason and confirm. The card keeps its branch and the pull request opened for it: the next agent continues on the same branch, and when you finalize with **Open a pull request** again, Guildwise reuses the pull request that is still open instead of failing. The card's timeline reads "Reopened by … into Build: <reason>", and the card thread shows the earlier pull request link so the agent knows it exists.

Archive. A Done or Cancelled card leaves the board 24 hours after it was finished. The project's **Archive** (a link in the board header) lists these cards newest first, with search by reference, title or ticket key, filters for status, agent and date, and paging. An archived card opens as usual and can be reopened; a reopened card is back on the board. Reports and metrics still count archived cards.

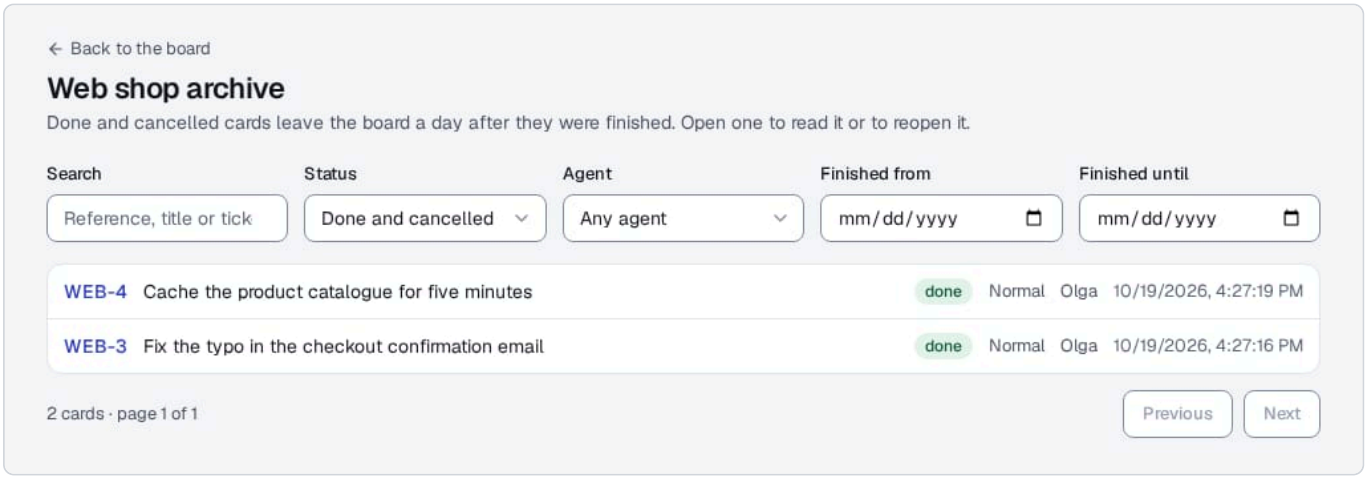


Figure 96 — The Archive of a project

Priority scale. Urgent is 1, High 3, Normal 5 and Low 8 (the API accepts 1 to 9). A card created with priority 2 keeps 2; only cards from before priorities had labels, whose default was 2, were read as Normal. A bug the platform team files for itself is High (3).

Priority and completion action at any time. On an open card, even while an agent is working on it, **Priority** and **Completion action** (expert mode) are changed in place on the card page. The completion action is locked only while a finalise waits for approval or runs; a change then applies to the next finalise. A Done card still takes a new priority; a Cancelled card takes nothing.

Other cards that depend on the reopened card are held again until it is done, unless they already started; those get a note on their thread. A card in a phase makes the phase incomplete again while the phase is still open.

8.2 From research to a project

You want: to find out whether a new payment provider is worth using, and build the integration if it is.

1. **Create a research project. New project**, workflow **Research**. No repository is needed.
2. **Ask the question as a card:** a title, the question, the scope and the depth (**Quick**, **Standard** or **Deep**). A researcher finds sources, a fact checker verifies every claim against them, and the result is **published as a note** in the project's vault folder, with sources.
3. **Read the notes** on the **Research** tab. If a claim is not supported, the fact checker sends the note back for rework and says why.
4. **Decide.** When the answers are good enough, **convert** the project (**Project settings, Stage, Convert project**): choose Code as the target, add the repository (or request a new GitHub repository, which waits for your approval on the desk), decide what happens to open research cards, and write a hand-over note.

5. **Build.** The published notes are listed in the project's `PROJECT.md`, so every builder reads them. Create the first cards and carry on as in 8.1. The project remembers that it **started as research**, and the Research tab stays.

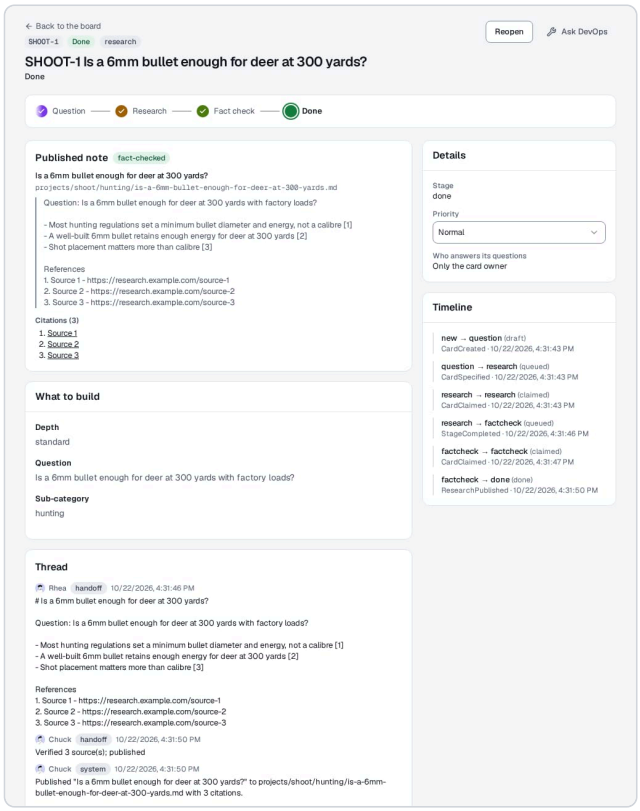


Figure 97 — A published research note

8.3 Setting up interests without being flooded

You want: to follow AI news, but not get a hundred links a day.

1. **Create the interest** (**Interests, New interest**). Write the description like a briefing: "Practical agent engineering and coding assistants. No hype, no press releases." Choose the kinds you want (articles, videos, podcasts). There is no vault to choose: an interest's files live in the organization vault.
2. **Keep the volume low.** Set **max total items** to something small, such as 5 or 10 per run. Choose a **run schedule** that matches how fast the topic moves (daily is plenty for most), and a **delivery schedule** of **one digest at set times** (for example weekdays at 07:00) instead of "as soon as a run finishes". Runs can happen as often as they like, but you only hear from them at the times you chose.
3. **Set the quiet cap.** At the bottom of the Interests page, **Daily quiet cap** limits how many items reach your desk per day across all interests.
4. **Teach it.** For the first two weeks, rate what arrives: **useful**, **irrelevant** or **boring**, with a short reason. Add taste rules ("Prefer primary sources over summaries", "Skip beginner tutorials").
5. **Go deeper only when it is worth it. Research this** on one item produces a fact-checked note. Research never starts by itself.
6. **Watch the cost.** The interest's **Settings** tab has a monthly budget. A paused interest does not run.

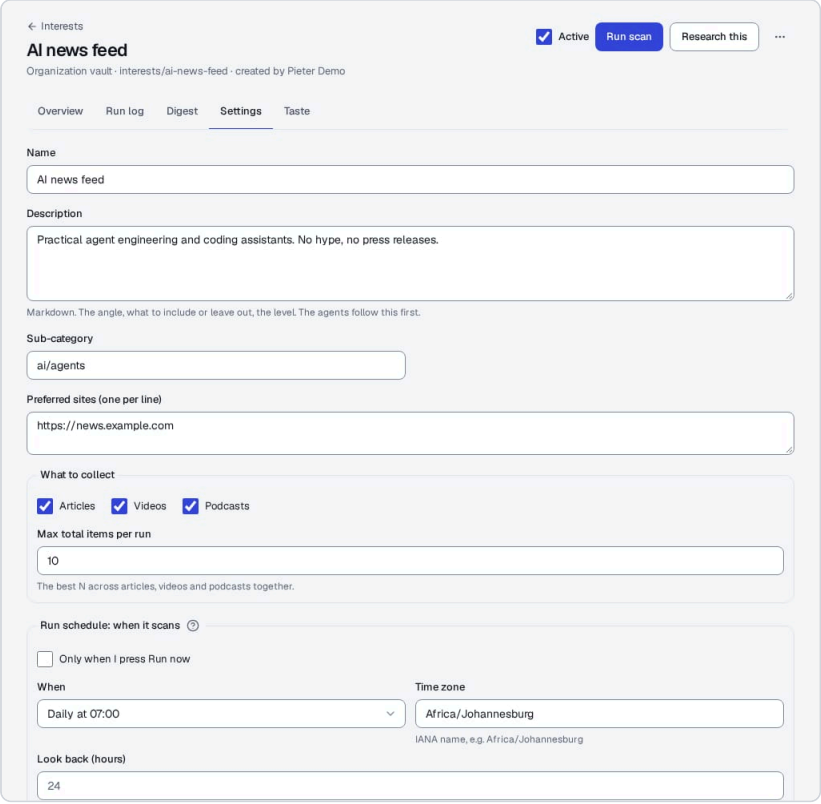


Figure 98 — An interest's schedules and settings

If an interest cannot run (for example its workstation is offline), it shows a red **Cannot run** badge with the reason and raises a notice on your desk after the third attempt.

8.4 Controlling spend

You want: the agents to be useful without surprises on the bill.

1. **Look at what things cost.** Open **Costs** for the breakdown by project, agent, model and day, and the **Agents** page for each agent's monthly and total cost.
2. **Set budgets.** For every project, set a **Monthly budget** in its settings. Start with a number you would be comfortable losing and raise it when you trust it.
3. **Use the right model for the job.** A smaller model for reviewers and testers, a stronger one for builders and the BA. Change an agent's model any time (**Change model**).
4. **Let the 80% notice work for you.** When it arrives, check the **daily report's Spend section** for which projects and agents cost the most.
5. **At 100%** the project pauses by itself. Decide on the desk: **Raise budget** or **Override for this month**. Declining to act is also a decision: the project stays paused until the 1st.
6. **Stop loops early.** If a card keeps failing, the loop breaker already backs it off (see 9.3) and your CEO warns you. Do not keep feeding a card that cannot succeed. Cancel it or fix what it cannot do.
7. **Review monthly.** Export the Costs CSV and look for agents that cost more than they deliver.

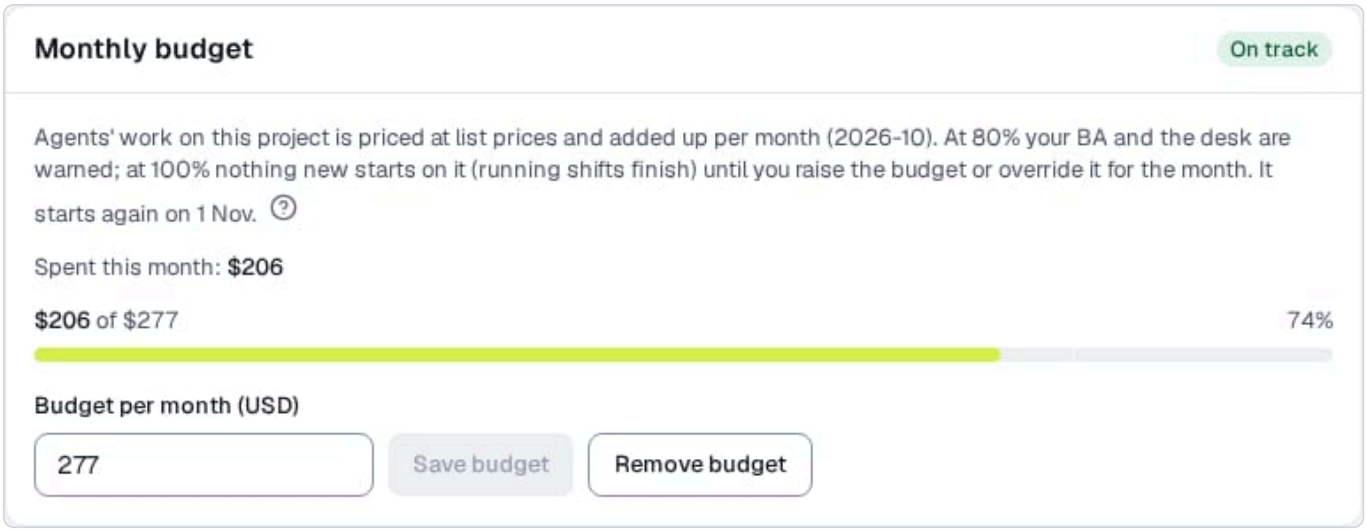


Figure 99 — The budget panel and the month's progress

9. Troubleshooting

9.1 The installer

What you see	What to try
The wizard stays on "Waiting for you to run the command"	The command was not run, or was run on a different computer than you chose. Run it on the computer that will host the agents. Check you pasted all of it.
The command link says it expired	The link works for 30 minutes. Choose your system again on the page to get a new command.
"Paired" never appears	The computer cannot reach this website. Check its internet connection, proxy and clock. Run the command again, it is safe to repeat.
A health check shows a warning (Claude, sandbox, Docker, yt-dlp, a repository)	Each row says what is wrong and how to fix it. Claude not signed in: run `claude` on the workstation and sign in. Sandbox missing on Linux: install `bubblewrap` and `socat`. Docker and yt-dlp are optional.
Windows asked to restart	Restart. The installer continues by itself when you sign in again.
Anything else	Open **Contact us** from the installer's failure screen. It already knows what went wrong.

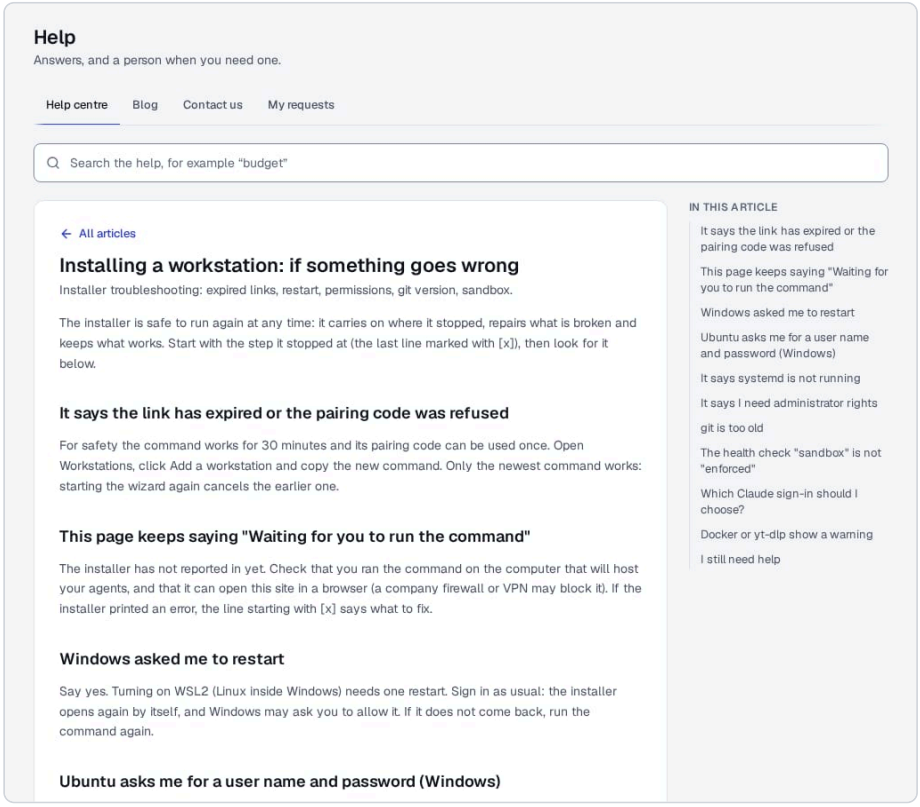


Figure 100 — The installer help in the Help centre

> **In the app**
> Help, "Installing a workstation: if something goes wrong" (`/help/install-troubleshooting`).

9.2 The runner is offline

A workstation that shows **Offline** cannot take work. Its agents show "offline" and cards that only they could take show an amber warning ("Reviewer Linus is offline").

1. Is the computer on and awake? Laptops that sleep disconnect.

2. On the workstation open a terminal and run `aom-runner status`. It shows whether the runner is running and connected.
3. If it is not running, `aom-runner start` (or restart the service the installer set up). Run `aom-runner doctor` for a health check of Node, git, Claude and the connection to the server.
4. Still stuck? Running the installer command again repairs the installation and keeps the pairing.

The warning icons clear by themselves when the machine returns (within about 30 seconds). Logs are in `~/.aom-runner/logs/`.

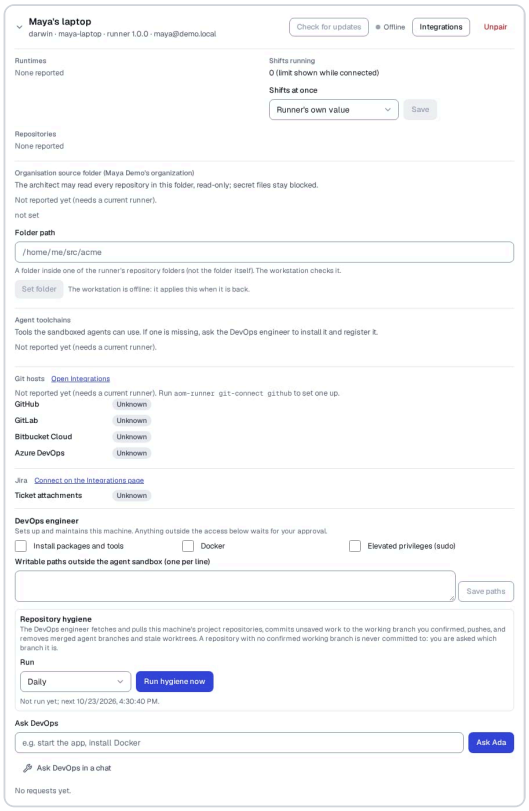


Figure 101 — A workstation that is offline

9.3 A card is backing off

An amber badge "Backing off until 14:32 (3 failures)" on a card means the **loop breaker** stepped in. When three shifts on the same card end without a report within 10 minutes (the agent crashed, timed out or was stopped by a denied tool), the dispatcher stops handing the card out. The wait starts at 1 minute and doubles with each failure, up to 1 hour. You also get one alert on the desk.

1. Open the card and read the **Timeline** and the last **Handoff** for the reason. The usual cause is something the agent cannot do: a tool that is denied, a missing capability, a repository that is not on its workstation.
2. Fix the cause (adjust the card, the agent or the workstation).
3. Click **Release back-off** on the card to try again at once. Moving the card to another stage also clears it.
4. If it keeps failing, cancel the card and write a better one.

A card that keeps crashing is parked. After 10 failed shifts in one episode the loop breaker stops backing off and parks the card: it becomes blocked and one blocking item appears on the desk, naming the card, the failure count and the last error. Fix the cause, then answer (resolve) the item or move the card back to the queue. The failure count starts again from zero.

Cards made by a schedule or an interest run in a project with exactly one repository get that repository, like a card you create by hand. With several repositories the card has none until you pick one.

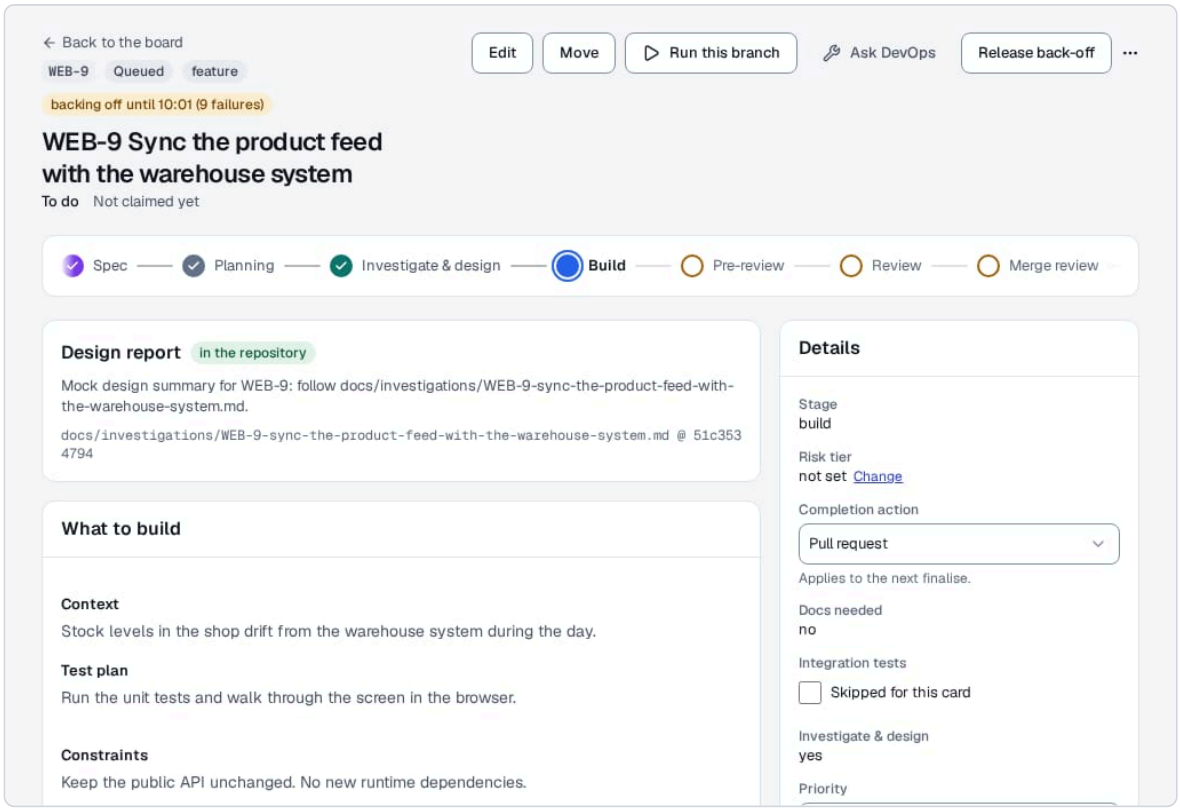


Figure 102 — The back-off badge on a card

9.4 A budget pause

A banner "This project has used its monthly budget" and a desk item mean the project is paused. Running shifts finish, nothing new starts. See 4.6. On the desk choose **Raise budget** (the pause lifts as soon as the new amount is above the spend) or **Override for this month**. If you are a Member, tell an Owner or Admin.

9.5 A missing working branch

Guildwise uses the repository's default branch by itself, so you rarely see this. Symptom: the DevOps engineer does not commit or pull in a repository, and the desk asks "Which branch is the working branch?" (or the project settings show *not confirmed*). Answer the question on the desk, or set the branch in **Project settings, Repositories, Change**. The DevOps engineer commits and pushes right away. If the branch you named does not exist yet, the runner creates it from the repository's **main branch** (default: the repository's default branch) and pushes it when the next card starts (the card shows "Created working branch X from Y", and the repository row in the project settings keeps the date); you only get this question when it cannot tell the main branch, the main branch you named does not exist, or the push is refused (the message names the branch and the host's reason: check that this workstation may push to the repository). See 4.4.

Git hosts. Every repository has a git host, detected from its address and changeable by the project owner (Project settings, Repositories, Change). One project can mix hosts. For pull requests, listing your repositories and creating new ones, the workstation must be connected to that host: the Workstations page and the repository's Git host line show, per host, Connected, Not connected (no token saved), Token refused (the host said no; the line below gives the HTTP status and the likely missing scope) or Could not check (the host could not be reached; it clears by itself). For Bitbucket Cloud the token needs the repository and pull request read/write scopes; the account scope is not required, and **Connect** gives the one command to run on that workstation (`aom-runner git-connect github`, `gitlab`, `bitbucket-cloud` or `azure-devops`); your login or token stays on that computer and the server only learns whether it works. The DevOps engineer can walk you through it: it can start a browser sign-in and show you the address and code, but it never asks for or types a token (if one is needed it tells you to run the command yourself or use **Connect**). **Azure DevOps:** personal access tokens that are not limited to one organization stop working on 2026-12-

01, so use a **Microsoft Entra service principal** (or workload identity) as the main sign-in: register an app in Entra, add it to your Azure DevOps organization with Basic access and Contributor on the repositories, and set `AZURE_TENANT_ID`, `AZURE_CLIENT_ID` and `AZURE_CLIENT_SECRET` (or `AZURE_FEDERATED_TOKEN_FILE`) for the runner on that workstation. A token for one organization and `az login` remain supported fallbacks. Agents can also ask for a new repository on any of these hosts (GitHub, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Bitbucket Cloud); you approve it on the desk and your own login on the workstation creates it. **SSH instead of an API token.** If you already have SSH keys and would rather not create tokens, use SSH for clone, fetch and push. On the Workstations page, open the workstation, click **SSH** on the git host, choose the default for new clones (API token / CLI login, or SSH key) and the key: **a key made by the runner** (the page then shows the public key and where to add it on GitHub, GitLab, Bitbucket or Azure DevOps), **a key file I already have** (give its full path on the workstation; it is not copied), or **my ssh-agent**. Press **Check SSH** (optionally with a repository address) to see one clear state: SSH works, the host refused the key, host key changed, host not reachable, no key yet, or ssh is not installed. In a terminal the same is `aom-runner git-connect github --ssh` (with `--key-file <path>` or `--agent`, and `--check`). Per repository, the owner can override the default under **Access** (Project settings, Repositories, **Change**); the clone's remote address on the workstation switches between https and ssh automatically. The private key stays on the workstation and agents never see it; the runner does the git work for them. SSH does not give pull requests, branch rules or the repository list: those still need the token or CLI login. Without it, finishing a card pushes the branch and the manager opens the pull request, and the page says so. A plain git server needs no connection but gets no pull requests: the branch is pushed and the desk tells you to open the request yourself. If the working branch is protected on the host, finishing a card opens a pull request instead, says so on the card, and the project switches to pull requests for new work.

Repositories, tools and rights on a workstation. A repository you add under Project settings, Repositories is cloned (or, with "Create a new repository", created and cloned) onto the project's workstations by their DevOps engineers; the Repositories tab shows Cloning, Cloned on a workstation or Failed with the reason and a Try again button. Before build work starts on a workstation the DevOps engineer installs the tools the repository needs (for a .NET MAUI app: the .NET SDK, the MAUI workloads, a JDK and the Android SDK), if you ticked "Install packages and tools", and then the project's own packages (pnpm/npm/yarn/bun install, Python into the project's environment, dotnet restore, Go, Rust, Maven, Ruby, PHP); until the workstation is ready every agent card of the project waits with the reason, a notice on your desk tells you when it needs your help or failed, and Project settings shows the Development environment per workstation with Check again. On the Workstations page every ticked DevOps right shows verified or failed with how to fix it, and a sudo password, if sudo needs one, is entered there: it is encrypted for that workstation and never shown again.

Fix with DevOps. Next to every item that failed or is missing (a tool in the Development environment, a ticked right that failed verification, a repository that could not be cloned) there is a **Fix** button. It sends the DevOps engineer of that workstation a request with the error text, the workstation, the project and the repository, so you do not have to write it yourself. The status shows right next to the item: *Requested*, *DevOps is working on it*, *Needs your approval on the desk* (when the fix is outside what you allowed), *Done* or *DevOps could not fix it* (with **Fix again**). When DevOps reports done, the check runs again by itself (the environment check, the rights check, or the clone), and **Check again** is there if you want to run it yourself.

9.6 Two-factor recovery

- **You lost your phone, but have your recovery codes:** at the sign-in code step, type one of the ten recovery codes instead of the six digits. Each works once. Then set up two-factor login again on a new phone (**Your settings**), which gives you new codes.
- **You lost both:** ask your Owner to **reset your two-factor login** (**Organization, Members**; only the Owner can). If you are the Owner, ask the platform administrator (**Accounts**). If you are the platform administrator, an operator resets it on the server with `superadmin-reset-password --reset-two-factor`.
- **Too many wrong codes:** after five wrong codes the sign-in attempt is cancelled. Sign in again with your password and type the right code.

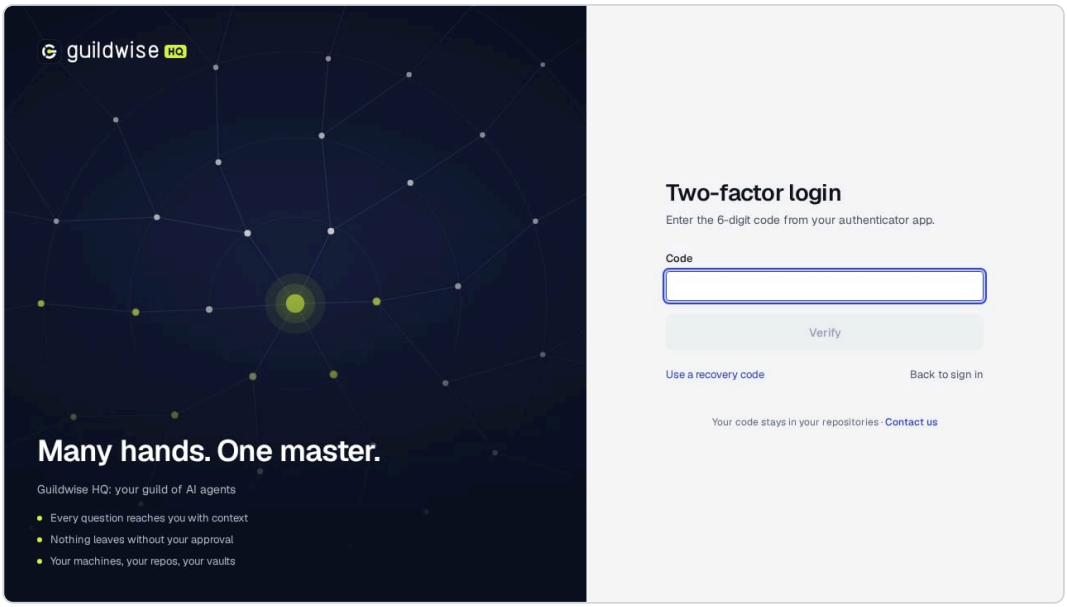


Figure 103 — The sign-in code step

> **In the app**
> Help, "Two-factor login" (`/help/two-factor`) and "Troubleshooting" (`/help/troubleshooting`).

9.7 Other things you may see

What you see	What it means
A red warning icon on a card, "Not workable"	Nobody hired could ever take this stage. Hire the missing role (hover, focus or click the icon: the explanation has a **Hire** link).
An amber icon, "Waiting"	Agents exist but are offline or busy. It clears by itself.
An amber icon, "Last attempt failed: …"	The runner turned the last shift down (for a missing working branch it names the branch and the repository's default, and links to Project settings, Repositories). A desk question offers the existing branches, with the default preselected; the message clears when a shift starts.
The card says "waiting on bug"	The tester found a bug and a bug card is being fixed.
The card says "waiting for sub-workflow"	A step of the card started another card (named on the tile) and the card carries on when that card finishes or is cancelled.
A desk item "Could not post the update"	The ticket system refused the post. Fix the login on the workstation and use **Retry**.
Vault sync paused with a conflict	A local and a remote change collided. Resolve it in the vault, then restart the sync.
"Out of scope" in a handoff	The agent found work outside its role. Adjust the card or the agent's skills.

10. Contact us

If something is broken, confusing or missing, tell us. **Contact us** is in your avatar menu, in the command palette (Ctrl+K, type "contact"), on the **Help** page, on the installer's failure screens and, for people who are not signed in, in the footer of the sign-in page.

1. Choose what it is about: **bug report**, **question**, **feature request** or **billing**.
2. Write a subject and a message.
3. When you open it from the menu or the palette, a screenshot of the page you were looking at is attached automatically. You can remove it or upload a different image (PNG, JPEG or WebP up to 2.5 MB).
4. Open **What we send with your request** to see exactly what goes along: the page you were on, the app version, your browser and screen, and the last few errors from your browser (untick the box to leave the errors out). Your name, email and organization are added so that support can answer.

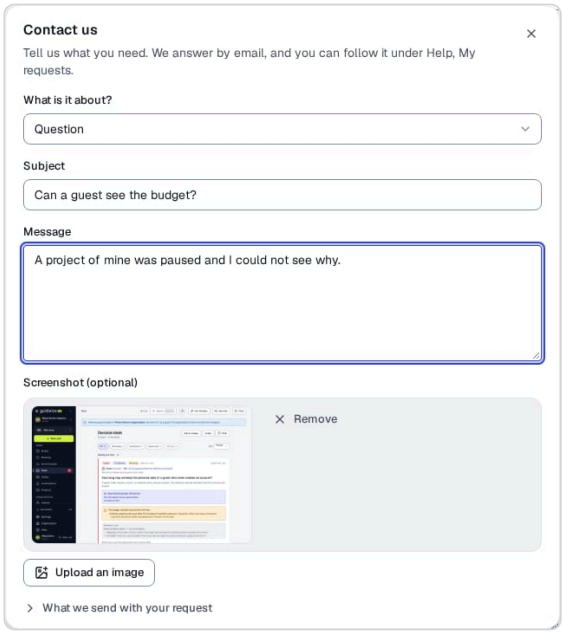


Figure 104 — Contact us

We answer by email, and the answer also appears under **Help, My requests**, where you can reply. A request is **Open** until we answer, **Answered** until you write again, and **Closed** when we are done. A request with a new answer shows a "New reply" badge.

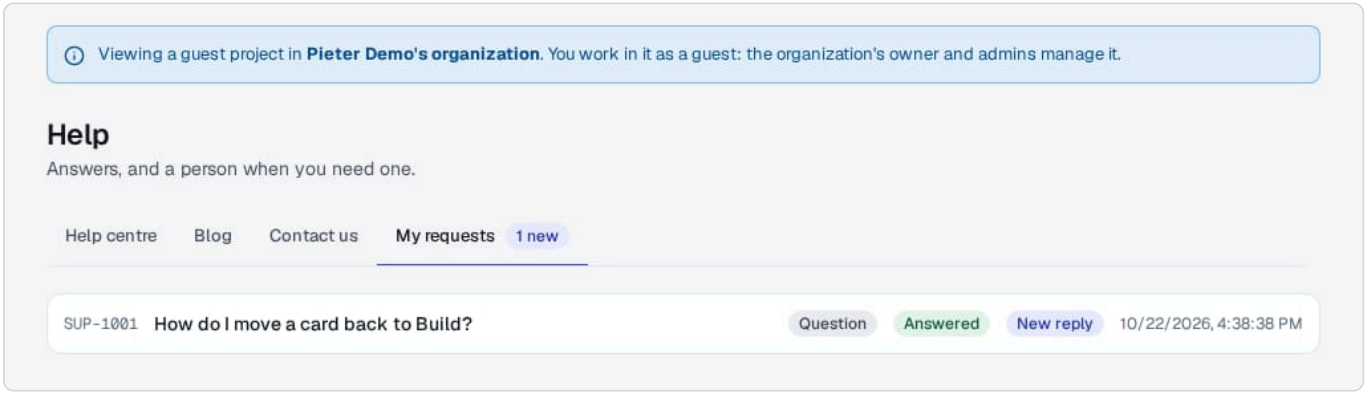


Figure 105 — My requests

> **In the app**
> Help, "Writing to us" (`/help/writing-to-us`).

11. Frequently asked questions

Is Guildwise HQ hosted, or do I install it? It is a hosted service: you sign up on the website (3.1). Only the runner goes on your workstation, your own computer, a VPS or a GitHub Codespace, and your code stays in your own repositories.

Do the agents see my whole computer? No. They run inside a sandbox on the workstation, with access to the repositories and folders they need. Warnings appear if a workstation cannot provide a sandbox. The DevOps engineer is the exception: it works as you, so only give it a machine you are happy to hand it (4.4).

Where is my code stored? On your workstations and in your git remotes, exactly as before. The Guildwise HQ website holds the board, cards, desk, ledger, and records of what the agents did. Passwords and tokens for Jira, your git hosts and Claude stay on your workstation.

Can an agent change my main branch by itself? Only after review and test, and only if the project's **How finished work lands** is *Commit and push to the working branch* (the default). Choose *Pull request I approve* to merge everything yourself. Large changes wait for your approval either way, unless you turned that off in the project settings. If the working branch is protected on your git host, a pull request is opened instead.

What does it cost? Guildwise HQ is $19 (Starter), $49 (Team) or $149 (Business) a month with a 7-day free trial, in US dollars including VAT, charged in rand (4.17). The AI work is billed by Claude: through your subscription or your API key. The app estimates the spend (4.6) and you set budgets.

How many agents do I need? Start with a builder, a reviewer, a tester and a BA (3.5). Add more when cards queue up.

Can I stop an agent? Yes. **Cancel** a card, or **Fire** an agent. A running shift is stopped, and its card goes back to the queue.

An agent asked something I already decided. Add the decision to the ledger when you answer (4.5). Agents search the ledger before they ask.

What if two of my projects have a card with the same number? Card numbers are unique only within one organization. If you are in two organizations with a `WEB-1` each, the app asks which one you mean.

Can I use it on my phone? Yes: the board, the desk, cards, chat and most pages work on a phone. Open the menu with the button at the top left. On the board, **Filters** and **Project actions** open the controls that sit in the header on a bigger screen, and cards can be moved with **Move to…**. The installer needs a computer.

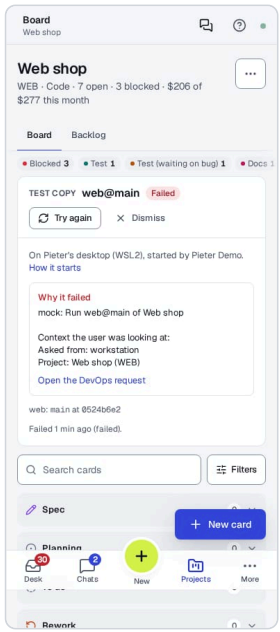


Figure 106 — The board on a phone

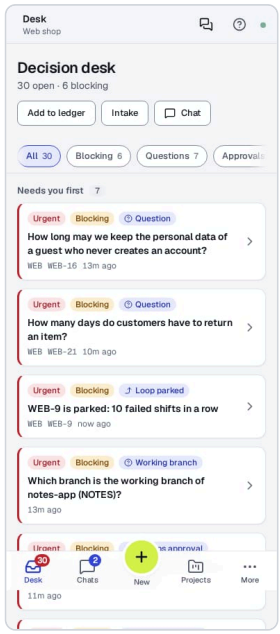


Figure 107 — The desk on a phone

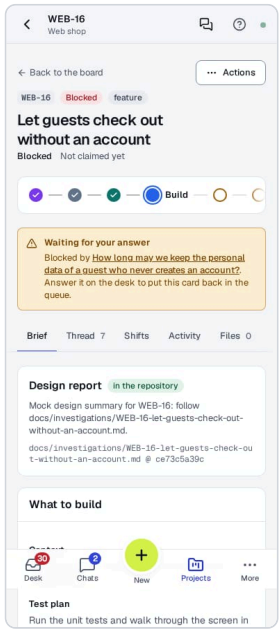


Figure 108 — A card on a phone

Where do I find help? Help in the sidebar: the getting-started training video, searchable articles, the glossary, the **Blog**, **See what's new**, the guided tour again (**Resume the tour** when you stopped part-way), the Get started checklist (bring it back from here), **Contact us** and **My requests**. The **?** hints open the matching article. Press **Ctrl+K** to search the app.

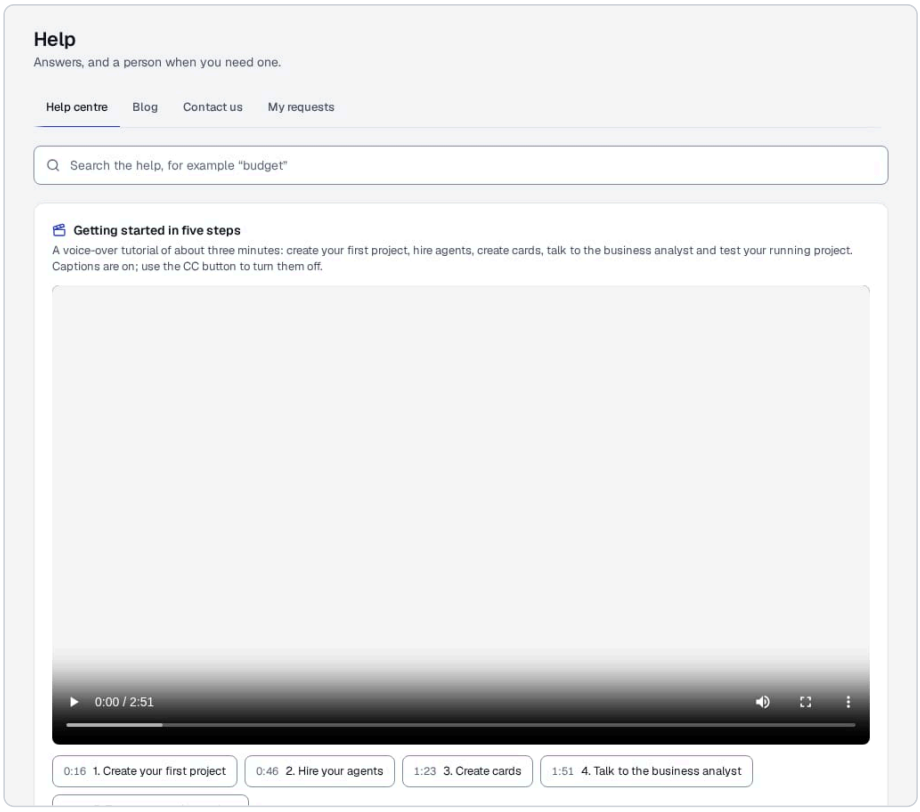


Figure 109 — The Help centre

Which keys can I press? Press **?** (when not typing in a field) for the list of shortcuts. **Ctrl+K** opens the command palette.

Appendix A. Where to find things

The section map

Every entry of the sidebar, in sidebar order, with who sees it, where this guide covers it, its step in the guided tour (3.3) and its Help article. Use these names: they are the labels in the app. Nothing here is hidden by a different name in the app; an entry is missing from your sidebar when your role or your organization's plan does not include it.

#	Section (sidebar)	Who sees it	Guide chapter	Tour step	Help article
1	**Board** (with card, New card, Archive and phase pages)	Everybody	2.2, 3.7, 3.8, 4.6, 4.10, 4.12, 8.1	`board`	Board and cards
2	**Backlog** (project tab)	Everybody reads; Owners and Admins edit	4.3b	`backlog`	Board and cards
3	**Environments** (code projects)	Everybody; Owner approves	4.21, 4.23, 4.27	`environments`	Phases and follow-ups
4	**Research** (projects with research)	Everybody	4.13, 8.2	`research`	Converting a project
5	**Desk**	Everybody	3.8, 4.5, 4.11	`desk`	The Decision desk
6	**Intake**	Owners and Admins	4.8	`intake`	Intake and outbox
7	**Automations**	Everybody	4.8	`schedules`	Automations and integrations
8	**Projects** (and project settings)	Everybody; Owners and Admins change	3.6, 4.3, 4.3a, 4.14, 6.1	`projects`	Projects
9	**Agents**	Everybody	3.5, 4.4, 4.18	`agents`	Agents
10	**Org chart**	Everybody	4.7	`org-chart`	Organization chart and design
11	**CEO**	Owners and Admins	4.11, 4.22	`ceo`	Your CEO
12	**Roles & workflows** (page title Organization)	Everybody	4.7, 4.26	`org`	Organization chart and design
13	**Workstations**	Everybody	3.4, 4.19, 4.24a, 4.25, 9.1, 9.2	`workstations`	Workstations and the installer
14	**Releases**	Everybody; Owners and Admins release	4.28	`releases`	Phases and follow-ups
15	**Integrations**	Everybody	3.4a	`integrations`	Integrations
16	**Metrics**	Everybody	4.29	`metrics`	Agents
17	**Costs**	Owners and Admins	4.6, 8.4	`costs`	Budgets and costs
18	**Interests**	When the Interests feature is on	4.9, 8.3	`interests`	Interests
19	**Ledger**	Everybody	4.5	`ledger`	Ledger and vaults
20	**Vaults**	Owners and Admins	4.3, 4.3a	`vaults`	Ledger and vaults
21	**Settings** (also **Your settings** in your avatar menu)	Everybody	3.2, 4.30	`settings`	Getting started
22	**Organization**	Everybody; Owners and Admins manage	4.1, 4.2, 4.16, 4.17	`organization`	Organizations and roles
23	**Help**	Everybody	3.3, 10, 11	`help`	Getting started

#	Section (sidebar)	Who sees it	Guide chapter	Tour step	Help article
P	**Platform area** (platform administrator)	Platform administrators	7	the platform tour	Organizations and roles

The platform area has its own menu: Organizations (7.2), Invitations (7.3), Accounts (7.4), Billing (7.10), Support (7.5), Blog (7.7), API keys (7.11), Runners (7.12), Platform team (7.9), Inbound mail (7.13) and Audit log (7.6).

Questions you may have

I want to	Go to
See my work	**Board** (sidebar, Work)
Keep a list of wanted work that agents do not touch yet	**Backlog** (tab next to the board)
Answer questions and approve things	**Desk**
Hand the BA a ticket	**Intake** (Owners and Admins)
Set up recurring jobs and event automations	**Automations**
Connect Claude, git hosts, Jira and MCP servers on a workstation	**Integrations**
Create or change a project, or put the projects in priority order	**Projects**
Follow a topic	**Interests** (Knowledge)
Look up a past decision	**Ledger** (Knowledge)
Register a notes vault	**Vaults** (Owners and Admins)
Hire or change agents	**Agents** (Organization)
See who answers whom	**Org chart**
Talk to your CEO, set what it may decide and when it reports	**CEO** (Owners and Admins)
Design roles and workflows	**Roles & workflows**
Add a computer, a VPS or a Codespace	**Workstations**
See how the team performs	**Metrics**
See and control spend	**Costs** (Owners and Admins)
Picture, notifications, Monday briefing, time zone, two-factor, expert mode for code changes, weekly blog digest	**Settings** (the sidebar, or your avatar menu, Your settings)
Link projects to each other (for the CEO's routing)	**Organization**, Project links tab (Owners and Admins)
Release a version that is ready, see what is live and what was deployed and why it was allowed, edit the rules, freeze all releases	**Releases** (Organization; Owners and Admins release, everyone looks)
Say where your app runs, start steps, test and live sites, places, and pause a project's releases	**Environments** (the project, under the board)
Set a deploy secret	**Environments**, Show technical details
See a project's code map	**Projects**, then the project's **Settings**, Code map for agents
Members, invitations, plan, billing	**Organization** (bottom of the sidebar)
Help, glossary, blog, what's new, the tour, contact us	**Help**

Appendix B. More documentation

- `docs/RUNNER.md`: the runner in depth (data folder, command-line, configuration, Windows and WSL2).
- `docs/DEPLOY.md`: installing and running the Guildwise HQ server (for whoever hosts it).
- `docs/SPEC.md`: the full product specification.
- `docs/ARCHITECTURE.md`: technical design.
- `docs/guide/Guildwise-HQ-User-Guide.pdf`: this guide with screenshots, as a PDF.